

GNOMOLOGY

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# GNOMOLOGY

TEACHING AND EXPERIENCES  
OF THE  
OLD INITIATIC SCHOOLS



*ELEVEN FIGURES IN THE TEXT*

Editions des Champs-Élysées  
"LITERARY OMNIUM "  
72. Avenue des Champs-Élysées — PARIS

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*The enjoyments provoked by the senses are like matrices of pain to come...*

BHAGAWAD GITA

*The narrations of the Torah are garments of the Torah. Woe to him who takes the garment of the Torah for the Torah itself... Educated men do not pay attention to the clothes, but to the body that this garment envelops.*

ZOHAR.

## FOREWORD

The compass indicates the direction, but it is our toiling legs that must make the way.

*Chinese saying.*

*I decided to bring together in this book my articles published at various times. I do so at the request of many readers who cannot obtain the issues of the journals, sometimes dating back twenty-five or thirty years, which published them.*

*The few ideas that are scattered there will be useful, I hope, to those interested in the occult sciences and the life beyond the grave.*

*I am convinced myself that our short stay on earth is only an episode of our life. And when I leave, “ don't think that this body in front of you is me; he was indeed mine, but he is not me. It was my home for a number of years and my spare clothing. I am the bird and this body is its cage... Understand the meaning of what I am saying, for it is a mystery that can only be described by symbols and figurative language... Do not believe that death is the end, for in truth only life is eternal ”)... (HayatAl Hayawan Demeri)*

*Think again: “ The body is like the mount of the soul; it perishes, but the soul survives. The soul must take care of its body like a pilgrim, on his way to Mecca, must take care of his camel. But if the pilgrim spends all his time feeding and trimming his camel, the caravan will leave leaving it to perish in the desert. (Al Gasali, Sage Suji.)*

*Here is yet another point of view which broadens the question and brings us great comfort: " Man comes to life many times but does not remember his previous lives, except sometimes in a dream or a thought relating to some circumstances of a previous life. He cannot specify the date and the place of this conjuncture, he only knows that it is a question of a familiar circumstance. In the end, all his different lives will be revealed to him..." (Papyrus Anana, 1320 BC)*

*Thus death in itself should in no way frighten us.*

*What I fear is to weaken and, for fear of suffering, to cowardly abandon my positions, to renounce all that I have served during my life, to bow before the "beast", to to accept on my forehead the ignoble "sign of the beast". (Revelation 14.9.)*

*No! Never! Let's grit our teeth and, like the captain of the ship perishing in an unequal fight, let's nail our flag to the mast, so as not to have the temptation to lower it at the last moment. May our flag, which for a lifetime have been our sacred emblem, float proudly and sink with us.*

*This may pass for quixoticism in the eyes of contemporary man. He will keep no memory of the one who perishes without having betrayed his convictions. But this act will give us this satisfaction that no one, and above all ourselves, will be able to say: he betrayed what his whole existence had served.*

*And later, when the feelings of honor and probity will awaken in man, the contribution of those who, through times of shamelessness and cowardice will have kept the flame of their convictions until the end, this contribution finally appreciated, will help establish a new world on a solid foundation of faith and truth leading to predestined evolution.*

*The man will finally understand that "The short passing sufferings produce in superabundance the Eternal Glory". (Saint Paul, Second <sup>Epistle</sup> to the Corinthians.)*

*Under the title of "Gnomology" I have brought together in this book articles dealing with various questions which do not seem to have anything in common, but which all relate to the same vast science of antiquity, forgotten in our day.*

*I have done this with the intention, first, of demonstrating the almost limitless amplitude of Gnomology and, second, so that the adept can choose, among the different ramifications of the tree of Knowledge, the one that is in harmony with his degree of individual evolution or, to use ordinary language: that which "interests" him the most.*

*By doing so I followed the teaching system of the old schools of initiation where the disciple, as he progressed, had to go through all the stages of his path of spiritual evolution.*

*Having chosen a special branch of knowledge, the adept will have to thoroughly study all the literature relating to it and, in order to be able to understand and master it, he will have to draw from the deepest sources in our possession. To accomplish this, he will necessarily have to study ancient Hebrew and, if possible, the hieroglyphic language.*

*This will enable him, when he makes experiments (as indispensable here as in the study of the physical sciences), to*

*understand the combinations of forces of Nature that it brings into play.*

*Without it, everything he tries will be worthless and doomed to failure.*

*It is knowledge alone that gives power, just as to open a door one must possess the key.*

*I know that what I am proposing is not easy, on the contrary; but what value would this universal science have if, having read one or two books, one could possess the “Open Sesame” which opens all doors?*

*Let us remember the old hermetic adage: “Lege, lege, relegere, ora, labora et invenies” (Read, read, reread, pray, work and you will find), everything is there and there is nothing to add to it .*

ENEL

## GNOMOLOGY

This word of Greek origin is composed of: 1) *Gnoma* meaning proof, experience, or *Gnomé* meaning: knowledge, knowledge and 2) *Logos*: the verb, the creative word.

The verb *gnomologeo* which presents the combination of these two words means: to teach by means of parables or allegories.

Thus Gnomology, as a denomination of the branch of knowledge, which will be discussed, seems to define the principles on which this very ancient science is based.

It is the mass of experiences pursued by man through the millennia of his existence that constitutes the indisputable proof of this.

Having obtained the proofs by experimental means, man establishes his knowledge on a solid foundation and can begin to erect the complicated edifice of a new science. I say “new”, but it is basically new only for us who live <sup>in</sup> the 20th century. It would be more correct to say it “renovated” or simply recalled to the memory of man, freed from the veil that has covered it for countless centuries.

This knowledge had been forgotten by the man who directed his intelligence and all his research towards material development, towards the application of the forces of Nature to the sole service of his bodily part. Today's man seems to be unaware of the existence in him of superior faculties, he has forgotten that the Creative Word is a formidable power that can transform the unreal into reality, that a word uttered knowingly or an appropriate gesture can really create.

Instead of developing in himself the sublime faculties with which he was endowed from his creation, man chooses manual work, the shaping of matter by his physical members.

This erroneous orientation necessarily led him lower and lower, bogged down in matter of which he became not the master, but the slave. The forces of Nature which he thinks he has mastered bind him more and more to matter, for they develop

in him desires that he cannot realize and erase the last vestiges of his spiritual faculties (the human-robot that contemporary industry seeks to create).

It is the tempting serpent of Genesis, the ancient Nahash of the Bible, which seizes man, squeezing him more and more in his bonds by awakening in him the various passions. Once evoked, they can no longer be put to rest. It is drink for the drunkard, it is money for the miser, it is luxury, wantonness, envy and hatred... Hate and fear, these are the two scourges of our sad time, when really "homo homini lupus est".

Such, then, is the main and real cause of all our evils, of revolutions, of wars and finally of the atomic bomb, which will inevitably lead humanity to its general destruction.

Man would have avoided them if he had oriented himself differently, if he had developed his innate faculties of embodied spirit and not his wild beast instincts.

We find markers of spiritual guidance in all the ancient teachings; Christ Himself told us this very clearly. The beautiful words of the Gospel delight our ears but do not penetrate our understanding. We remain deaf and blind, as Jesus said to the Pharisees who claimed to have the key to true knowledge.

Gnomology, which we are in the process of removing from the rubble of ancient civilizations and reconstituting, is therefore based on experience to reveal to man the presence, in himself and in all that surrounds him, of formidable latent forces since they are precisely the constructive forces of the Universe. The famous cosmic rays that man strives to capture are one of their many manifestations.

These forces were revealed to Adam (the universal man), from his creation, by the Creator. We find mention of this fact in Genesis under the symbolic name of "the tree of knowledge of good and evil" of which man was forbidden to eat the fruits. This allegory means that man is forbidden to use the creative forces for material purposes "to nourish his body".

The fall of man and his expulsion from paradise were the consequence of the use he made of these forces for a forbidden purpose. Many ancient civilizations have collapsed because they too have touched the essence of the universal mechanism for an impure purpose.

For the same reason we are on the eve of a catastrophe because, by decomposing the atom, we play like children with forces that we do not understand and that we nevertheless want to adapt to the service of our material body.

Gnomology precisely studies the constructive forces of Nature, but its access is totally different from that of

material science, doomed to failure and impending doom.

Gnomology, on the contrary, develops in the follower his spiritual faculties to enable him to place himself in a harmonious agreement with the forces directing the Universe. Its purpose is to serve man by helping him to restore the balance between his spiritual part and his physical part, to help the spirit to free itself from the grips of matter, to heal the ailments and failures of the mind and body; in a word, to serve one's neighbor by all means, following the precepts bequeathed to us by Our Lord Jesus Christ.

We will therefore admit the need, for the teaching given by Gnomology, to be at a certain point allegorical: we must avoid "throwing pearls at the swine".

The powers that Gnomology studies are so great and the consequences of an erroneous use would be so serious, that it is understandable that the revelations can only be made, so to speak, drop by drop, as the aspirant gives proof of his intentions: to serve all who need help, but never to use these forces for material purposes or revenge.

There can therefore be no question of a "correspondence course". teaching is done orally. In this way, the one in charge of teaching will be able to judge the degree of preparation of the aspirant, his aptitudes and his real intentions. He will reveal to him as much as it will be useful to him and as his evolution will allow him to understand and, if he notices the slightest inclination towards materialism, he will be able to close the door of knowledge before an ill-intentioned spirit seizes it to use it dangerously.

It will therefore be deduced from the above that the teaching of Gnomology can only be individual and that the progress of the aspirant depends only on his spiritual preparation, his sincere desire and the purity of his intentions.

His reward consists neither in his enrichment nor in glory, but only in the satisfaction of having helped his neighbour.

We do not call ourselves masters, because we are only humble servants, ready to render service to all those who need help both because of their physical ailments and their spiritual orientation.

## *FIRST PART*

## MAN CREATED IN THE IMAGE OF GOD

It is said in Genesis (I. 26): "And God said: We will make Adam (the universal man) in Our shadow reflected according to the laws of Our assimilating action so that, collective power, he may hold universal empire and dominates at the same time... all the creation accomplished before him. »

This translation by F. d'Olivet differs from that of the Vulgate, but its general meaning is about the same.

What is the fact that man "reflects" his Creator? Why can man be considered "created in the image of God", as it says in the official translation?

Egyptian teaching gives us valuable explanations on this subject.

According to the doctrine of the temple of Heliopolis, the Creator was Tem (or Atum) whose name meant: "Reason of all life" and "All" (see my "Origins of Genesis").

The double epithet usually added to this name was: "Great by its Unity" and "Great by its number". These epithets expressed on the one hand the idea that the Creator contained in his Unity all the forms of creation and, on the other hand, that the creative force manifested itself in each of the innumerable differentiated forms, for the Creator was ALL. Thus, in other words, Tem presented simultaneously the principle of synthesis and the principle of analysis.

In order to manifest itself, the first act of the Unity of the Creator was its splitting into two opposite poles (positive-negative, masculine-feminine, active-passive, etc.). This is expressed by another epithet of Tem: Mut-f, meaning: "mother-father" of all that was created (see op. rit.).

The principle of doubling, once declared in the Mout-f, manifested itself in the consecutive doublings of the divine unity which were personified by the divine couples of the "Great Ennead" (the Elohim of Genesis). "I am One become Two, I am Two become Four, I am Four become Eight, but I AM ONE".

The Ennead, according to the teaching of the temple of Heliopolis, was thus formed. The creative word, the Logos of Tem,

Egyptians Ra (which literally means: "the action of the mouth") successively issued four pairs of deities personifying the main laws of nature.

The first couple was Shou and Tefnut — the principle of expansion, of light, of heat (Shou) and that of limitation, of frames imposed on any expansion of the vital principle (Tefnut).

The second couple was Geb and Nut, the god of the earth and the goddess of the celestial vault, who fixed the real limits within which life must manifest itself. This couple represents the precision of the principle established by Tefnut: limitation, framing.

The third couple was Osiris and Isis, the principle of life which is in the seed and manifests itself only if it is buried, or that which is in the egg and requires that the latter be hatched for life to appear. . This pair represents the development of Shou's principle of expansion.

Finally the last couple was Set-Nephtis, the solidification, the realization (the brick-Set, of which the building-Nephtis is built). This couple personifies the manifestation of real life, limited by the framework of the three dimensions of matter. It therefore constitutes the maximum development of the principle of Tefnut. But what matters is that the defining sign Nephtis is the temple (she is called "mistress of the temple"). It is therefore not just any building that man must erect, but a temple in which to adore his Creator.

All these consecutive unfoldings represent the work of the analytical force unleashed by the Creator to accomplish the act of creation.

Once the analysis was at its peak, it was necessary to oppose it to the synthesis in order to reduce to the primitive unity the maximum number of duplication or, in other words, in order to bring back to their primordial source the parcels of the vital Principle of the Creator. , dispersed in its innumerable manifestations. This had to happen for the cycle to be completed.

Now, this mission was entrusted to man "created in the image of God", therefore possessing within himself the "two greatneses"—that of analytical infinity and that of synthetic unity.

In the Egyptian pantheon, this moment is personified by Horus the Younger, son of Isis, "avenger of his father" Osiris.

Horus is the tenth element of the divine Ennead, tenth, that is to say the Unity of the second order. Hence, Horus corresponds to Malchut—the tenth sephire of the sefirotic tree of the Kabbalah. The other elements of the Sephirotic system correspond to those of the Egyptian Ennead.

Horus was the son conceived by Isis (the vital principle of mother earth) and begotten by Osiris (the fertilizing principle, the

double principle of life, of expansion, of evolution was fought by the principle of limitation, of involution so that incarnated life could manifest itself.

The Egyptian myth describing the struggle of Osiris and Seth (of the two opposing principles) expresses this idea in a poetic and metaphorical way. Osiris falls under the blows of Seth because, to complete the cycle of incarnation, life had to follow death, but the latter is not the end, because life is eternal. A Russian writer, M. Merezhkovsky, in his remarkable book "The Mystery of the Three", defined Osiris as the shadow of Christ, Osiris being essentially the symbol of the resurrection, the living god in death, the one who sacrificed himself in order to manifest eternal life. From death must arise new life, as from a buried seed comes a new plant.

On the other hand we see this same idea personified in the Egyptian pantheon by Horus, the son of Osiris called "avenger of his father".

Its raison d'être is to fight death, to liberate the principle of life from the grips of matter, to accomplish the predestined evolution by bringing back the divine parcel to its primordial source: Unity.

Thus Horus is the prototype of man whose role is precisely the same: evolution, the liberation of the spirit from its material envelope. It is said in Genesis that "the offspring of the woman shall crush the serpent" (Nahash — the passions which bind the pure spirit of man in matter).

It follows from the above that the divinities of the Egyptian Ennead are all personifications of the analytical force emanating from the Creator (the Elohim of Genesis) and that man, endowed with free will, is the only one to possess within himself the "two magnitudes" of the Creator: the analytical force and the synthetic force. Man is therefore truly the image or reflection of the

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## FOCUS OF LIGHT

Formerly, the peoples still in childhood recognized the superiority of those who constituted an elite and who led them towards the good and the progress conceived in the thought of the Creator.

Like docile subjects, they followed their leaders, for they had unshakeable faith in their wisdom.

This is how the grandiose civilizations of Atlantis and its colonies developed: Egypt and Babylon.

Moses, the Initiate of the Egyptian sanctuaries, endeavored to penetrate with his teaching the mentality of Israel. But the spirit of revolt reigned among the Hebrews who did not have blind confidence in their leader. The latter, to establish his authority and make people believe in his divine mission, had to resort to miracles.

The idea of a terrible and vengeful God crosses like a red line the doctrine of Moses, in order to get the better of this rebellious people who must be tamed by the fear of divine punishment.

The wisdom of the Magi was, in ancient civilizations, covered with the veil of mystery and transmitted orally to the elect; Moses, in turn, concealed it under cryptographic symbolism. He thus protected the sacred dogma from impure hands that could have used it for material ends. Such was the struggle of a Sage with this nation, in which the beast was every moment on the verge of devouring man.

So Moses is not afraid to say with disdain that his people are only a band of rebellious serfs. The vengeful and merciless God was the whip with which he could lead this people. On the other hand, his magic powers allowed him to give constant proofs of his power.

The continuous wars, the internal fights which occurred after the death of Moses brought this people of depraved revolutionaries under the yoke of Babylon first and Rome later.

Appears Jesus Christ, whose coming was announced by all the prophets of the Hebrews. Christ opened wide the door of spiritual progress to men of good will. He gave the key to this door, which the Sages had guarded for centuries under the

sealed with mystery, saying that to reach perfection, it was enough to love. Loving God and neighbor is the Alpha and Omega of teaching — the beginning and the end.

Such a simple prescription does not require any preparation, any initiation. But unfortunately ! this path towards the Light was impracticable for the man of desire and very few were those who committed themselves to it. A few apostles, a few martyrs... Then came the separation of the Churches; sensuality took the place of the divine, hatred replaced love, and once again darkness enveloped humanity.

Wisdom, this pivot of antiquity, was lost, love, the basis of Christianity, replaced by the passions, and men fell under the yoke of the antichrist who, under the seductive mask of socialism, promised him paradise. terrestrial instead of the celestial joys following this life. The man has fallen and the triumphant beast is about to devour him.

This is where the white race has arrived, a dominant race which, despite the extraordinary progress of science, is closer to its end than it has ever been. But, alongside our civilization so developed in the material order, there are other races whose evolution and growth have not paralleled ours. I hear those we consider backward because they don't have airplanes and don't know the TSF

From the height of our pride, we assimilate to monkeys these peoples whose spirit escapes us, without suspecting that with all our progress, we are perhaps closer than them to the beast. The time we spend in developing industry, comfort, the means to destroy our fellows, they pass in silence, meditation and contemplation of nature.

Haven't they moved further from the physical plane than we have? Haven't they developed psychic faculties unsuspected by us? It's to do...

It should not be thought, however, that among the Christians there are not chosen ones who keep intact the doctrine of true Christianity.

On the contrary, there are centers, foci of light where faith is sincere and deep, and it is perhaps because of these foci that God does not annihilate animal humanity, as He has already done. long ago, not wanting to lose a few saints by chastising the guilty crowd. These Christian homes exist, but few suspect their existence because they must be sought far from all pomp and modern bustle. They live in silence. Their spiritual methods resemble those of certain centers belonging to other religions and the results which they obtain are of the same order.

I am going to establish a parallel likely to interest those who can approach these environments and which will allow them to perceive the

light they radiate.

It is not a question here of studying their processes, but only of noting their strength.

He who, animated by pure intentions, wishes to observe them, does not reappear and dies for the world. On the contrary, a simple curious person who enters this atmosphere only sees the exterior which seems incomprehensible and even strange to him.

I will first take Thibet as an example, that mysterious country where so many explorers have disappeared. Others have come back and published extraordinary, not to say sometimes implausible, travel reports. As another example I will show the Orthodox monasteries of Mount Athos which date from the first centuries of the Christian era. They contain incomparable treasures of religious art, admired by tourists and guarded by uneducated monks, but whose mystical radiance attracts and enlightens the enthusiasts of Eastern Europe.

What strikes the traveler in Tibet is the large number of small monasteries scattered all over this dismal country with a harsh climate.

The lamas receive with a smiling and friendly air, while giving the impression of hiding their thoughts and keeping a secret. You feel like an insurmountable wall separating you from them. They will show you around their monastery, show you scrolls that date back centuries and are often important libraries.

But one has the impression that there is something beyond what one sees and that this something, which one guesses is essential, is of an occult order, known only to lamas, incomprehensible to the European armed with an erudition nevertheless superior to theirs.

Consider those veiled eyes, that gaze both interior and distant, that enigmatic smile, characteristic of the faces of Boudha and the Sphinx...

The curious explorer sees on all sides prayer wheels turning in the wind, repeating ceaselessly: "Aum mani padmi om"; he hears the deafening noise made by the lamas during religious ceremonies to chase away evil spirits. Hideous and ridiculous masks surround him.

All these manifestations seem childish and ridiculous to him. But he remains stupefied by certain phenomena produced by these same illiterate lamas.

The future and the past hold no secrets for them, the forces of nature seem to obey them, they free themselves from the needs of the body and can, without apparent effort, dominate their surroundings.

Time and space no longer seem to matter to them and the results they obtain on the physical plane are of a higher order than those which the applied sciences allow us.

What is human life if not an incessant struggle against time and space that bind us? Our existence is becoming hectic. Machinery allows man to move from one place to another at tremendous speed. Wireless allows him to hear and see what is happening at prodigious distances.

But anyway, the machine, production of man, can never overcome time and space...

And these backward lamas, who have no notion of our Western sciences, obtain by psychic processes results which disconcert the European.

It is of them that God says: "I opened to the children what I sealed to the Wise."

Those who have only seen this profound and mysterious religion on the surface cannot claim to know it. Its age is counted in millennia, it is contemporary with the Egyptian cults, if even it is not prior to them...

The Sages who govern these peoples *know* and have been able, until today, to preserve them from the harmful influences, from the temptations of our materialistic and erroneous culture. And the peoples obey and believe.

The above undoubtedly relates to one of the Foci of Light in our world. Let us now see what it may have in common with another centre, this time a Christian one.

"Our intention is the same, our hearts beat in unison. Let us join forces to achieve the common goal" says a Vedic prayer.

The traveler who arrives at Mount Athos is dazzled by the splendor and riches of the principal monasteries. Gold, silver, precious stones sparkle on the icons and on the sacred objects of the shrines.

The ceremonies, the songs invite to prayer. The prayers of the monks, the harmonious sound of the bells, the virgin forests of the surroundings, the severe beauty of nature, everything invites him to retreat and meditation.

But these rich monasteries, with their golden cupolas decorated with Byzantine crosses, these imposing processions pass in the background for the curious tourist.

All these decorations, he could contemplate them elsewhere than in this grandiose and melancholy country; but he has heard that on these mountains and in these dark forests there exist men who pass their lives in prayer and contemplation, whose faith is transformed into knowledge and knowledge into supernatural force.

He wants to see them, not to humbly ask them for initiation or their blessing, but out of a taste for new, extraordinary things, in front of which he will play his Kodak. He asks these obliging and helpful monks where he can meet the hermits he has been told so much about. He is told that they live somewhere in the middle of century-old forests, in

caves unknown to all, coming to the monastery when they deem it useful. However, the traveler is free to look for the anchorites: if necessary, guides will be provided for him so that he does not get lost. He explores the country, climbs the peaks.

He sometimes meets in the forest, near an isolated hut, some peasant, some old man with a white beard who kindly offers him tea or honey. "Have I found the hermit?" asks the traveler. Nothing proves it to him: this man could simply have moved away from the world out of a need for calm and solitude.

Bored by these fruitless searches, the tourist returns dissatisfied with the conviction that all this fame is imaginary and results from a suggestion on the weak spirits exploited by the monks.

He saw here, as in Tibet, only strange and sometimes ridiculous appearances.

But if we approach these hermits with faith and sincerity, if we live with them for some time, we see them accomplish astonishing things that their mask of peasant bonhomie did not allow us to foresee.

These so-called illiterate men began to read fluently old Latin or Greek texts, very numerous in the libraries of the monasteries, or to speak three or four living languages with ease.

Watch their gaze carefully, both gentle and fiery. Their simple, measured words astonish you and appear to you as the expression of pure Wisdom deified by faith.

You begin to feel the effects of the unknown force that emanates from these beings dead to the world for years, of the spiritual force that permeates the atmosphere of this sacred place. You have to go there yourself to know these indefinable impressions.

I am going to cite a few personal observations which will make it possible to illustrate these comparisons between Christian Initiation and the ancient Initiation.

\*

A fishing boat dropped me on a small beach enclosed by huge rocks. Behind them the mountain rose suddenly to a very great height and I saw no possibility of advancing on this difficult terrain. I stopped, somewhat moved, afraid to stay in this solitary place because my boat had regained the open sea. Yet I knew that loners lived on this steep mountain. Suddenly my eyes met a man crouching on the sand and looking busy. I approached and asked him to show me the way out of this cove. Without turning around and without saying a word, he waved his hand at me pointing to the mountain. I headed in the direction indicated and saw a barely cleared path that was lost in the brush. I began the ascent and, having reached a certain height, I felt something like a look

watched me from the depths of the copse. Almost immediately I saw a man covered in rags and presenting that illuminated face which characterizes hermits. I greeted him and asked him if he lived there. He replied in the affirmative, but when I asked him to allow me to visit his home, he smiled and told me that the thing seemed impossible to him. I was surprised. He invited me to follow him and I realized, a few minutes later, that I could not risk such a trip. He lived in a cave dug in a rock with a vertical wall. To get there, you had to walk a hundred meters by clinging to a rope fixed horizontally above a precipice and resting your feet on the rock. I was dizzy thinking of this perilous maneuver performed every day by my companion.

He was a kind and very educated man. I talked to him for a long time. I told him that for a long time I had wanted to see a hermit to show him my veneration and my respect and that at last this satisfaction was given to me.

He smiled and told me that he was just a poor sinner who had retired there for only fifteen years and that he deserved nothing of my admiration.

He offered to take me to the master (Staretz) whose disciple he was. This master who had lived in the mountains for more than 50 years was a man of great merit. I gladly agreed, and after a bumpy journey through the rocks, we finally came to the entrance of a cavern in front of which sat an old man of strange and majestic beauty. He was blind and his eyebrows covered his eyes.

No sooner had I approached him than he named me, said he was waiting for me and welcomed me. I begged him to give me his blessing, and when I bowed before him, I felt a warm current escape from his hands and invade my whole being.

I talked to him for about an hour. During our conversation I asked him why he had withdrawn from the world.

He replied that the purpose of human existence was to fight evil.

In this combat, as in the other war, there is the rear of the army, the front and finally the outposts, which are the most exposed to the attacks of the enemy which they must signal. Hermits are the outposts of humanity in its fight against evil. Their determination, their loneliness, their constant prayers expose them to the onslaught of evil; they must constantly push them back or... succumb if they are not strong enough. Many are those who, prejudging their own strength, cannot adapt to the life of the anchorite, to this constant struggle. On the other hand, those who can sustain the battle render the greatest service to humanity.

He who lives in the human vortex does not directly receive the attacks of the lower forces to which he is more or less

less enslaved. On the other hand, the one who has withdrawn from the world is exposed to all kinds of temptations and must continually struggle not to fall.

If there were no saints who pray for misguided humanity, it would long ago have suffered the fate of Babylon and some other ancient cities where depravity had reached its height.

“Are you, my father, one of these chosen ones? I asked him. He smiled and said very simply and very humbly: “No, I am only a poor sinner, there are others who are more worthy than me”.

I took leave of the holy personage, asking him for a place in his prayers.

## INITIATION

A neophyte who comes to the monastery is placed under the supervision of a staretz (old man) whom he must obey blindly. Most of these neophytes are employed in the work of the vegetable gardens, woods, etc., the others assigned to the library and the archives of the monastery.

The eight-hour day is unknown and we work from sunrise to sunset. Disciples, as a reward, are admitted to church service on Sundays. Those who enter the monastery with the intention of devoting themselves solely to God often do not understand that menial work is imposed on them. He begs the staretz to allow him to attend the offices, but he receives a discouraging answer: "Go dig the potatoes, I will pray for you". Offended at first, he rebels internally but his repeated requests always provoke the same injunction: "Go pick the potatoes and don't worry about the rest." By drawing you will be closer to God. »

Years pass like this... sometimes, for some, a whole existence.

But for others, who have complied completely with the will of their staretz by making abnegation of theirs, a day comes when the initiator tells them: "You have to live in a cave and live as a hermit. The time is over". It is with difficulty that the neophyte separates from his guide, to whom he is bound by deep affection and absolute devotion. But he has been bent for years to passive obedience: he will now live in retirement, ready to one day replace the one who trained him.

The rule is to reduce the will of the disciple to the point of making it a mere object, "perinde ac cadaver", in the hands of the instructor. Only then can he himself acquire a will of steel which will enable him to dominate his own beast and to rise, through conscious prayer, to a great spiritual height.

— They say you often work miracles, I once asked a monk in one of these monasteries.

— No, he replied, what miracles would it be? There are only men who lead a holy life and there are healings. For the rest, you will see and you will hear.

Curiously enough, all the holy hermits die on Sunday during mass, immediately after the elevation. They know in advance that they are going to leave for the last journey and the joy they experience is truly moving.

All the monks gather around the dying person to share their joy and build themselves up to the spectacle of an exemplary end. According to the same monks, there are hermits in the mountains whose age we do not know and whom we do not meet. Sometimes, only, they appear to warn that a great misfortune is near and that it is necessary to pray. The last time they showed up was to predict the great war. There is a short prayer: the prayer of N.-SJ-C., said day and night by these religious who acquire through this prayer a mysterious force <sup>1</sup>.

I asked them if I could recite it and get the same results. 'No,' they answered, 'you cannot pronounce it and it takes years to understand it and realize its power; used without special preparation, it gives no result, sometimes it even produces an effect opposite to that expected, by triggering forces that you do not know how to dominate'".

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Here's another sobering case:

A holy old man lived in a monastery. He was weak and walked with difficulty. One winter day, a telephone was telephoned to the monastery in a village 18 km away, asking this monk to come and relieve a sick person. It was dark and to reach the village, you had to cross a forest under the snow. The old man wanted to leave on foot. A normal man would have taken at least four hours to cross the forest.

He had barely left an hour when the village was telephoned from the monastery to send someone to meet him. But what was the surprise of the monks when they were told that the staretz had arrived half an hour ago and was peacefully having a cup of tea.

On his return, he was questioned about the extraordinary rapidity of his movement. He remained silent.

Examples of this kind abound... He who is animated by holy intentions can easily verify them.

I have taken as examples the two centers mentioned above; They are not the only ones. India, a mysterious country, also has centers of initiation whose light is reflected in the religion of the Brahmins. The initiation is very difficult and shrouded in mystery.

The fakirs that one meets in most towns are only skilful conjurers. Some have a

real power of collective suggestion and delude the crowds. But initiates do not seek such successes.

In my pilgrimages, I had the opportunity to meet some initiates who gave me indubitable proofs of their supernatural strength. Wherever they come from, their initiatory modes are similar.

In our time, when humanity is bogged down in matter, those whose spirit suffers, suffocates and struggles in vain in its prison, must, if they are free from all social burden, orient themselves towards one of these focal points of light. Which ? It doesn't matter, since the Truth is One.

Those who have traveled in the Orient have attended, from time to time in public squares, juggling sessions presented by beings of rather bizarre appearance, silent and disdainful of that eloquence which is the prerogative of Western jugglers. The native spectators follow with attention the conjuring work of those who are called fakirs. The latter indulge in incredible experiences in front of the public. They manipulate cobras which they charm to the sounds of a small flute. They also make these formidable reptiles perform a kind of mysterious and rhythmic dance.

They then take a seed which they place under a small heap of earth, water it and cover the whole with a light veil. After a few minutes, we see the earth rise, the plant emerges, grows, is gradually covered with leaves, flowers, and fruits. This amazing plant growth lasted for half an hour at most.

They cross from side to side, with needles or knives, various parts of their body without bloodshed and without leaving traces of wounds.

Finally, sometimes they repeat the well-known trick of the monkey climbing up a rope launched into space and disappearing in two... The crowd watches and remains speechless, each having the absolute certainty of reality of the phenomenon.

The European is less gullible and seeks to control the facts. In the majority of cases he manages to conclude that he suffered some kind of hallucination and that nothing happened. The photographed scene does not show us a monkey climbing in space, but rather this animal peacefully seated on the shoulder of its master who is holding the rolled rope in his hand.

Verifications of this kind made foreigners incredulous. They regard these fairground fakirs with disdain and regard them as the vulgar tricksters of a credulous and backward crowd.

This opinion is questionable. It is true that the phenomena that these fakirs make onlookers see do not exist and are, for the most part, only products of collective suggestion.

But it must nevertheless be admitted that to exercise such hypnotic power over the masses these men possess an undeniable, little known and even formidable force. This unknown force is well worth studying.

I had left for India in the hope of meeting there initiates who, through a special life, had reached a high evolution giving them mastery of the elements.

I did not content myself with studying the fakirs, interesting from certain points of view. I knew that those who had reached a high degree in spiritual development were not going to pick up pennies in the midst of an astonished crowd. They had to, as in the ancient or Christian initiation, live withdrawn from the world, absorbed in the contemplation of nature and in meditation. All my searches were fruitless. The recommendations I had received from certain influential people gave the same negative results. One could not say, in short, where these initiates were, or even if they existed.

The Brahmin high priests denied the existence of any esoteric teaching outside of the current doctrines they professed. I had been advised to consult ancient texts. The latter, drowned in a mass of poetic fictions, could at a pinch contain some interesting ideas, but not exceeding the level of those which have been transmitted to us by the ancient religions. Moreover, admitting the possibility of succeeding in discovering some truths in these heaps of manuscripts, it would have been necessary to be guided and to dispose of a considerable amount of time. Finally, a work of this kind carried out by a European risks being considered as a kind of sacrilege. We are no longer in Egypt where research is free, but in a living religious milieu which knows how to keep its tradition very secret.

My patient investigations having yielded no result, I took the resolution to leave mysterious India, since I had not received any of the lights I expected.

One evening, I was sitting in the garden of the bungalow where I had stayed, busy looking through a translation of the Mahabharatha, when suddenly I felt the presence of a man near me. I looked up and found myself in front of a very tall Hindu, his face adorned with a black beard. He was simply dressed, but his dress gave an impression of distinction and order. He was wearing a snow-white turban. His face seemed pale as his beard was dark and his piercing eyes seemed to penetrate the depths of my being.

He spoke to me in very pure English. His voice was soft and melodious. After a few expressions of politeness, he spoke to me more or less this way: "You shouldn't be surprised, but I know who you are and I know your intentions." You came here looking for the truth you think you will find in our religion and you are disappointed. First of all, wanting to prove to you that I am not a man to exploit your credulity, as happens quite often here, I will tell you about some important events that have occurred during your life. He gave me such evidence of his insight into my past that

I no longer doubted this character for whom nothing was hidden.

We talked until nightfall and my interlocutor showed amazing erudition. For the next two weeks we met every day. He had extensive knowledge of all ancient and current religions. He quoted whole pages of the Old Testament which found their echo in Vedic texts, just as he commented in the light of the Gospel on obscure passages of the doctrine of Buddha.

He brought together in a harmonious synthesis all the religions to reconstitute the radiant edifice of truth, each of which represents only a fragment, a stone.

These days spent together, these long walks together in a magical landscape, walks during which he made me understand the voice of nature and read in the book of eternal life, these hours are among the happiest of my spiritual life.

How old could this man have been to possess this immense erudition, to have seen so much, traveled so much and meditated so much?

He looked like he was just over forty. Not a gray hair, sparkling eyes, a face without wrinkles. His countenance and silhouette were simple and noble at the same time. Of a gentle character and always equal, he was interested in all the phenomena of life and seemed to penetrate deeply into its manifestations. The vegetable kingdom and its multiple uses, the language of animals which seemed to be familiar to him, the physical and chemical laws of mineral nature... in a word, the physiology of the Cosmos, everything seemed to be known to him. He had searched every corner of human knowledge. And all his answers to the questions I asked him, all his explanations shone with a clarity, with a faith that I have rarely encountered... The ascetics of Mount Athos alone could be compared to him, but with them, Faith replaced knowledge and their wisdom came from this Faith, while with him, each word revealed an enormous erudition, erudition which had determined an unshakable faith at the same time as certainty.

The days passed and it seemed to me that our meeting dated from the day before. My conceptions had changed and new horizons stretched out before my eyes.

I would have liked to stay with him, become his disciple, learn indefinitely, in order to assimilate part of his knowledge. But the times were over and we had to part ways.

The day before this separation, during our usual walk, he said to me: "Several times you have asked me to give you tangible proof of the powers over nature of a man of lively faith and whose intentions are pure. Let us remember the words of Christ: "If you command this mountain to move, to throw itself into the sea, you will not be able to

doubt your word and it will be done according to your order”. You have seen all kinds of phenomena produced by the fakirs who direct your imagination according to their fancy. This opinion is well founded for most of these phenomena, but there are some which are of an entirely different order.

Your desire for control is commendable since it is not based on banal curiosity. This confirmation is likely to strengthen your faith by giving a basis to your knowledge.

Tomorrow, after sunrise, come to the large terrace and you will be satisfied. Take your Kodak with you.

The next day I found myself at the place indicated. From this terrace one enjoyed a magnificent view of the plain. More than once I had contemplated the spectacle of this nature so beautiful and so seductive.

On the balustrade that surrounded the terrace were placed several large vases about five feet high and filled with water. My friend was waiting for me, squatting on a step, and greeted me with an affectionate gesture:

“Look at these vases filled with water, he said to me, check them, make sure that it is water, plunge your hands into them, let it flow”. I obeyed and washed my hands and face. The water was pure and fresh.

“Now you will see what you asked me. Exercise strict control so as to leave no room for doubt, especially when I will no longer be at your side and your memory will reconstruct the picture you will have seen”.

He got up and slowly approached the vase that I had just left, stopped about ten paces from it, staring at it for a few moments and holding out his hand in its direction. His gaze suddenly lit up with a supernatural fire and a strange pallor covered his face. The vase swayed and leaned slowly toward him, pivoting on its foot until he was lying horizontally on the terrace. Not a drop of water escaped and the surface of the liquid continued to remain perpendicular to the axis of the container!

I photographed the scene from the front and from the side. I approached to touch the surface of this water which, only a few moments earlier, had been liquid and normal. To the touch, the strange impression is impossible to convey with words; no doubt the appearances had remained the same and my hand plunged into this water as easily as before, but it no longer flowed. It had become gelatinous and I withdrew my hand which was absolutely dry. Stunned, I turned to my friend. He was still in the same position, his hand pointing towards the vase. At the same time, I felt a current of indescribable strength emanating from his whole person and from his eyes in particular. He made a gesture of relaxation and, slowly, the vase rose and resumed its usual position.

Moved and struck with admiration, I threw myself at the master's feet. He picked me up gently and said, "You saw what you

wanted to see and now you are convinced. Go and realize that the water is always the same. The slightest doubt must not shake your conviction.

The water had returned to normal; I fervently drank a sip...

I wanted to express to him my state of mind in the face of this miracle, but he stopped me.

“The miracle cannot exist for man. God alone can produce it. The nature that surrounds us only exists in appearance. It is the result of various combinations of forces that can be oriented in one direction or another, with a view to producing this or that phenomenon. Among these forces is thought, the power of which is unknown to most. Concentrated and directed in a certain way, it can modify the laws which govern matter and give rise to manifestations which seem supernatural.

“Unconsciously, man sometimes feels the strength that is within him emerge. The goal to be achieved consists in being able to concentrate this force and direct it according to one's will”.

When, with understandable excitement, I developed my plates, I clearly saw the picture appear as it has just been described.

But one thing that I hadn't noticed during the experiment appeared on the gelatin. On the vertical surface of the water, as in a mirror, was reflected the imperious figure of my initiator.

Years passed. I had kept these precious photographs among the objects to which I attached great value. Many friends have seen them, they were even projected on the screen during a lecture I gave to a restricted circle.

The unfortunate events that followed the Great War brought about with my ruin the loss of a library containing valuable manuscripts and the photographs just mentioned.

Perhaps all of this is not lost forever.

This story speaks for itself. Once again, I had approached envoys from another “focus of light”.

## THE MASTER

It is said in the Talmud : “Choose yourself a Master” (Pirque aboth 1.6) and the Commentator adds: “Let him get a single Master and always receive from him the traditional teaching; that he does not receive this teaching today from one master, tomorrow from another”. This observation is full of common sense, because it is the only way to pursue such a complicated and difficult study as that of the Kabbalah.

A Master cannot claim to possess the truth alone and that all outside him follow erroneous paths. No. Integral truth is not accessible to humans who, moreover, cannot understand it. Jesus himself, to Pontius Pilate's question: "What is truth?" was silent, unable to reveal this mystery, unintelligible to men.

Countless roads lead to that supreme goal which is called truth. This is comparable to a high mountain which can be climbed from different points. The one who climbs on one side will not see the one who walks on the other and yet the two travelers, continuing their walk to the end, will have to meet on the summit. Spiritual evolution can be compared to this ascent, the means varying infinitely to achieve a single goal. The various methods may present contradictions but, I repeat, lead to the same ends. Thus, one teaching recommends the study of the harmonies of nature to manage to conceive the emanating hearth while another will direct his disciples towards this hearth by a strictly spiritual culture.

The infinitely large and the infinitely small merge. They are both but Infinity seen from two different angles, and the roads leading to the Goal are opposite, given the dissimilarity of points of view. Initiation by the infinitely small will seem to contradict that by the infinitely large. Thus, a seeker who takes one path, then abandons it to take another will never arrive at a satisfactory result and will always vegetate in doubt. It will, however, have started with faith and a sincere desire to progress. Passing from one teaching to another, he risks losing confidence and finally having the impression that all doctrines are tainted with falsity and error.

It is like raising a child in different religions at the same time, inculcating contradictory principles. We would certainly make him an unbeliever, an atheist. The mature man fashioned in a single dogma can, at a given moment, modify it by adapting it to his personal conceptions, analyze it, retain or reject what seems to him true or false, but he retains an indestructible faith.

A layman in the field of ancient wisdom is like the child. It is difficult for him to differentiate the true from the false, he is seduced by the attraction of mystery and driven by a vain curiosity; it floats from one bank to the other, deprived of direction and totally incapable of discussing facts and procedures. At this moment, the thirst for knowledge, instead of favoring evolution, becomes a real danger which disorients him and causes him to fall into a vicious circle.

Finally, alongside schools that aim for the same spiritual goal, there are teaching centers that work consciously to achieve a deep evolution of the divine spark in matter. Their methods and the promises that accompany them are obviously more seductive than those of the true doctrine. Now, the Master is indispensable and, moreover, he must be unique. He will orient the disciple towards the supreme goal by making him follow a path in harmony with his individuality. He will also indicate to him the other roads which lead to the goal, the contradictions which they present in appearance although leading to identical results. He will put him on his guard against the pitfalls scattered on his way; he will support him in dangerous places or near precipices; finally, he will defend it against possible attacks by harmful forces.

Without a Master, initiation is impossible. It is not enough to read even all that has been written; if so, the sincere neophyte would run the risk of falling into confusion. There is one thing that must never be forgotten, and that is that no book contains the essential, that is, what constitutes the true Kabbalah, the chain that binds the Master to the pupil, which is transmitted from hand to hand, by word of mouth. Very often the Master, with a single word, illuminates an apparently vague or insignificant passage which, considered from this new point of view, takes on a deep meaning, sometimes capable of totally changing the orientation of a book.

“If you want to receive initiation, choose a master for yourself, and follow him with confidence and faith”. Never forget that in the most banal and seemingly insignificant things, one can always find a germ or a reflection of the truth; but you have to know how to find it.

## MAGIC

One will certainly find it strange to write about an ancient science which provokes a smile of contempt in the man of the XX<sup>th</sup> century.

"What is magic?" " he will say, shrugging his shoulders, "it's non-existent, we once believed in it, when the peoples were plunged into the darkness of superstitions. In our century, when popular science illuminates the cottage of the poor and rationally explains all the phenomena of nature, how can we speak seriously of magic? »

This judgment, as haughty as it is modern, proceeds from ignorance.

In the following lines, I will try to throw some light on this question that cultivated men who think they know everything do not even bother to study.

The word magic derives from the word "magueia" which, in turn, comes from the Chaldean word "maghdim" high wisdom. The root "Mag" preserved in Aramaic is related to Mogh (Megh, from the ancient Pehlvi language) which means: high priest, sage. Thus, in the phonetics of the word, common to most ancient languages, we see emerging the idea of the highest wisdom united with that of the priesthood.

The magician was not only the holder of high wisdom but also the hierophant realizing his knowledge in action. He had acquired a perfect knowledge of the creative forces of nature and, consequently, the power to act on these forces by modifying their combinations at will.

The first arcana of the old Tarot which represents "The Magus" symbolizes this power by the four elements of the minor arcana which are in front of him. The scepter he holds high is the sign of the power he draws from above to manifest it below, which he specifies by the index finger of the hand which remains free, directed towards the ground. On a cubic stone we see laid out: a sword, sign of struggle, offensive weapon, a shekel, sign of acquired value or protective pantacle, and a cup where the mixing of forces takes place.

The very definition of the word magic indicates that this science requires: 1) extensive studies to acquire complete knowledge of the constructive forces of nature; 2) a special training of the will in order to dominate these forces. These two conditions—as we can see—are intimately linked.

Just as to study physics or chemistry, it is not enough to learn formulas by heart, one must also engage in experiments. On the other hand, experimenting without knowing it cannot yield any usable results, it can even present certain dangers.

I took this example to make my thinking clearer, but magic cannot be compared to any of our academic sciences, because its domain includes not only physical forces, but above all the forces that are called supernatural and that our scientists contemporaries systematically want to ignore. Religion recognizes them, makes them an article of faith, and abhors any connection with magic. I will come back to this question but, for the moment, allow me to recall that the rites of the Christian religion with their fumigations, modulations of prayers and determined gestures are of magical origin and that their purpose is to provoke vibrations in the higher planes.

Before approaching the study of magic, the man must have all the human sciences. The knowledge of things of a physical order is essential to undertake the study of invisible things, just as primary and secondary education are essential to those who want to approach the courses of the faculties. One cannot learn literature before knowing how to read, nor trigonometry without knowing the four rules.

Magic is the science of the word, of the action of the Principle with a view to creating the vital manifestation. As a result, it requires in-depth knowledge of the vibratory forces of sound on the one hand, of gesture on the other, elements which translate into hieroglyphics on the material plane. Readers familiar with the works I have published know that the letter, in the primitive sacred language, represented by its hieroglyph the combination of creative forces which were actuated and applied in a certain way to create the desired phenomenon. From this point of view, these letters differed completely from the characters of our phonetic alphabets, whose sound is empty and without force, the design, a simple convention. Each letter of the sacred language represented a key and whoever determined its meaning knew what forces were thus symbolized. So that by combining these different keys, he associated the creative forces at will, by acting in the world of the forces of the Astral.

Religion can obtain an identical result by provoking, through the rite, in the physical world, vibrations of which it is unaware of the essence, whereas it believes it directly provokes supernatural phenomena. The rites, sanctified by time and reinforced by the faith of millions of humans, are, as I have said elsewhere, of magical origin. But the difference is

what religion *believes* and magic *knows*.

The starting point is different, but the goal and the results are the same. What the believer can obtain by faith, the magician obtains by his knowledge. These means, however different they may be, give man supreme power. It is said in the Gospel that he who in faith commands the mountain to throw itself into the sea and has no doubts about the force of his word, will perform a miracle and upset all natural laws or laws considered as such. — Modern science does not admit the possibility of such phenomena, and yet they are produced as much by knowledge as by faith.

The two routes followed are equally difficult for man. Undoubtedly, integral faith gives Wisdom and Power, as the knowledge of causes confers certainty and power. In both cases, moral discipline, complete self-control and absolute purity are essential to achieve the goal one has set for oneself.

The ignorance of these rules creates in the religious field the unbelievers whose prayer loses all force, in the field of magic the black magician, or sorcerer, whose action only evokes the harmful forces that he does not know how to control. and which will turn against him. While the white magician, by the purity of his intentions, penetrates his conscious will and sharpened like a steel blade into the higher planes and changes at will the balance of the constructive forces, the sorcerer, ignorant and perverse, offers to evil forces a sacrifice of matter charged with vital fluids (blood, sperm, etc.) in order to attract them and obtain a supernatural phenomenon. Now, the Magus, worthy of the name, rises on the spiritual scale and participates in the life of our world, while the sorcerer falls into the lower regions, struck by the forces he has unleashed without having acquired the desired authority: consequence of his ignorance and his guilty and shameful desires.

This can make us understand the danger of some spiritist practices and the lamentable error into which those who, by these means, attempt to enter into relations with the higher plane fall.

The medium is a condenser of fluidic forces drawn from the chain of assistants and which allow him on our plane to manipulate certain forces and, sometimes, entities of the higher plane. Most of these mediums are completely ignorant and draw from their supernormal sensibility a material yield intended to increase their well-being.

How is the chain of which I have just spoken created? After a good meal and copious libations, happy guests jaded on all the usual distractions decide to experience new sensations tinged with the supernatural, rare emotions which they will make hot throats. Medium and assistance pursue an undignified goal by deplorable means and whose results are certainly harmful or uncertain. All these manifestations of so-called entities which often appear under historical guises are only imaginative creations materialized by the vital fluid emanating from the medium. The different

phenomena of levitation, of contribution, are the only ones which present any interest. However, they cannot be considered in any way as a manifestation of “spirits” but rather as the effects of natural forces still unknown to man and whose realization is only possible through the intermediary of the medium. It is certainly rare for an entity from the invisible to manifest itself in such sessions. If the case occurs, we can be sure to have to deal with a larva attracted by the fluid of the medium on which it feeds. Contact with a being of this category cannot be profitable; it is rather to be feared. The trials of succubi and incubi with which the stories of the Middle Ages abound are far from being the reflections of an era of superstition. Witchcraft uses very simple processes to evoke beings from the Beyond, processes which do not require any special preparation. Even in the 20th <sup>century</sup>, when man believed he was freed, it was easy, with the help of certain fluids or materials, to make appear beings from the astral who would take on the appearance of humans in the flesh and in body. bone. It goes without saying that experiments of this kind, which are really dangerous, are inadvisable. It must be understood that it is impossible for me to expand further on such a subject and on the procedures used to appeal to the elementals and to attract certain readers towards a new kind of distraction. My sole purpose is to enlighten my readers and help them follow the path of evolution. However, practice is essential for those who study magic. It serves as its control and marks the stages of its volitional forces. As I have said elsewhere, it is not enough to retain formulas, one must ascertain their value, which can only be done experimentally. No matter how thoroughly one knows the theory expounded in the works bequeathed by the ancients, the essential will always escape the most attentive and scrupulous student. It is for this reason that true initiation can only be transmitted orally. The novice must be initiated by the one who, having attained power, can alone open his inner eyes as he progresses and reveal to him the secret meaning of the formulas. Finally he will have to listen to the master who, by certain graduated tests, will control the purity of the intentions and will submit it to the severe, but indispensable discipline, which must develop and intensify his will - the only means allowing him access to higher planes without danger.

We realize that such a teaching is not found in any grimoire, in any course. It is strictly individual. What one can achieve in a relatively short time, another will put his whole life to achieve. Most neophytes abandon training at the start, unable to comply with the imposed discipline. It is for these reasons that a master is indispensable and can alone judge the progress of the disciple by imposing new tasks on him and guiding him on the arduous and thorny path which leads to the goal.

This is why the various grimoires, the treatises of practical magic such as those of Eliphas Levi or Papus, despite the value they represent for an initiate, can only be harmful to a beginner. An example: it will not be enough to make a

pantacle or a talisman by applying the rules formulated in the preceding writings, to adorn them with cabbalistic signs borrowed from this documentation but, above all, to understand their value and their arrangement. Only then will we be able to realize exactly the forces set in motion by these bizarre hieroglyphs—otherwise their effect is completely nil.

To dare to provoke the imbalance of the creative forces — for all operation is only that in the final analysis — it is first necessary to know these forces and to have the precise notion of their balancing combinations. Otherwise we find ourselves in the position of a child who, unaware of how a dynamo works, will make no use of it and will put it out of order by trying to dismantle it, or even be electrocuted by this machine.

Also, I could not repeat it too often, the popularization of the mysterious science carried out by the authors who pass for being classics of the occultism, does not answer anything and even presents certain dangers. Besides, let it be well known and I affirm it, neither Papus nor Eliphas Levi, to name but a few, were true initiates, otherwise they would never have dreamed of lifting the veil which covers the mystery<sup>1</sup>.

Magic is not fun, but the highest science accessible to man and, at the same time, the millennial basis of religions. It is the source of living water revealed which gave birth to two new ones: religion and science. It contains them both. What I said above justifies the mystery that surrounded magic in ancient times. The Magus was both the high priest and the great scientist who, from the depths of his oratory, directed the progress of peoples, adapting their mentality to religious dogmas and guiding the discoveries of science in all fields. The initiatic schools of Egypt of which Moses, Pythagoras, Plato were disciples, instructed and trained young people according to their abilities. Of these, only a few managed to climb several rungs of the ladder of perfect wisdom. They then carried the torch of teaching throughout humanity, laying the foundation stone of science and religion. Thus were born Genesis and the other books of the *quinque librum* of Moses, thus were born the philosophical systems of Plato, Aristotle and other philosophers. But none of these experienced initiates revealed the practice of Magic, for this secret tradition, this Kabbalah, was to remain inviolate in the realm of mystery. It was the only way to conquer knowledge, a way as dangerous as it was inaccessible to the vast majority of humans. I recall here Plutarch's answer to those who questioned him on occult teaching: "The oath seals my mouth."

In our century, man, having received a materialistic intellectual training, disdainfully rejects any religion that cannot serve his ends. He seeks to discover new natural forces to use them for his well-being, for the destruction of his

similar... In these unfortunate conditions, the veil which conceals the ancient wisdom from view must be even thicker and the choice of those who are admitted to initiation more severe than in the past. High science is not intended for the children of the century. Not being ripe to receive it, they would not understand it; their eyes are drawn to the earth, not to the sky. As a poet said, he who is born to crawl cannot fly.

And yet the Kabbalah, an ancient tradition which contains all Wisdom in its symbols, is before their eyes, but they neither see nor hear. I have said elsewhere that magic is the wisdom of the Word. In the beginning was the Word, says Saint John the Evangelist; it is this same Word which created the Universe because "God said and it was" (Genesis). It is the Word, active emanation of the Holy Trinity, of which Hermes Trismegistus speaks in these terms: "The word of God shook the world and as it shook there appeared the innumerable manifestations of form" (Poimandres).

The creative force of the Word was lost by the primitive man after the original sin - trial which he could not undergo - but the memory and the process of this creative Word are known to the advanced man and this knowledge represents the high magic. The fumigations, the special rites are only accessories necessary for the manifestation of the Word. Certainly, after sin, man enslaved to matter *can no longer create*, but, knowing the combinations of creative forces, he can cause certain associations, *effect permutations*

However, to obtain the desired result, it is necessary to achieve a favorable atmosphere, that is to say, to choose the optimum moment by astrological research and to ensure that the light, aromatic sound waves are in harmony with the kind of planned operation and the chosen time. Finally, the operator himself must be in unison with all these various forces.

As we can see, all of this requires long and meticulous studies, absolute calm and a perfect vital balance, all things impossible for the majority of our contemporaries struggling with modern life, its demands, its pleasures.

Formerly, those who wanted to devote themselves to these works found the required atmosphere in temples and initiatory schools. There he could work, balanced in perfect calm, sheltered from the temptations of the world and guided by a master. Only then was it possible for him to achieve the supreme goal. The labor demanded is enormous, there is no need to increase it by the difficulties of present life; it requires great effort and a lot of attention because any distraction is fatal.

I said that practical magic formed the basis of all religious rites. Fumigations, symbolic gestures, sound or light vibrations are borrowed from magic. In primitive religions, sacrifices took place during ceremonies, even human sacrifices, among backward peoples. These sacrifices, originally honored in black magic (or low magic), provided the fluid necessary to cause the appearance of entities from the Beyond. These coated entities

of human appearance were used for material purposes.

Jesus Christ abolished the blood sacrifice and replaced it with communion—a sacrifice without bloodshed. However, we must not forget that the wine, in the Christian mass, symbolizes the blood, and the bread, the flesh. Thus the link uniting Christianity to the religions that preceded it is found in sacrifice. High magic called "white magic" suppresses blood in its operations, but the symbol of sacrifice is still observed by the mixture of the four elements: sprinkling by water, purification by fire and sanctification by sulfur and salt. Relying on the knowledge of these elements, the magician, by his will, enters the plane of forces and, by his prayer, into the higher plane. Its goal is not the search for material phenomena, but to approach the spiritual light. Exteriorization, exits into the astral, bilocations cannot constitute goals for the magician, as is generally believed, but only obligatory means or accessories. Mages will never meet in theaters or public squares competing with jugglers who earn their living.

The reader who expected to find in this short study interesting recipes or the description of implausible phenomena was mistaken. I set myself the goal, in writing these lines, to demonstrate that magic exists, that it is the highest of sciences, the only one incorporating in it all knowledge and all religions.

Let him who feels drawn to study first acquire advanced instruction in all branches of human knowledge. Let him then devote himself to meditation and the study of ancient symbols, such as the Tarots, for example. Then, if the goal he has set for himself is lofty, if his intentions are pure, *if his soul is ripe to receive the supreme teaching*, his inner eyes will see the veil lifted which covers the mystery and, at the opportune moment, the Master will come to him, without his needing to call him or look for him.

## THE BEWITCH

It seems quite strange to speak of bewitchment in our century of positivism. Indeed, man seems to have freed himself from the limits of time and space since, by radio, his thought is transmitted in an instant from one end of the world to the other.

Bewitchment is considered left behind from past centuries, from the time when the alchemist prepared his potions of love or hate in the darkness of his laboratory, where the illiterate and superstitious crowd feared the manifestations of the formidable and inhuman magician. .

In those already distant times, witches took on the forms of the wolf, ran through the countryside at night, slitting the throats of children to drink their blood...

These stories, both childish and terrifying, we do not read without smiling, since science has proven the absurdity of all superstitions to us.

However, it is not long since the work of Colonel de Rochas established the possibilities of supernatural action of one man on another, even from a distance, which is nothing other than bewitchment.

De Rochas externalized the double of one of his subjects to imbue an object with the sensibility or the vital force of this subject. As a result, this object was in close relation with the subject to the point of making him suffer cruelly according to the good pleasure of the operator.

The process of the ancients, however different, gave identical results.

To bewitch another, it was necessary first of all to obtain an object belonging to the targeted person or, better still, some waste of his body: hair, clippings of nails, a drop of blood, or all things which, detached of the human being retain for a certain time an appreciable quantity of vital fluid. The mesmer, by acting on this waste, exerted a direct action on the subject in question.

Then, by means of a special rite, he voluntarily acted on the fluids of the astral plane which he "animated with a certain

vibratory movement adequate to the astral state of the double of the being on which he decided to act. On both sides the fluids seek to bring themselves into harmony - for this is one of the principal laws of the astral plane - and thus come into contact with the double referred to. <sup>4</sup>

By his will, the magician thus brings out of balance the forces of the astral plane which can resume their normal regime only after having accomplished his desire.

Under these conditions we would all be, at every moment of our existence, threatened with occult dangers. Any individual feeling offended by us, or simply wanting to exert his harmful power, could reach us without us knowing where this sudden attack comes from.

Fortunately things are not as simple as they seem. First of all, to bring the forces of the astral out of balance and to control them, it is necessary to practice for a long time and this exercise is not within the reach of the first comer. Secondly, a human being, a stranger to the "cursed sciences" and not harming his neighbour, is naturally protected; the black ray needs a very great force to succeed in penetrating the protective enclosure. Things happen differently if the subject is in a state of hypnosis and in a relationship with the person who put him to sleep. It is for this reason that one must be very sure of a man to allow oneself to be magnetized by him. If necessary, it should not be forgotten that he becomes the absolute master of his subject on which he can exert a harmful action at will.

But bewitchment at a distance according to the old methods accounts, for various causes, for a good deal of failure. The astral forces out of balance naturally seek to find it again and, unable to carry out the desired act, return to their starting point by striking the one who has modified their normal state. This is called backlash. To deal with the latter, the sorcerers had imagined, in case of failure of the operation, to move this shock, either on another person, or on an animal, or even on a plant. This complicated the operation and, moreover, did not always give the expected result.

As we can see, these practices are very dangerous and should not be undertaken, even for harmless purposes or simple curiosity. Wizards of old used wax figurines bearing a certain resemblance to the subject (dagyres). They incorporated into the material used a fragment of the victim's body (hair, teeth, excrement, etc.) The maneuver consisted of pricking this figurine with a needle, exposing it to fire, then burying it with a special ritual.

Nowadays, country sorcerers are familiar with these operations and sometimes recommend them to clients who want to satisfy revenge. I once knew a woman who, desiring revenge on a fickle lover, approached a sorcerer and, on the latter's advice, performed this ancient ritual almost without modification. She had, to be in the note of the day

and progress, substituted a photograph for the wax doll, but she had forgotten neither the hair, nor the pin, nor, either, the ritual burial.

I do not know what result this experiment gave.

Here is a personal case whose effects were surprising: I was very young and, in the company of two friends, I devoted myself to the study of the occult sciences. What interested us the most, obviously, was the mysterious side of the phenomenon.

We decided to carry out a spell experiment whose subject would be one of us, chosen by lot. The other two would be the operators. The patient was a friend of mine. We took his photograph which was provided with a lock of his hair. Since we meant him no harm, we contented ourselves with pricking his left arm, observing the accepted ritual. The usual astrological conditions had been scrupulously observed.

Our friend did not seem to be affected by the maneuver that we continued with perseverance... On the third day, he fell from his horse and broke his left arm, just where we had taken his photograph... Caught out of fear, we abandoned the experiment. Were we faced with a coincidence? She was very strange... Since then, I haven't bothered with bewitchment...

In India, instead of acting on the wax doll, we act on the shadow of the man: we strike it with a dagger which is left behind when the victim leaves the place where she was; as the weapon is withdrawn, the man falls, mortally wounded.

In a century as "advanced" as ours, let us see that things happen that science does not suspect or that it is content to record with a contemptuous smile...

## THE ASTRAL CLICHE

By astral snapshot is meant the formation in the world of forces or *astral*, of the elements of an event which later materializes in the visible world.

The astral is the soul of the Universe. The human being, before performing an act, forms it in the conscious region of the soul; likewise the instinctive acts originate in the subconscious.

Man (microcosm) being the prototype of the Universe (macrocosm), the conception of an act takes place in the astral. Thus all events leave an imprint in this last plane. We understand how clairvoyant or hypersensitive beings can see or hear things that seem supernatural: premonition, vision in the past, psychometry. We can also explain the feelings of anguish or oppression that agitate certain particularly sensitive subjects in a place where a murder or suicide has taken place.

Photography, which has nothing mysterious or occult for our contemporaries, is indisputable proof of what I have just said. A picture covered with a sensitive film reproduces exactly the image of a scene in front of which it was exposed.

It is necessary to consider any object as a photographic plate which it is a question of knowing how to develop to obtain the reproduction of the event which took place in front of it.

There are people endowed with special faculties enabling them to see reproduced before their inner eyes the events whose imprint is fixed on any object, an invisible imprint for a normal subject; I named the psychometers.

Science recognizes them and studies them, justice sometimes uses them to be informed about obscure or very difficult cases.

I have met several of these sensitives endowed with remarkable second sight. The Englishman Peters, who gave psychometric sessions a few decades ago, had given me undeniable proof of the gift he possessed. Here's how he did it. Someone among the assistants gathered in a handkerchief objects belonging to various people present. the

medium did not know, of course, who possessed them. He took these objects one by one and, after a few moments of contact, he designated the owner and then told the story.

During a session, I entrusted her with an old ring whose history I knew. He described with precision and in a moving manner the drama in which this jewel had been involved. His story, very lively, really took on the value of a testimony. This is only one example among the hundred that I could cite, having heard psychometric mediums many times.

We all have, more or less pronounced, a sixth sense that we just need to develop in ourselves to reach this curious faculty which, in some, is innate.

By way of example I am going to relate some personal facts which prove that I was able to see or feel the astral image without being a psychometric medium.

I. — I was 16 then and spent the holidays with my parents in the country. One evening, I felt a strange uneasiness, the cause of which escaped me. I was not suffering but I felt a kind of anguish which was going gradually. I did not know what to become. This state had lasted for four hours, when suddenly, at ten o'clock, I had the very distinct sensation of an inner voice telling me that an uncle whom I loved very much had just died. This sensation took on such a character of certainty that on going to bed I asked the servant to give me a telegram which would arrive during the night and not to disturb my parents. Around 2 o'clock in the morning the telegram was brought announcing the death of my uncle. By day, we were all leaving to attend his funeral. His relatives told us that he went into agony around 6 o'clock in the afternoon and that he had breathed his last at 10 o'clock in the evening.

In the meantime, he had had fits of suffocation and had been transported, on a wheelchair, to the end of a long gallery which linked one wing of the castle to the central building. It was there that death had surprised him.

On the evening of my arrival at the chateau, in order to reach my room, I had to pass through the gallery in question, lit by the moon then at its full. When I got to the place where the wheelchair was, I saw my uncle, in his dressing gown, sitting on the seat, very pale and his head bent forward. I saw him clearly and very closely; no doubt was possible. I was scared and I ran away.

The imprint of this man was therefore very visible at the very place where his last hours of suffering had passed.

II. — A few years later, I was hunting in a region quite far from my home, so much so that, when evening arrived, I

could think of going home.

I asked a small owner to take me in. He welcomed me very kindly. I washed in the room that had been assigned to me and then I went to the dining room where my host and his family were.

As I crossed the antechamber, I suddenly experienced a horrible sensation. I looked around me, I saw nothing but I clearly felt someone at my side. I was so impressed that on entering the dining room I could not hide my confusion. Questioned by my host, I could not conceal the reason from him. He expressed his surprise to me and told me that about fifteen years before, brigands, during his absence, had murdered an old servant at the very place I pointed out to him.

This example can be seen as a sensation of the astral snapshot or the presence of the very entity attached to the scene of the crime.

Finally, the following case proves that the event is formed in the astral before materializing on the physical plane. This is the case in dreams which very often have as an extension, on waking, facts which come true.

III. “This was long after. I was then working with a group, studying sensitive people. That evening, five or six of us were experimenting with a clairvoyant medium who described the aura and the double of the people present. Suddenly he said that all the doubles had been scared and were each performing different and characteristic movements.

No sooner had he finished his descriptions than a tremendous explosion was heard; all of us then repeated exactly the movements he had observed. A bomb thrown by criminals had exploded very close to the house where our session took place.

What is amazing in this example is that unconsciously we repeated the typical movements of each of our doubles.

I could cite many personal examples, but the scope of this article is necessarily very limited.

Nevertheless, I will cite one last very characteristic fact. I did not witness it, but I verified its authenticity.

For many years, the neighboring inhabitants of the castle of Reynaholen, near Begnanolm in Sweden, had observed a singular phenomenon. On sunny days, one could very distinctly see the face of one of the former owners, Major Gyllenscrops, who died in 1859. This officer, who had become crippled, had spent 40 years sitting in an armchair behind this window. The examination of the glass made by Dr. Mohlim, a Swedish scientist, demonstrated that there had been a slow decomposition of the constituent elements of the glass which, by a sort of reflection of the illuminated face, had

gradually developed like a photographic cliché.

This example speaks for itself and confirms what I said at the beginning of this short study.

On the other hand, I had the opportunity to observe that animals are much more sensitive than humans to impressions from beyond. Almost all of them are endowed with the sixth sense, they are, so to speak, *clairvoyant*. These kinds of observations will form the subject of an article on the sentience of animals. As a general rule, it can be said that the dog, the cat and even the horse are more impressed than the man by the astral snapshot. Often they accuse the presence of an entity of the invisible whereas the man does not see anything.

Note that the dog and the horse show fear and seem to seek the protection of their master. On the other hand, the cat seems happy and goes purring to meet the ghostly manifestation.

Maeterlinck, in his piece "l'Oiseau Bleu", realized this particularity. But, I repeat, this subject is vast and will be the subject of future work.

## THE WISDOM OF AROMA

The tangible phenomena of nature are perceived by our five senses: touch, sight, hearing, smell and taste.

Science regards these phenomena as varying vibrations affecting our physical organs and transmitted through nerves to different centers in the brain.

The location of the latter seems to be determined by our current anatomical knowledge. As for the origin of the vibrations and their nature, we are reduced to hypotheses.

Occultists also have taken up the question and have been able to classify some of the phenomena according to the effects observed on man.

We know the classification of colors and sounds by the range resulting from the spectral decomposition and by that of the seven musical notes.

Current science, armed with very precise means of experimentation, has established that in addition to the seven known colors there are others whose vibrations are not registered by the eye, such as infrared and ultraviolet. We can admit that the number of these vibrations is indefinite.

Same observation with regard to the notes in the innumerable scales whose vibrations are too frequent or too long to be picked up by man's natural radio, hearing.

There is a link between these phenomena of a different order, and the sound wave can be transformed at a certain moment into a visual wave.

A great Russian musician, Scriabin, had glimpsed this relationship when he wrote his last work, "*Prometheus*": at the moment when, his hero having conquered fire, the composer reached the peak of his inspiration, music alone revealed itself powerless to express his thoughts. To obviate this insufficiency of musical sonorities, he sought to bring in a light effect; death surprised him during the development of a special device that was to realize his aesthetic design.

But let's look at things from the perspective of occult science:

Man is composed of three elements: spirit, soul, body (Nechama, Rouach, and Nephesh of the Kabbalah), which correspond respectively: 1°) to the superior, spiritual part, the divine spark; 2°) to the middle, instinctive, balancing part (the living soul of Genesis), and 3°) to the lower, sensitive, subconscious part, which directs the functioning of the vegetative life of the being and by which it makes contact with the physical world.

According to this classification, the lower senses are touch and taste, although the latter is to some extent influenced by smell and sight, which places it in a higher sphere.

According to the Kabbalah, touch and taste belong to the domain of the letter *Mem* (bowels and external organs).

Through touch, we become aware of the shape and state of an object. Through taste, harmful elements are removed from food. The other three senses (sight, hearing, smell) belong to the domain of the letter *Shin* and to that of Ruach, perhaps even, in part, to that of *Nechamah*.

Of these three senses, the highest is that of smell.

I will try to prove this superiority, but as it is very little known and escapes scientific investigation, I can only deal with this meaning in a summary way.

Sight reveals to man the external form of the object, its coloring. Visual memory evokes the sight of a place or an object and reconstructs its image before the inner eye of man.

The action of this sense is superior to that of touch, because it perceives not only form, but also color.

Musical vibrations evoke memories of a higher order, that which touches the strings of the soul. They cause happy or sad emotions.

One determined music can resonate with a man and another leave him cold.

However, these impressions will be of a quite different nature from those of the other senses. I know music lovers who, under the influence of Wagner's music, lose all sense of time and space and only regain consciousness of the middle when the last note dies.

But it is above these senses that the sense of smell is placed.

An aroma, an odor suddenly awakens in man the memory not of an object, as happens with the other senses, but of the state of mind in which the subject was when he perceived this perfume. for the first time. It is not the evocation of the place or the object that occurs, but that of the feeling that dominated the subject.

The memory caused by smell is the most intense, the most luminous. Those who come from the other senses escort him and the picture of the past is thus reconstituted in full clarity at the same time as the emotions that accompanied it.

It is extremely rare that a reminiscence coming from another sense evokes one belonging to the sense of smell. The opposite happens, and the olfactory memory suddenly illuminates all the elements that contribute to the reconstruction of the picture.

There is therefore no doubt that the sense of smell occupies the first place among our senses. It is almost impossible to define it, because it is of an order which exceeds the range of words. It belongs to a higher dimension that we perceive, but which remains outside of any classification.

From this point of view, it is similar to the higher domain of Ruach, perhaps even to that of *Nechamah*.

This is why the ancients reserved a primordial place for perfumes and fumigations. The fumes of the aromatics rose straight towards the sky and through them contact was established between the Supreme Being and the incarnates.

In its ceremonies, the Christian Church has preserved these fumigations. The first Apostles understood its importance in prayer, perfume acting as a real stimulant in the exteriorization of the soul. These practices have fallen into oblivion, the Church is unaware of the range of different aromatics appropriate to certain circumstances and has retained only the use of incense. <sup>5</sup>

Now let us see what the Kabbalah says about the sense of smell.

We know that the latter is governed by the letter *Noun* <sup>6</sup> whose numeral value is 50 and which corresponds to Scorpio in the zodiac world.

The major arcana which corresponds to it is the *Genius of man* whose meaning in the upper world is the perpetual movement of life and, in the physical world, the combinations of the forces of nature.

Curious remark: the name of the nose — organ of smell — begins with an N in almost all languages (nez, naze, nose, nos...) Similarly, the French word nostrils has a consonant relationship with its Hebrew synonym : *Nehiraim*.

Number of words mean both finest aroma, divination, spiritual and start with *Noun* . <sup>7</sup>

This multiple meaning is explained, since it is through the organ of smell that respiration also takes place and that enters the lungs the air necessary for the life of the *Nephesh* as well as the perfume which seems essential to the *Nechamah* life .

Let's not forget that, according to a Hindu legend, “the aroma of the flower is the soul of the plant that emerges at the most beautiful moment of its life”. However, to ensure our physical existence, we use the body of the plants (food of *Nephesh*);

would not their soul be the essential food for Nechamah? It's to do...

may, Tarôme is a vital emanation of the flower at the height of its growth. An unpleasant, foul odor is generally a sign of death, of putrefaction.

We find here the vivifying and pleasant harmony, analogous to that of music or colors, and chaos or cacophony, which symbolize the disorder of death.

Another interesting remark: it is recalled that the Kabbalah attributes to each nostril a different letter which has a particular meaning.

At the right nostril: the *Daleth*, whose correspondences are: Jupiter, in the planetary world, the number 4 and the Major Arcana, the Cubic Stone, arcana of realization.

At the left nostril: the *Resch*, corresponding to Saturn, the number 200 and the Tarot "The Awakening of the Dead", spiritual renewal of life.

At first sight, it seems strange that to the two parts of the same organ, whose functions seem identical, one attributed two letters of such different meanings although they are related from the hieroglyphic point of view.

Here is the explanation given to me by a Master: "When you come to be able to breathe by inhaling through one nostril and exhaling through the other, you will have climbed an important step on the infinite ladder of progress. »

First of all, I did not understand the meaning of these words, believing more in a metaphor than in something realizable.

Later, by studying the letters cabbalistically, I understood what the Master meant, namely: that for the man destined to reach a certain height of evolution, it was essential to control his physiological functions in order to remain in harmony with the laws of nature.

The Hindus demonstrate to us the possibility of this control by provoking at will anesthesia and even apparent death by the suspension of their bodily functions.

The letter *Daleth* presents the idea of exhalation; chemically it is the carbonic acid and the nitrogen which are used for the construction of the visible nature (Cubic Stone). <sup>8</sup>

On the other hand, the letter *Resch* presents the idea of inhalation, of renewal; chemically it is the oxygen essential to the maintenance of physical life (Awakening of the Dead). <sup>9</sup>

Unfortunately, we are very little documented on these essential questions. Perhaps we belong to a lower plane which does not yet allow us to approach it?

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Unfortunately, we are very little documented on these essential questions. Perhaps we belong to a lower plane which does not yet allow us to approach it?

There is a range of fumigations and perfumes that the Magi had adapted to the other known ranges.<sup>10</sup> This nomenclature of aromatics has been transmitted to us by various authors with contradictions and errors, fatal consequences of an insufficient evolution which does not allow us to understand the true “Wisdom of aroma”.

## FORMATION OF AN EGREGORE

### INTRODUCTION

Man is a complex being: two opposing principles compose him, two principles which are in constant struggle. One is the physical body, exhibiting the perfection of the animal species which, parts of a primitive individual differing little from the evolved plant, have gradually improved.

Through this physical body, man belongs to Nature; it constitutes only a fragment of it, but the most perfect, the crowning achievement of the work of Creation. When the time came for man to appear on earth, that is to say when Creation reached its apogee, God, as Genesis teaches, decided to create a being in His image. He thus fashioned the Adamic element, composing of raw materials the bodily part of this being, then, in the body thus formed, He breathed Life and endowed man with the principle of reason and that of free will.

The breath of life which we call "soul" serves as a link between the two opposing principles: the material body and the spirit. Every living animal on earth possesses, in addition to its bodily part, a "living soul" (Genesis, I. 30); but what differs man from any other created being is the presence in him of the divine particle, of the spirit which is his reason and his free will. Thus, the animal is a binary being, composed of the body and the "living soul", while the man is a ternary being, formed of these two elements to which is joined the Divine Spirit.

Just as Nature which, by its continual work of perfection, prepares the bodily part of man, the animal, by developing successively through the species, prepares the psychic part which will serve as an envelope for the coming spirit. incarnate in the material body. All the functioning of the body of man is done according to the laws of Nature, which contemporary science designates under the name of physical, chemical, caloric laws, etc. This work is carried out without the intervention of the body. mind and without the latter being aware of it.

The spirit has a perfectly established dwelling in the body, the regular functioning of which should not preoccupy it. It is the subconscious (from the lower parts of one's soul) that monitors and directs the work of the natural forces.

The role of the spirit is to direct the acts of man, to direct this complex being towards perfection and the predestined evolution.

It is reason which understands and establishes the goal which man must attain in his evolutionary ascent, and it is his agency which must transform the concepts of reason into action. On his way, the latter encounters obstacles: laziness, the attraction of the passions which try to stop his evolutionary movement and bog man down in matter. It is the "Tempting Serpent" of Genesis that metaphorically represents these passions and temptations of the body. It is he who acts on free will (Aisha, the spiritual woman according to Genesis), and who dragged down reason (Aish, the spiritual man) to bog it down in matter. Thus were lost by man paradise, happiness and peace. In the existences that followed, he had to fight in tears and sweat the bodily temptations (the snake), and tame his passions in order to find Paradise lost.

Instead of having followed the path indicated by the Creator, the path of evolution in which the spirit must win the victory over matter - the path that leads to Good and Happiness - man took the opposite path, he allowed the forces of Nature to subjugate his reason, he got bogged down in matter, he plunged into evil and sadness.

Ever since he has existed, man has struggled under the influence of matter. The religions, which have preserved the primitive idea of the good, strive to bring it on the path of evolution; their voices call him in vain, "they cry out in the desert." The cult of the body and materialism are too strong, the temptations too strong, the passions too exacting.

The result is before our eyes. What has the materialism of our time brought us, if not suffering, hatred, general discontent?...

Bad guides try to give humanity new ideals to replace innate principles. But these leaders are only "wolves in sheep's skin", and their doctrines, a mask under which hides the grimace of the devil.

Take for example Christianity and Communism. Many consider that the latter professes the same principles as the former. Poor naive people, they do not see that Communism covers itself with the mask of the sheep to hide its wolf face.

The beautiful precept of Christ who said "give", Communism has replaced it by the cruel "take"!

The result is the same, it will be said. Yes, but not for the one who gives nor for the one who takes. It is the tone that makes the song; now, one is the voice of charity, a teaching which elevates man; the other is the doctrine of evil which makes man a beast

ferocious and retards its evolutionary progress by plunging it into the depths of matter and darkness.

The idea of God is innate in man, it is what differentiates him from the highest animal.

Reason, a divine plot, has preserved this notion of the Center from which it was an emanation, a Center which, in its memory, remains Light and absolute Good. This notion has always been confirmed by various religious dogmas. The most backward savage himself addresses a prayer to a Superior Being whom he does not know, but whose presence he senses, to grant him a good hunt. Then, his prayer having been answered, he thanks this Unknown Being for his benefit by sacrificing to him the best part of his game.

By observing the world around him, by broadening his knowledge and his intelligence, primitive man begins to adore the phenomena of Nature, those to which he attributes the granted benefits. Thus was born the first worship, that of the Sun, this beneficial star. Its daily appearance and disappearance taught man the eternal renewal of life.

Just as the sun, having completed its diurnal course, disappears on the horizon, man knows that he will have to die one day but, just as the star, infallibly, will rise the next day as glorious as the day before, man knows that he will rise again immediately after his death. Remains found in the oldest tombs prove that ancient people, tens of thousands of years ago, believed in afterlife and resurrection.

Progressing hand in hand with the development of human intelligence, the religions of antiquity created an increasingly complicated ritual at the base of which was the imitation of the phenomena of Nature, which man learned to observe and understand. .

Many deities populated the pantheon, each playing a determined role in the rite and symbolizing one of the phenomena of Nature. This pantheon was indispensable to the masses, who needed concrete things that they could adore, abstractions not yet being within reach of their understanding.

But we must not believe that the elite, that those who led the masses in their religious exercises, were satisfied with the adoration of these god-phenomena. This belief would be erroneous, and it is precisely because our scholars approach the study of ancient religions (such as, for example, that of Ancient Egypt) with this preconceived idea, that they cannot understand them and treat them childishness or superstition.

It would be wrong to consider Christianity as a pantheistic religion, judging it according to the images and statues of the various saints that the Catholic religion venerates. These images do not represent divinities, but only serve to facilitate the concentration of thought which otherwise, in the man of the people, would wander around without being able to concentrate in prayer.

The ancient peoples, or at least their crowds, were of a lower spiritual or cultural level than ours and it can be assumed that some sincerely believed that an idol was indeed a deity. On the other hand, the Initiates, those who instituted and performed the rite, had modes of belief analogous to those of contemporary religions.

Egypt is the cradle of Western religions, as it is that of philosophical schools. We have proof that all the great Greek philosophers had drawn their knowledge from the initiatic schools of Egypt. Moses, the founder of the Hebrew religion, was also initiated into Egyptian temples. (Acts VII, 22).

Osiris, the Sacrificial God, the one who rises eternally, was "the Shadow of the Crucified", as Merezhkovsky says in his remarkable study *The Mystery of the Three*. "I called my Son out of Egypt," says God the Father, and the Son says "he did not come to contradict the law, but to confirm it. (Matt., V, 17.)

Finally, the religious texts of ancient Egypt teach us that the beginning of the world was "when Ra rose above the surface of the water". (Book of the Dead, ch. XVII).

But the meaning of the name Ra is simultaneously: the Sun God and the Word. Thus we find the link between the teaching of Moses (the Bereschit of Genesis) and that of Saint John (In the beginning was the Word).

Ancient religions, such as that of Egypt, for example, were based on primitive revelation, the principles of which were preserved in the memory of humanity by chosen ones who transmitted these principles from generation to generation, either by oral tradition or by means of symbolic writings. Later, this tradition was entrusted to the Hebrews under the name of Kabbalah, a word which means: "That which is transmitted from hand to hand".

But, over the centuries, the speculations of human intelligence have obscured this tradition so much that it has become almost impossible to discern its essence under the thick shell of the forms imagined by the Pharisees. Wisdom was lost like a pearl in a dunghill, and one understands the apostle Paul asking bitterly, "Where then is this Wisdom and where has it disappeared?" »

Christ's coming to earth was necessary to remind man of forgotten principles. But Christ came not to abolish, but to confirm the ancient law instituted by the Creator. He declared it Himself, and He banished from the Temple the Pharisees, who had lost the essence of the revelation among their ingenious and complicated adaptations and interpretations.

The religion instituted by Christ is the purest and most beautiful that mankind has ever known. Its fundamental principles are: faith in God and love of neighbour.

But it did not retain its purity for long. Like all other religions, once they fell into the hands of the priests,

it degenerated, because the latter made it a profession and a weapon by means of which they wanted to lead humanity. The inquisition, the fierce struggle between the different Christian Churches were the result. Blood was flowing in the name of Christ and possession of the truth was being wrested away from each other, each wanting to monopolize the monopoly of Salvation.

The misfortunes that struck humanity turning away from God could not be dismissed by the representatives of the Churches. The faithful no longer found consolation or guidance from the official and licensed guides of the soul. He searches in vain for other guides and often falls into the hands of false prophets who, concealed under a mask of piety, lead him to his downfall.

This was the reason why the Initiates who, through the millennia, kept the true revelation intact and worked in the shadows, decided to reach out to all those who seek the true way of Salvation. Their faith is based on Knowledge and their only goal is the predestined evolution of man.

The decision to follow these initiates cannot offend any devotee, whatever religion he belongs to, because their teaching is broader than the framework laid down by all religions. It encompasses them all, and its Masters seek to bring humanity back to God and to the Light.

The devotee will find no contradiction in this teaching with the principles of his religion; on the contrary, his faith can only be strengthened there, and he will find indisputable proofs which will confirm the principles of good.

As it used to be, the proposed teaching connects religion with true Wisdom, which is firmly based on the knowledge of the laws which govern the Universe.

The union of all those who believe in God and seek the path of evolution has become indispensable to save humanity and lead it out of the impasse of materialism. The universal organization of all the servants of Good will form a powerful egregore which will fight against that of Evil. The force is in the union.

The methods employed by the Masters of the Brotherhood are the same that have guided the elite of humanity for the millennia of their existence.

As a means of action, each member will perform the rites of his religion. He will add to this the scientific use of the forces of Nature, which will not serve the needs of the human body, but will help man in his spiritual ascent.

The Masters therefore engage all those who seek God and elevation towards the Light to gather around them. Only atheists and materialists will not be admitted, because their goal is opposed to theirs!

## THE BEETLE

The emblem around which the Brotherhood gathered was an ancient Egyptian sign which represents a beetle - whose phonetic is "Khepera". Symbolically, this sign expressed eternal transformation, the resurrection which infallibly follows death. The god Khepera was one of the forms of the Sun god, he represented his *regenerative force*.

We see on the frescoes of Egyptian temples the scarab placed in the boat of the rising sun; and in the tombs and the funerary papyri, it is still he who penetrates into the heap of sand where the mummy is buried, to bring him the resurrection. Often also, the beetle is depicted holding the solar disk in its paws and raising it to the sky.

Why did the Egyptians choose this insect as a symbol of regenerated life? We find the answer in the works of Greek travelers who visited Egypt a few centuries before our era, an answer confirmed by naturalist scholars today: the beetle buries its egg in a ball of garbage which it rolls with its legs and bury it in the sand; when the time comes, the egg hatches, and new life comes out of the pellet and appears on the surface of the sand.

This behavior of the insect evokes the idea of resurrection that was linked to the symbolic meaning of the hieroglyph "Khepera".

Resurrection after death is the basis of Christianity and other developed religions. This fundamental principle was already strongly expressed in Egyptian teaching and made understandable to the simplest man by the representation of symbols related to daily life.

Thus, we better understand the Egyptian conception and the orientation of this religion which saw in death only a passing state after which came infallibly, according to the general law, the Resurrection.

The ancient Egyptian knew no doubt about it; he looked at death without fear, knowing that it is only a transformation into a new life. Throughout his earthly existence, he prepared for death, building his own tomb which he fitted out with as much luxury as possible, deeply believing in a life beyond the grave, perhaps different from his

present life. The mummification of the body was instituted so that at the moment of the resurrection the soul could find its material envelope intact.

The Egyptian had no doubts, for he saw evidence all around him in the phenomena of Nature: the daily cycle of the sun, the hatching of the seed and the egg, etc... Why the man, superior to all the other beings who populate the earth, would he alone be deprived of eternal renewal?

Modern science teaches us that nothing in the physical world disappears since everything is transformed, passing only from one state to another; and since none of the parts that made up our body can disappear, but will transform to be reborn in a new chemical or physical combination, how could we doubt the continuation of the resurrection of the higher part of the Spirit?

The Masters had the certainty and the proofs; this is why they had chosen the ancient symbol of the Resurrection as the emblem of their Brotherhood.

Transformation, Regeneration, Eternal Life, that is our motto.

They had chosen the scarab and not the Cross, which is also a very old sign representing "Eternity", because this last symbol has become more particularly that of Christianity.

Their Brotherhood, we repeat, encompasses all religions and all those who seek God; however, it could seem to those who do not belong to the Christian religion and do not know the origins of the Cross, that we want to impose on them the adoration of a symbol which is not that of their religion. The same objection concerns any other symbol belonging to an existing cult.

By taking the beetle as their emblem, they offend no one's feelings and, at the same time, they establish their *Creed* which is the certainty of the Resurrection and Eternal Life.

Moreover, as this organization is based on the ancient traditions and in particular on those of Egypt, by establishing this emblem they reconstitute the link which connects them to the Hierophants.

In the following chapters, it will be explained how this symbolic object, which is consecrated according to a special rite, becomes active in the hands of the one who knows how to use it.

## RESPONDENT

The ancient teaching consisted of two closely related parts: one was Faith, and the other Magic.

Magic, of which our materialistic century makes fun so much, not understanding its true nature, has always existed and still exists now; each of us has even witnessed, perhaps without realizing it, magic rites: for every religious rite is nothing but a magic practice.

Conventional gestures, fumigations, chanted words are means of realizing the will for a specific purpose. Now, Magic is precisely the science of the application of the force of the Word increased by these various practices, in use since the most ancient times.

By addressing his prayer to God, man puts himself in contact with the higher planes, and the result obtained depends on his state of personal elevation. But if he joins to his prayer a strictly established ritual, and used for centuries in the same circumstances by thousands of his fellow men, he increases the intensity of his prayer, for he thus unites, at this moment, the forces of all those who preceded him in the performance of the same rite.

Thus, all common prayer and all religious rites are basically only Magic.

I said that the latter is the Science of the Word. The writings of the different religions which have come down to us teach us that Creation was accomplished by the emanation of the Word. “God said, let there be light... and there was light. » (Ev. de S. Jean.) « The Word was the tool by means of which God executed the Creation in the beginning. (Book of the Dead). “The Lord had created by the twenty-two letters (of the sacred language) all that was created and all that must be created. (Seph. Ietsirah.) Etc...

Thus, the Word is the primary force, the motor that triggered the work of Creation.

The first man was endowed with the Creator Word, by means of which he named beings and things (Genesis, II), so that they could exist. After original sin, when man, in his pride, believed himself to be like God, he was deprived of this faculty, in order to

not to be able to use it for evil. But the memory of this creative language persists in the myths of all ancient peoples, who attached the greatest importance to the name. The name of a being or a thing contains in ancient languages (for example Hebrew and Egyptian) a kind of formula which expresses the essence of the being it names. Making known the composition of one's name presented a danger, because it was believed that this knowledge gave power over the person named.

The Egyptian texts (in particular the myth of Ra) give us many proofs of this belief, as well as certain monuments on which the names were hammered in order to punish those who had carried them (for example the cartouches of Akhnaton, the heretical king of the 18th dynasty).

The knowledge of "naming" someone or something, as well as the knowledge of the constructive laws of the Universe, enter into the domain of Magic, which uses in its practice forces considered as supernatural.

Nowadays, there are sorcerers who know the use of some of these forces and can cause phenomena inexplicable for official science. One can meet these sorcerers in the savage tribes of central Africa (for example the rainmakers), in Tibet, in India, among the Redskins of America, etc...

Even in Europe there are old men who practice magic according to books handed down from generation to generation. They stop bleeding, remove warts, cure jaundice, cast spells, etc.

This knowledge is scattered all over the world and represents the vestiges of the deepest antiquity.

In ancient Egypt, magic was officially recognized and was part of religion. The latter consisted of morality (like Osiris who, by his sacrifice, had obtained beatitude and resurrection) and magic, by which man versed in universal laws could force his admission into the Elysian Fields.

It seems to us unreasonable to deny the existence of the forces of Nature whose use we do not know, but which nevertheless manifest themselves by phenomena considered supernatural. Magic has always existed, as it still exists today. It can be oriented towards the good and thus form part of religious practices, or towards evil and then constitute a danger all the more formidable since the layman does not know how to protect himself from it.

What interests us is beneficent magic, and we are going to be talking here about a practice that makes up part of it.

In most of the tombs found in Egypt, small figurines representing mummies have been discovered, some in terracotta and painted blue, others in wood or even in wax.

Sometimes these figurines bear inscriptions containing the name of the deceased or an extract from the prayers of chapter VI of the Book of

Dead. In certain tombs, one finds hundreds of these figurines piled up in a wooden case.

These figurines were called "Shabti" (or sometimes "Ushabtis" and "Shawabti"), which means "answering".

It was expected that the deceased, being obliged to perform work in the other world, could be replaced by one of these figurines which, being duly made and consecrated, would answer his call and come to perform the work in his place.

Later, this name of "Shabti" was given not only to these figurines, but to all kinds of objects or machines which carried out a certain work in place of man. The clepsydra (water clock), which marked the time during the hours of the night, was called "Shabti"; the consecrated pearls that were put around the neck of sick children in order to cure them (pap Ebers), were also "Shabti".

We can say that under this denomination should be understood any object prepared in a particular way and endowed with a force intended to carry out a determined work. This force was conferred by a magic rite which made it a responder. In the magic practice of the Middle Ages, the same faculty was attributed to pantacles, ritual objects, made and consecrated for a specific purpose, and constituting a kind of condenser charged with magical forces.

It is necessary to note the difference between a pantacle and a talisman, the first being charged with forces particularly directed towards a determined goal, the second, on the contrary, being strictly personal and reserved for the person for whom it was established.

In the previous chapter, we talked about the Scarab, which the Brotherhood had made its emblem.

In addition to its purely symbolic meaning explained above, the Scarab is at the same time a "guarantor" prepared and consecrated for the dual purpose of serving as a link between the members of the Brotherhood and as a means to achieve the common goal, for all those who, knowingly know how to use it. Thus, the Scarab, charged, so to speak, with fluid, exudes a real

## THE MAGNETIC CHAIN

Everyone knows what electric current is. Our children themselves know that, to obtain the desired effect, spark, ringing, etc., it is necessary to "close the circuit", that is to say, to establish a closed chain by means of a metal wire. through which the electric current passes. The light which we use, the telegraph, the telephone, the TSF are based on the principle of the establishment of the "closed circuit".

But, besides the electric force, there exist other currents: magnetic, sympathetic, etc., which, in order to be able to manifest themselves, all require the same condition of the closed circuit.

Each being, each object carries different forces; it is charged with electricity and other less studied currents. There is for example the magnetic current, which plays a big role in the life of the Universe. This magnetism is a force which seems to approach electricity, at least by certain of its manifestations. The experiences of Col. de Rochas ( *The Exteriorization of Sensibility* and other works), Reichenbach ( *Les Effluves Odiques* ), the Durville brothers, and still others, have proved the existence of this force. Their conclusions are based on their experimental observations. Photographs of human hands could be taken by a special process, showing the existence of a faintly luminous current which circulates in the body of the man and escapes from the tips of the fingers and the other extremities of his body.

The luminous aura which surrounds the human body as well as any other physical body presents a radiation corresponding to the nature of the object which it envelopes.

Some observers call this current "the vital force", and it is on the action of this force that the treatment of the laying on of hands is based. The vital or magnetic force which is exteriorized from the hands of the healer restores the normal action of the magnetic current which is disturbed in the patient. The photographs mentioned above clearly prove that illness or depression of the soul provoke these troubles. One can observe, on the pictures of sick people, that the luminous currents, instead of circulating freely, moving from the centers to the extremities, form bristling lines,

tangles, knots and gives the impression of uncombed hair.

It is this same force which manifests itself in seances. It is very rare that during sessions there is an intervention of external forces or the appearance of beings from the Beyond. In principle, this is possible, but, I repeat, it happens very rarely. Later, I will indicate the reason why appearances from the astral world are rare. Most of the phenomena, such as noises, movements of objects, levitation, loss or increase in weight, etc., which are observed in serious and controlled sessions, are only manifestations of the so-called magnetic or vital force. .

The scientific experiments of Crookes and other scholars have proven the reality of these seemingly supernatural phenomena.

By constituting a chain, the participants of these sessions cause the magnetic current to circulate, just as electricity circulates in a closed metallic circuit. The medium constitutes a condenser which absorbs the currents of all the assistants, and it is by means of this current that the medium is exteriorized by phenomena which seem miraculous.

It is essential to note here that once constituted, the magnetic current presents a favorable field on which can occur a phenomenon of the Beyond, a formation distinct from those presented by the manifestations of the magnetic force. Scientists, having made experiments with high voltage electric machines, were able to observe several times, with astonishment, the formation of images occurring in the magnetic field which had been constituted. In the scientific literature, we find several of these cases, mentioned by English and German electrical engineers (*Côte d'Azur Médicale*, January 1929).

In antiquity as well as in the Middle Ages, this magnetic chain was used to achieve a specific goal. Thus the Knights of the Round Table formed an association which came together with common thought directed towards a particular goal. The chain being formed, one of the members received the mission to accomplish a certain work and, during his absence, *the chain not being broken*, the magnetic fluids of the assistants were concentrated in him, thus giving him the necessary forces and means. to perform the intended act. Thanks to this current he accomplished actions which seemed superhuman to all those who were unaware of the existence of the chain.

We have exposed all this in order to explain the means employed by the Brotherhood to achieve the goal it has set itself.

By scrupulously carrying out the indications that the adept will find in these lines, he will participate in the formation of a universal and formidable force, the Egregore of good, which will fight evil and bring humanity out of the impasse in which it is cornered.

In previous chapters, we explained the role that the Brotherhood emblem plays, as a capacitor

(pantacle) forces directed towards the desired goal.

Anyone can easily make a simple device which will serve as a thought transceiver and the way to use it is explained in the next chapter.

All you have to do is draw the figure shown on page 100 in Indian ink on a white cardboard, enlarging it so that you can put both hands on it (palms down). It is, as we see, a radiation of form which acts through the contact of the operator and the concentration of his thought.

If you want to strengthen the device, you can get an Egyptian scarab that will stimulate the concentration of thought.

*Important note.*

*The Brotherhood of Masters has no headquarters or official representative. It would therefore be useless to try to enter into direct contact with her. The contact is made only by the concentration of the thought directed towards a goal of Good. It is possible that in case of necessity one receives a message from the Masters, but one must not seek them.*

Thus, it is a kind of universal Round Table which is constituted; the result of this work will depend on the concentration and intensity of thought of each participant.

But it must be understood that its various properties *can only be directed towards a goal of good*: the help of a loved one in misfortune, or the necessary help for oneself in case of need. *No work of hatred or revenge may be carried out by these means.* On the contrary, if someone tried to draw strength from it for the accomplishment of an act directed towards evil, he would infallibly be struck by this same force which would act against him. The consequences of such an act cannot even be foreseen and could end in the death or paralysis of the culprit.

It is therefore expressly necessary to warn any novice against such an act of madness, because he must realize that *the goal of the Brotherhood is directed solely towards good* and the fight against evil in all its forms . . . Any contrary action by a member of the Brotherhood will be crippled from the start, and the culprit will be punished very severely.

## VARIOUS USES OF THE TRANSMITTER-RECEIVER APPARATUS OF SYMPATHETIC CURRENTS

It has been observed that sympathetic currents encircle the earth, criss-crossing space in all directions ; but their principal and natural direction corresponds to the rotary motion of the earth, that is to say, they go from west to east.

There are other currents of the magnetic kind which, on the contrary, move along the meridians, that is to say in the north-south direction.

It has been noticed, in magnetic treatments, that the patient lying in the direction of the meridian experiences a tranquilizing sensation; in this position, in fact, the magnetic currents run along the body, producing a kind of longitudinal massage. We know the calming and sleeping effect caused by the hypnotic passes made along the body of the subject. On the other hand, to wake a person, one uses short and transverse passes, which produce the opposite effect, similar to a jolt.

Some people have noticed that they sleep better and quieter if their bed is oriented in a north-south direction; indeed, in this position, they benefit from the calming faculties of the magnetic currents. On the contrary, in the waking state, the person being upright, these same currents strike his body transversely, keeping all the senses wide awake.

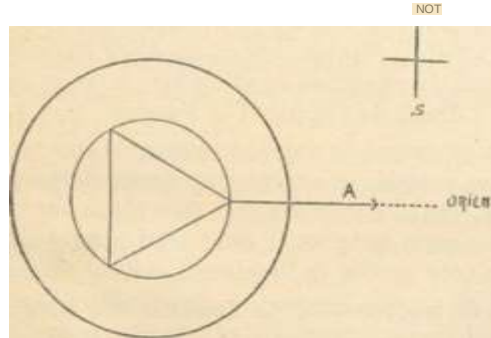
But, in our case, there is no question of dozing off or putting anyone to sleep by absorption of magnetic current. On the contrary, the establishment of the common sympathetic chain requiring a certain effort, one must be active, and the work must be carried out in a state of perfect lucidity.

It is therefore very important that the transmitter-receiver apparatus of the sympathetic currents be placed in the correct position, so that the fluid emitted through it can enter more easily into the universal movement formed by all the participants. In order to facilitate the correct orientation, the device is equipped with a compass.

Each time you want to emit your personal fluid by taking part in the general movement, it will be essential

## GNOMOLOGY

orient the device so that needle A points to the east (diagram I).



*Diagram 1*

On the other hand, if it is a question of receiving the fluid emitted by the general movement, in order to increase its own forces by absorbing a moral comfort or a restitution of physical forces, the apparatus must be turned in the opposite direction, c ie needle A pointing west (diagram II).

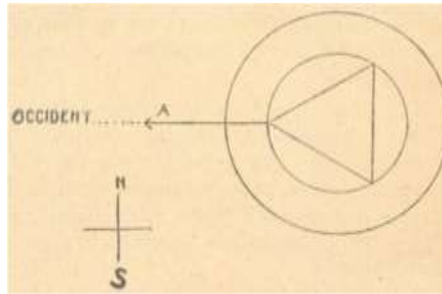


Diagram II

This also relates to cases of third party processing performed by the practitioner through the device.

If the subject needs restoration of forces, if he is dejected, weakened, depressed, etc..., the apparatus is placed in the reception position (diagram II), the subject having to be on the right of the device (to the east).

If, on the other hand, the subject is overexcited, nervous, suffers from excessive blood pressure, heart palpitations, etc., the apparatus must be placed in the emission position (diagram I) and the subject placed in relation to it on the left side (to the west).

We will come back to the issue of third parties in the section on processing. It is important to establish for the moment that the correct orientation of the apparatus plays a great role and cannot be overlooked; the result depends on it.

Like a radio device, our receiver resonates with the waves emitted by the person using it (position I), causing the emission,

I

To participate in the general work of forming a sympathetic current, the adept will orient the device in the position of the

scheme i.

It will be placed on the left side of the device (to the west), the face facing east.

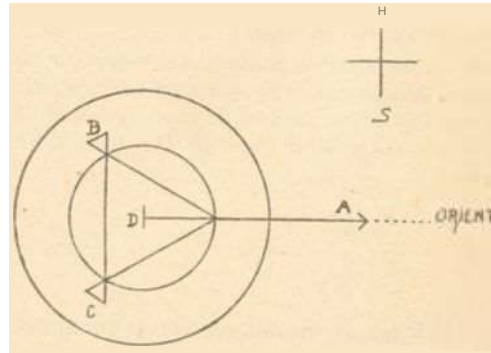
He will place the Scarab in the center of the apparatus, on point D (diagram III), the head of the Scarab being turned in the direction of the needle A, that is to say towards the east.

After a concentration of thought which will be facilitated by the prayer established especially on this occasion (see chapter V, prayer I), he will put his hands on the device, the right hand on the point marked with the letter C (of diagram III) and the left hand on the point marked with the letter B.

The fingers will be elongated flat, so as to cover the small triangles B and C of the tips of the three fingers: the index, the middle and the ring finger. The hand and forearm will rest on the table, in a resting position, without any tension in the muscles.

The adept will focus his gaze on the Scarab and direct his thoughts towards the goal of spiritual union with his brothers.

It is not necessary, at the beginning of this work, that the follower gets tired because the intensity of his concentration would suffer from it. It is recommended to start the sessions with small efforts not exceeding five minutes; it is better to repeat them several times, resting between each repetition (changing position and thought).



*Diagram III*

Later, we will practice extending the periods of concentration, and we will thus be able to make programs that will last half an hour or even longer. But this increase must be very gradual and depends on the faculties of the subject. It is vain to hope for a result if the thought lurks and if the work is carried out mechanically.

This exercise should be repeated regularly every day, at a time fixed by the adept himself according to his convenience. We get used to it, and these moments of concentration become pleasant and essential; in periods of trouble, trouble and worry, the follower will find calm and happiness in the exercise sessions, feeling that he is participating in a great work of regeneration.

## II

When it is a question of obtaining a moral or physical comfort, or an advice for a decision of great importance, one will be able to ask the assistance of the Brotherhood and this last will be granted.

To obtain this result, the orientation of the device will be that of diagram II and the subject will be placed on the right (to the east), the face turned towards the west.

The Scarab will be placed on point D (diagram III), but the head turned towards the subject (towards the east).

The hands will be placed on the device, as explained in paragraph I.

After a prayer of concentration (see chapter V, prayer II), the operator will formulate his request (either a moral comfort, or the healing of physical disorders, or a revelation to make an important decision). Then, concentrating his gaze on the Scarab, as explained in paragraph I, he will put himself in a state of receptivity and wait patiently for the result.

After a good practical training, the latter will not be long in waiting; the operator will feel like tingling at the end of his fingers and a heat will go up along his hands; this is the first indication of contact with the sympathetic current.

If it is a question of revelation, this will manifest itself in the clear formation of a decision which will occur in reason, free from

any extraneous thoughts. Very often, a way out will be indicated which one had not suspected the possibility.

If it is spiritual comfort he desires, the subject will feel a calm and bliss that will gradually replace his troubled feelings. He will understand how futile and insignificant what was worrying and upsetting him was, and when he finishes the session, he will feel refreshed.

Finally, if it is a physical disorder, he will feel a wave of heat that will invade his body, and his own natural resistance forces will be awakened and strengthened to fight against evil. Once awakened, his subconscious forces will work, the session over; but it is recommended to repeat them several times to obtain a decisive result.

This work needs training, the same as that explained in paragraph I.

### III

If the adept wants to come to the aid of a loved one stricken with grief or illness, he can increase his natural forces by using the same device, as follows:

The device and the Scarab will be oriented as described in paragraph II. The operator and the patient will stand to the right of the device (to the east), their faces facing west. The patient will be placed to the right of the operator and will place his right hand on point C of diagram III, in the manner described in paragraph I. The operator will place his left hand on point B of diagram III, and his hand right flattened on the root of the patient's neck, fingers extended vertically along the spine, fingertips pointing upwards and not extending beyond the patient's shoulders.

After the prayer of concentration (chapter V, prayer III), the operator will place his gaze on the Scarab and put himself in a state of activity. His thought will be oriented towards the emission of his own strength increased by that which he will receive from the universal magnetic chain, to combat his brother's discomfort.

The patient will put himself in the state of receptivity. After a while, he will feel a wave of heat spread along his spine and invade his whole body.

Tranquility and well-being will replace his troubled state; if it is a case of physical discomfort, his natural forces (his subconscious) will be awakened and will continue the work of restoring the disturbed balance.

This operation can be repeated successfully in cases of serious trouble.

If it is a case of nervous over-excitement or congestion of any kind from which the patient needs to be released (cases for

which ancient medicine used leeches and bloodletting), the apparatus will be placed in the position indicated in diagram I; the operator and the patient will sit on the western side, their faces facing east. The entire operating process remains the same.

Excessive tension that upsets the patient's normal balance will flow away, carried away by the wave of sympathetic current. The patient will feel a release and his tranquility will return.

It is important to note that the follower cannot ask for any reward for this work, which will be carried out for the sole charitable purpose of coming to the aid of his neighbor stricken by misfortune.

If the adept thinks he will receive any kind of reward, material or moral, for his help, the whole meaning of his work will be distorted; not only will he not succeed, but on the contrary the current emitted by the universal chain will strike him himself and he will be severely punished by losing contact with the Brotherhood.

This contact can be reconstituted in certain cases, but then it will be necessary to prove that the adept has sincerely repented, and he must, by tests, show his firm decision never again to deviate from the path of the Light.

## TRAINING IN INITIATIVE PRACTICE

The first condition for training in the initiatic practice is discipline. You have to know how to discipline your thoughts, submit your actions to your reason, which must be oriented towards evolution and light.

The thought-concentration training indicated in the previous chapter is a powerful means of subjecting oneself to discipline. It would not be reasonable to hope to achieve appreciable results with irregular practice. To obtain an infallible success, it is necessary first of all to choose a suitable hour; this choice depends on the person himself. Everyone has duties to perform in life and must perform them in the most conscientious manner. But there remains a time each day which one can dispose of according to one's desire; part of this time must be devoted to spiritual work. We cannot specify how long each day: it depends on the person himself and on the goal he wants to achieve. It is not so much the length of time employed as the intensity of the thought that counts; it is better to be able to concentrate intensely for a few minutes than to spend an hour with the apparatus allowing one's thoughts to float away.

Thus, each novice who wants to achieve a result must choose the schedule that suits him and during which he will not be disturbed. But, having made his choice, he will have to stick to the same schedule every day.

At the beginning, it will require some effort, but soon he will feel the need to concentrate at the chosen time, because he will clearly experience how much good it does him.

This is the first test of discipline that any follower must impose on himself. This ordeal develops in him the spirit of order and strengthens his will.

As this work is a kind of magic rite by means of which man exercises his hidden faculties and comes into contact with higher forces, this practice must be performed with reverence and piety.

In order to direct the thought towards the goal which the follower proposes and in order to facilitate the concentration to him, one instituted special prayers of which each causes a particular effect. These prayers are composed in such a way as not to offend

whatever religion he belongs to. But a religious man can add a prayer that he chooses among those taught by the cult to which he belongs.

These concentration prayers are listed at the end of this chapter.

The work which you undertake in associating yourselves with the universal movement for the resurrection of humanity will require a great effort from you. But the goal you are pursuing, the reward that awaits you, is worth your effort to achieve. For that goal is the evolution of humanity along the path of good, toward the focus of eternal light; and the reward you will receive will be your own elevation on the scale of spiritual progress.

Participation in this common work is only the beginning of initiation, its vestibule so to speak. Whoever, having taken this first step, will have acquired the mastery of his senses, will receive indications from the guides which will allow him to penetrate into the interior circles and to approach the Center.

We wish that your decision triumphs and that God guides and protects you.

## PRAYER I

### *For concentration in general*

It is truly just and reasonable, it is equitable and salutary to give thanks to You at all times and in all places, Unique God, Creator of the Universe, without whom nothing was and does not exist, Sole Reason for all life and all movement, Father and Mother of all humans in Him Alone.

It is in Your Name that I call the Angels, the Archangels, the Principalities, the Virtues, the Powers, the Dominions, the Thrones, the Cherubim and the blessed Seraphim who all praise You, adore You, revere You with trembling and celebrate in unison Your Glory with transports of joy.

Let us join our thought and our word to those of these superior spirits, to say with them, humbly prostrate:

Hozanna! Hozanna! Hozanna! Unique God, He Who revealed Himself in the mysterious Ternary, Who lives eternally in all the innumerable forms of Creation.

Hozanna on Earth!

Hozanna in Heaven!

Hozanna in the four elements!

Blessed is he who acts in the Name of God!

Hozanna! Hozanna!

## PRAYER II

*For the restoration of mental or physical balance*

O heavenly Father, my most merciful and merciful Creator, purify me. Deign today to pour on Your unworthy servant Your Holy Blessing. Extend Your almighty arm over my being troubled with weakness, so that by Your commands I may participate in Your Divine Work, be endowed with all wisdom, glorify and adore Your Holy Name always.

I invoke You, O my God, and implore You from the depths of my heart that these forces which I call upon by Your power come immediately to comfort and purify me. May these forces manifest themselves, may they give me without any ambiguity certain, precise, true answers, concerning all the things on which I will question them, and may they also bring me the peace and balance that I ask of them in Your Holy Name.

Let them manifest without causing fear or terror to anyone, without hurting me or harming me or any other creature.

May peace and balance reign in the World and in me, Your creature; may all my actions be directed, today and throughout my life, so that Your Holy Name may be glorified at all times and in all places.

And so be it.

## PRAYER III

*To come to the aid of a third party struck down*

— O Merciful God, my Creator, Creator of all life, without whom nothing was and nothing would exist, the Being of Beings, the Unique Source of Good — grant me Your Grace.

Allow me to rescue my brother (name) who is suffering.

I ask You for this Grace in order to appease the sufferings of my brother. It is not to gain his gratitude, nor in the hope of any reward, nor to boast, that I beg You to grant me this Grace, but so that I may serve Good and help my brother in his pain.

May he regain peace and balance, may he in turn serve You and glorify Your Holy Name in peace.

May I, Your humble servant, be worthy for Your Will to manifest through me.

My heart, my life are Yours, and all my thoughts are directed towards You. Let my actions be directed by You.

May Your Name be glorified at all times, in all places and by all beings. May every spirit and every living soul praise and worship him eternally.

And so be it.

## *SECOND PART*

## ANCIENT ASTROLOGY AND MODERN ASTROLOGY

*The stars are only the visible reflections of the combinations of cosmic forces, but do not emit any force by themselves.*

“Speculum Astrologiae” — Junctin.

In his last published book, *Objections contre l'Astrologie*, M. Choissard replies to a letter in which I expressed this opinion that present-day scientific astrology had lost the essential spirit of the doctrines professed by the ancients. He claims that I have gone down a faulty path and that only those of his school hold the truth on the question which divides us.

While doing justice to the profound erudition and fruitfulness of this writer, while recognizing the interest presented by some of his works, in particular “La Chaîne des Harmonies”, I cannot agree to give him the monopoly of Truth.

There are many roads leading to it! It is not enough to place oneself on a pedestal, close your eyes and proclaim that outside your own chapel there is no salvation...

In his criticism, Mr. Choissard seems to advance that I consider useless the astronomical calculations which are used for the erection of the chart. I have never formulated such heresy. On the contrary, I consider these calculations to be indispensable and that the judgment of the horoscope depends on their precision.

But what I have said and what I repeat is that these same calculations only constitute the first phase of the work, the framework for subsequent research pursued by other means. These, known to initiated astrologers, led to a severe overlapping of astronomical calculations and gave them the soul they lacked.

If one sticks only to longitude calculations one obtains only insufficient results, especially in the field

material.

The sage knows that all science is built on principles, hypotheses and not on certainties, hypotheses and principles invalidated one day and replaced by others.

Finally, science comes up against an insurmountable wall. Beyond this wall, arise new principles, new hypotheses... unless one enters the domain of faith.

Science is far from having discovered all the laws of the Universe. She only knows a small number of them that can be observed with the help of our senses.

Can it, for example, measure the vital principle and calculate its value? No. And yet this essential principle is found in the smallest seed as well as in man; without this principle, all things would dissociate and nature would return to primitive chaos. This still belongs to the domain of Faith and not to that of Science.

We see therefore that it is not enough to establish a few calculations of probabilities in order to be able to judge a fact relating to life. These sorts of operations do not allow investigations to be carried very far.

To obtain a solution close to the exactness, it is necessary to seek the causes and not their often distorted reflections in the matter.

You don't judge a man or an object by the shadow they cast on the ground.

Contemporary so-called scientific Astrology, despite its precision, judges only according to the shadow, while ancient astrology examines the object itself in its essential constitution.

The stars are only the visible reflections of the combinations of cosmic forces, but do not emit any force by themselves.

The theme represents a kind of celestial writing, visible and readable for men.

It is through this writing that we can succeed in deciphering the dynamic combinations that gave rise to such an individual or such an event.

Astronomy is indispensable to be able to reproduce these characters, but, that done, its role is finished.

On the other hand, we must not forget this important difference between ancient science and contemporary science: the first was closely linked to religion, from which it derived, while the second proceeds by experience and geometric method.

Formerly, the coryphées gave themselves the mission of raising man to heaven by developing his spiritual faculties (evolutionary movement). Today, science strives to relate to strictly material origins the few laws

that she was able to study (involutionary movement).

The starting point was the same, but the goals essentially different.

What has come down to us from the old texts allows us to differentiate between these two orders of conceptions.

Take for example the *Sepher Ietзира* or “Book of Creation”<sup>11</sup> transmitted by the Hebrew Kabbalah. We will find there some lights on astrology. As we know, the Hebrew language is composed of 22 letters, called sacred. These letters are not only phonetic signs, but present several meanings pertaining to one of the three planes according to the idea that they express.

Moreover, the very hieroglyph of each of these letters symbolically schematizes the cosmic forces which have conspired to create the idea which it manifests. These properties had prompted the Hebrews to reconstitute, in their own language, the primitive language called Adamic or Wattan, each word of which had the power of creation.

Unfortunately, the man intoxicated by pride imagined that he was the equal of God and that he could do without. He lost the creative verb, it was his punishment. His speech became an empty sound out of *harmony* with nature .

In the course of the centuries, he searched in vain for the lost verb.

By purely scientific means man endeavored to understand the Divine Laws in order to make them serve his own ends. The Tower of Babel was only a symbol of these erroneous tendencies. Today, the human being is perhaps further from the truth than he has ever been, because materialism has totally substituted religion. But let us return to Scientific Astrology, the faults of which are common to all the official sciences. Man, in his pride, forgets that he is only a reflection of God and that he is forbidden to discuss vital laws as he does for everything that comes out of his hands.

According to the *Sepher Ietзира*, the 22 letters are subdivided into 3 groups:

Three mothers, seven doubles and twelve singles.

The three mothers realize in the world the principle of the divine trinity, a principle which is at the base of all developed religions and which is represented in the *Sephіroth* by the three superior *Sephіroth*<sup>111</sup> .

In the created world, these three letters signify the three main elements of nature (air, water and fire). The fourth element, earth, according to the *Sepher Ietзира*, is only a derivative. It serves as a passage from the ternary to the quaternary, from the ideal world to the material world. This passage is symbolized by the sacred name IEVE composed of three different letters, the second E being a term of transition to carry out this passage.

The seven doubles represent the principle of the septenary, which derives from the ternary, because it represents two ternaries balanced on

the unit.

In astrology, it is the various planetary influences which are balanced in the human being in a way proper to a particular individual and thus constituting his individuality.

Finally, the simple twelve symbolize the twelve signs of the Zodiac. These twelve letters are also derived from the ternary. Four opposite ternaries form the four trines.

They are naturally balanced and do not relate to a specific subject (fixed stars). The planets, on the contrary, are balanced for each subject and in each subject in a different way (wandering stars).

Thus, the one who is born receives the planetary influences tinged with the specific peculiarities of the signs in which his planets were at the time of his birth.

To decipher a chart, it is not enough to reproduce with all the desired precision the astronomical state of the sky at the time of birth.

This operation, I said above, only gives the frame in which the omens are written in cabalistic signs. It is necessary to highlight these omens, to see how such or such forces are balanced (letters, planets) tinged with such or such influences (letters, zodiacal signs), to set up the determined subject. That's not all. We will have, with the help of these combinations, drawn only the external being, highlighted its instincts, in a way the bed of the river of its life. But the spiritual life, the divine spark that he carries within him, constitute the elements in which is incorporated the very essence of man, "this incarnate spirit".

It is there, deep in the soul, that destiny resides. It is not possible to fully reveal the latter, but we can lift a corner of the veil that hides it. For this, we must bring in the most important factor in the field of our understanding: the Divine ternary.

The role of this primordial force in the deciphering in question shows us the evolution of the soul of the subject, projecting like a gleam on all the omens obtained, a gleam capable of modifying them radically. Judged and interpreted correctly from these various points of view, the edifice of the horoscope stands in all its harmony.

Unfortunately, it is not possible in this very reduced exposition to develop, as M. Choisnard seems to require, a doctrine laden with thought and which has been transmitted from the Sages of Chaldea to our own day.

Given the formidable importance of this vital science, I can here only sketch a very general idea of it. Readers wishing to go further in this area are asked to refer to my "Essay on Cabbalistic Astrology" (Volume I of the

## GNOMOLOGY

“Rota Trilogy”).

## II

### CABBALISTIC ASTROLOGY

The time has passed when Astrology was considered an aberration of the ancients. Some scholars even today recognize that it is worth studying.

During the last 25 years, we have tried to set up a so-called scientific Astrology. The progress of contemporary astronomy has made it possible to give it a precision hitherto unknown.

The chart, calculated according to the special tables, fixes exactly the configuration of the Sky at the moment of the birth of the subject. We thus realize the different influences that the latter receives, influences tinged with those of the zodiacal signs.

These interesting results militate in favor of the new Astrology.

However, the person who undertook this work did not obtain complete satisfaction and, despite the precision of the calculations, he felt very well that certain elements escaped the mathematical operations and that he only obtained an incomplete image. from subject.

And yet this something which is lacking is not a negligible quantity, but the essential — revealed by ancient Astrology.

It is really not explained why modern Astrologers despise and attack those who dare to remind them that the ancients did not limit themselves to rigid calculations, but involved in their method factors perhaps more powerful than these.

Is it heresy to recognize that the sages of antiquity sometimes possessed more extensive knowledge than ours?

We have blinding proof of this in the monuments and vestiges of their art which time has respected. Often even we cannot understand the reasons or the aims of their gigantic labors.

Why close our eyes and persist in saying that we have reached the summit of human knowledge and that outside our sphere of knowledge there is only ignorance and obscurantism?

However, those who would like to get rid of their materialistic prejudices and strive to study what is true in ancient science, would see their horizons widen. Beyond the hill from the summit of which he can dominate the world, appear much higher mountains which are lost in the distance...

The ancient Astrology is reproached for having a sacred and occult character.

Certainly, it is not its mathematical framework that had to be hidden under the veil of mystery. Whoever lifts this veil sees only a skeleton of figures... But is this the proof that there is nothing else? Maybe he just couldn't see?

Isn't our life itself the greatest of mysteries?

And the Astrology which deals with this life, which explains it, why should it be deprived of its very essence?

Scientific Astrology, daughter of a century with material tendencies, cannot judge otherwise than it does.

The same is true for medicine. It is the surgeon's experience that has enabled him to study the functioning of the different organs. As for knowing the principles of this functioning, that is another matter. Life remains an impenetrable mystery in the face of our material means, however perfected they may be.

It will be objected that as a man, I can retain only what is revealed to me by material processes. This is not correct. Man, belonging to both the physical plane and the spiritual plane, is able to conceive certain forces, foreign to the third dimension, allowing him to lift the veil of his destiny governed by supernatural laws.

It is the very source of creation that he seeks to approach: is not the existence of man the reflection of universal life? (Genesis I: "In his own image he created man.")

It is obvious that a problem of this order cannot be solved by calculation alone.

However, the memory of Adam (humanity) has preserved until our days fragments of this supreme science whose origin is lost in the mists of time.

Were these immanent laws known to the first man, created in the image of God? Where did humanity receive the revelation of it over the millennia? We only know that formerly, in the sanctuaries, these laws were taught, orally, to the adept, to the experienced initiate.

Back to Creation. And first of all, what is the act of Creation?

According to Genesis: it is the Divine Word. God says <sup>14</sup> : “Let there be light! And there was light” <sup>15</sup> . In his Gospel, St. John says that without the Word "nothing would have been done of what was done and in this very Word was Life" <sup>16</sup> . Finally, God brought the animals before Adam to name <sup>them</sup> .

Fabre d'Olivet had translated this paragraph as follows:

“He (God) brought them (the animals) to Adam to see what name relative to himself this universal man would assign to each species, and all the names which he assigned to these species, in their relation to him, were the expression of their relationship with the universal soul. » <sup>18</sup>

Thus man, in his capacity as holder of the Divine Creative Will, participated in Creation itself.

Before having thus received their denomination, the different animal species existed only in potential; it was names given by man that they received real life.

Subsequently, man, through his pride, got bogged down in matter and lost the creative force of the Word. He can no longer create except in the world of images.

A child who pronounces a name imagines the image of the latter. Having become a man, this representation is even clearer and sometimes he feels that he is close to objectifying it, to materializing it. In a way, he approaches creation.

Each image has a name and each name evokes an image.

Reality is only a living Word.

These are considerations ignored or forgotten by the followers of young Astrology. The incarnated man has a name which individualizes him, distinguishes him from other humans. Adam is the name which designates the universal man and places him at the culminating point of creation; it is an important name that evokes God the Creator and realizes the idea of its reflection, but it is not individual, it is universal. If we say: a Frenchman, an Englishman, a German, we are already indicating a framework, a limit, without yet representing individuality. But if we say, for example, Jean-Jacques Rousseau, we are designating a distinct, determined individual: he is Adam and he is French with the particularities of gender and nationality, but only his own name draws and clarifies his image.

And by evoking this name, if we had not lost the creative force of the Word, we would see appearing before us this same Rousseau and him alone.

Man is born with his name. Chance does not exist: everything moves according to precise laws.

It is not by chance that a man bearing such a name is born at such a time, but because THAT man, bearing THAT name, could not be born at another time. The name, which is the creative Word, the principle of life, is more important than the moment which is only the framework.

The Word is a force of which a letter is the representation. The letters composing a name carry in them the signs of the forces which contributed to the creation of the man bearing this name.

Basing its research solely on the celestial representation of the moment of birth, modern Astrology builds, so to speak, only the skeleton of the life of the individual, but does not cover it with flesh and does not give it the vital breath. .

We understand that his results are insufficient. The methods resulting from mathematics only make it possible to state rather obscure omens. On the other hand, ancient Astrology, the only true one, erected the horoscope with all the desirable precision; by studying not only the astronomical combinations but also the characters of the names of the subject, she obtained luminous and complete omens. It is impossible, in a study as small as this one, to expose such a vast subject, which even requires a certain knowledge of ancient languages if one wants to fix the rules essential to the establishment of the theme.

I add a few words concerning the method employed by the ancients to introduce the name into the horoscope. It is childish and erroneous to believe that it suffices to add the numbers corresponding to the letters composing the name, then to reduce them to a number (theosophical reduction). This too simple process does not give any precision on the individuality. We obtain the sum of the letters that form the name in question, but this sum can be obtained by a host of other names<sup>19</sup>.

The ancient cabbalists studied not only the numeral values of the letters composing the name, but also their respective places. The unique combination of such letters occupying such places clearly individualized the subject.

The letters forming a name must be studied as are the planets whose influence and power vary according to the aspect they receive or the place they occupy.

This gives the main essence of the name. Then this name, which represents the subject, is projected into the world, represented by the frame of the theme, where it receives the influences of the forces of nature.

He yields to them or fights against them, according to the opposite action of the dynamism of his individuality, represented by his name.

## MEDICAL ASTROLOGY

The applications of Astrology are innumerable. It is the science which observes and studies the multiple manifestations of the vital principle, a principle which, separating itself from the Divine Source, penetrates into the darkest depths of matter, giving it form, inseparable from existence.

This principle exists everywhere and in everything.

Man, in whom a particle of this Divine principle has individualized, is only a tiny cog in the universal machine. As such, he is closely connected with nature and is subject to all the combined influences of the sphere in which he has been placed.

On the other hand, the Creator incarnated in man his breath — his spark — thus enabling him, thanks to free will, to play an active and personal role in the life of the Cosmos by making living matter progress.

It is for this reason that it is not enough, to determine the role of this man in the Universe, to study only the position of the stars and the influences which dominated at the moment of his birth. This work can only reveal the external figure of the subject.

By examining him from this point of view alone, man is treated as a simple part of the visible world; we thus risk knowing only its envelope and not its individual essence.

The role of the divine spark embodied in man is to help him fight against the influences of fate under which he was born. The successes obtained in this struggle are all the more marked as the mind is more evolved.

Fate strikes only those who are weak and who cannot oppose it with an active will. But the Being sufficiently evolved in previous existences, and whose will has been steeped in suffering, molds his Destiny like soft wax, with the help of universal forces.

It is the invisible man, the "incarnate spirit" that shapes the individual, and not his material envelope—a fragment of cosmic matter.

The astronomical calculations of the horoscope only define this envelope, distinguishing the type envisaged from other humans. These calculations can only be considered as the starting point, the base of the building, hangar or palace according to the skill of the architect. They are similar to the talents which, in the Gospel parable, the Master had distributed to his slaves.

Do astronomical calculations make it possible in the latter case to judge their work? No. Everything depends on their zeal, on the play of their free will, elements which cannot be envisaged by our scientific calculations. Religions have always endeavored to guide man in his work here below, towards the progress predestined by his Creator.

The scholars of antiquity—initiated priests—studied these matters under a veil of mystery, and the results passed hand to hand to those who were judged worthy.

This Science — the Kabbalah — is found in all the ancient scriptures and everywhere the principles are the same.

It is for this reason that we can adopt the one that is closest to us, despite its difficulties in deciphering. This is the Hebrew Kabbalah.

The reader thus realizes that the astrological work comprises two absolutely distinct parts:

1) Astronomical calculations aimed at determining the exact place occupied by the subject in the world and the beneficial or malefic influences he receives at birth or during his life.

2) Cabbalistic dissertation that allows you to lift the veil on your inner being. By it, we will know if the subject, making use of his free will, will fight Destiny and thus take a step on the road to Progress, or will succumb under the trials of misfortune.

The first problem is solved using known methods and. nothing mysterious. The second requires an initiation because it goes beyond the framework of vulgar knowledge.

Thus modern Astrology, called scientific, which is based on astronomical calculation alone, is a human science, while ancient astrology is a divine and therefore sacred science.

I said above that Astrology finds applications in many fields. Take, for example, medicine.

Currently, medicine, although it calls itself a science, offers nothing precise: it is rather an art. The diagnosis depends above all on the skill and intuition of the doctor. Yet it is very rare that this diagnosis is exact, complete, and discovers the source of the evil.

On the other hand, medicines, those poisons that are applied indiscriminately to all patients without taking into account the nature

of each of them, are assimilated by some, badly tolerated by others.

This state of affairs is bearable, at a pinch, if it is a question of unimportant infections, such as a stomach ache or a migraine, but if the disease presents complications, here is the unfortunate doctor who gropes in the darkness.

If he is honest, he reassures the patient who trusts him, formulates a harmless prescription and lets the affected organism defend itself by its own forces...

But how many unscrupulous doctors indulge in experiments on their patients, sometimes going so far as to kill them!

The above applies to the most treatable physical illnesses. If, on the other hand, the evil is of a nervous or psychic order, the Faculty finds itself in the most complete obscurity and ignorance.

In all the above cases, astrology can provide valuable assistance by indicating, for each individual, the nature of the evil, its place of choice and its cause.

First of all, it is necessary to determine the order of the disease to be treated. Since man is not a purely material being but belongs to the three planes (physical, astral, spiritual) it is important first of all to realize the plane in which he is affected.

It is illusory to attempt the cure of an astral disease by physical means. But by acting on the astral we will intervene on his physical imprint.

This is where homeopathy is right. By decreasing the doses of a poison more and more, she treats not with this poison itself, but with its principle—its spirit—in other words, its astral.

Finally, illnesses of a spiritual nature require totally different procedures, given their very particular nature.

I will expound some ideas on the methods of treating illnesses on the different planes. It is here that astrology can render us indisputable services. In studying the patient's horoscope we see the influences which have ordered his constitution — his individuality. In the revolution (or horoscope of disease) are inscribed the harmful influences which have come together at the same time as the weakening of the beneficial influences.

If the evil is on the physical plane, we know the place in the body where the attack occurred, a place which may be quite different from where it was visibly manifested <sup>20</sup>.

The determined evil is localized, it is a question of combating it by increasing the beneficial influences and by paralyzing the evil ones.

If we are dealing with a physical illness, we will take the remedies in the physical plane according to the table of planetary correspondences <sup>21</sup>.

But, as I have said, every physical affection, like every material event, is formed in the astral and is then reflected in matter. Thus, one can act directly on the source of the disease which is in the astral, by destroying the combination of the forces having created the latter.

This result is obtained by the application of the magnetic force (magnetization, passes) ordered according to each case, or by the transfer of the evil on a being of a lower development, corresponding to the subject to be treated.

If there is a transfer, the best results are obtained by taking a plant which corresponds harmonically to the subject and which is hatched under conditions approaching as closely as possible those which accompanied the birth of the subject. — This plant becomes like its double, and he who knows can carry on it the harmful combination, the cause of the disease <sup>22</sup>.

If the treatment is carried out strictly and scrupulously observing all the required conditions, the man is delivered from his ailment, and the plant dies.

The treatments of sorcerers, which have come down to us through peoples and centuries, are only the fragments of an ancient science forgotten by man <sup>23</sup>.

Finally, for diseases belonging to the spiritual plane (such as possession, often considered a form of madness), the methods of treatment are completely different from those which have just been described.

Here, we must act through prayer, religious rites, heritage of magic. Besides, the Christian churches have formulas and a ceremonial for the above case. Whatever the nature of the disease, the diagnosis is made using cabbalistic astrology.

Affection is fought in its nature and not in its objective manifestations. Moreover, these manifestations are most of the time only a sort of danger signal—the red flag indicating to the train the insecurity of the track on which it is engaged; if, instead of stopping and slowing down to take stock of the situation, the mechanic burned the signal, the disaster would be fatal.

This is how, unfortunately too often, modern medicine works. Fortunately for her and for Humanity, nature possesses occult forces within her which allow her to defend herself and, despite the inconsiderate action of the doctor, the patient often ends up escaping danger.

If the art of healing had been able to take advantage of the help that Astrology can bring it, many obscure and so-called incurable cases would have been treated methodically and successfully.

I add, in conclusion, that in England and in America, for some years, a great number of doctors superimpose

classical and astrological diagnoses for the greater benefit of their patients.

## SOME DATA ON EGYPTIAN ASTROLOGY

The beautiful sky of Egypt, with its radiant sun by day and its stars in relief on the black velvet vault at night, was bound to hold the attention of the inhabitant. From the most remote times, he learned to observe the movement of the stars which, in his imagination, were grouped in the forms of bizarre animals, serpents and fantastic beings. All these images lived and traversed the celestial vault in an established order of time and movements.

The daily course of the sun explained to the primitive observer the phenomenon of day and night. He divided them respectively into hours.

The phases of the moon inspired him with the idea of the month which was originally lunar.

Finally, the successive and rhythmic declinations of the sun on its way through the Zenith suggested to him the idea of the cycle of the year, a cycle at the end of which the sun gradually returned to rise in the same place as in the previous cycle.

To these celestial phenomena were added the regular floods of the Nile to which the country owed its prosperity. They taught the people to divide the year into three seasons of four months each: that of the flood (flooding), that of the sowing and that of the harvest.

All these natural phenomena observed over a long period (centuries or millennia?) enabled the Egyptian priests to establish a calendar and tables of the movements of the stars in the celestial sphere.

The beginning of the year was fixed for about June 15, when the flood of the Nile usually reached Memphis. This day began the month Thoth. On the other hand, we know from the inscriptions that at the establishment of the calendar the star Sirius (Sothis for the Greeks and Sepdt for the Egyptians) appeared at dawn, preceding the sun. This is an important indication that allows us to establish certain dates in Egyptian history.

Since the solar year has 365 and a quarter days, the rising of Sothis is delayed by one day every 4 years. However, it takes 1461 years for the heliacal rising of Sothis to occur again on the first day of the year. Greek and Roman astronomers

call this period "Sothic".

The Egyptians had drawn up tables making it possible to establish the annual difference between the Sothic year and the heliacal year. It is precisely this difference, mentioned on some monuments, which allows us to know the date of certain historical events.

For example, in the Kahum papyrus, it is said that in year 7 of the reign of Senorset (XII<sup>th</sup> dynasty) the heliacal rising of Sothis took place on 19 Pharmothi (8<sup>th</sup> month of the year). This tells us the years 1882-1879 BC.

According to the medical papyrus of Ebers, in year 9 of the reign of Amenhotep I (XVIII<sup>th</sup> dyn.), the heliacal rising of Sothis took place on 9 Epiphi (11<sup>th</sup> month of the year), which gives us the date of 1550-1547. Etc...

Unfortunately the documents we have do not always contain these markers and we can only determine most of the dates approximately.

The Egyptian calendar is believed to date no later than the years 4238-41 BCE, when the heliacal rising of Sothis occurred on the first day of the month Thoth. But we can place this origin earlier, always taking into account the cycles of 1461 years.

Another point of reference making it possible to find the Egyptian dates is the position of the constellation of the Thigh (Big Dipper) which marks the time on the sky like the needle of a gigantic clock.

In chapter 64 of the papyrus Nu, a chapter considered to be one of the oldest in the collection "the Book of the Dead", we mention that: "The hoof of the Thigh is linked to the neck of the Face..." and further than that happens "when the twelve (signs of the Zodiac) holding hands (forming a cycle) appear one after the other (above the horizon). It is the 6<sup>th</sup> which is the one where the enemy is defeated..."

These sibylline words mean that the tip of the Big Dipper is oriented towards the sun (symbolized by the Face) rising in the first degree of Libra.

"When the enemy is defeated" means "at sunrise, at the beginning of the day", because the Egyptians metaphorically represented day and night as a constant struggle of light (good, symbolized by Ra or Horus) with the darkness (evil, symbolized by Set).

In the evening, it was the victory of Set and the whole world was plunged into darkness, but the morning saw the victory of Horus Ra whose coming was announced by his precursor Sothis.

The data of this papyrus tell us that the position in question occurred at the autumnal equinoxes. We

we can deduce the date which is 2456-53 BC. J.-C. (IX<sup>th</sup> dyn.).

The famous ceiling of Dendera, currently at the National Library, seems to indicate the same date because we see there the hoof of the Thigh directed towards the beginning of the sign of Libra on which is the solar disc containing the hieroglyph of the child (rising sun).

The date we have just deduced is the closest possible date to us. But we can assume that the astronomical knowledge of the Egyptians (or conquerors who brought an earlier civilization to Egypt) is much older, because this same position of the stars, indicated in the Nu papyrus, had been observed 26,000 years earlier.

Egyptian astronomers knew about the precession of the equinoxes. We have proof of this in the measurements of the Great Pyramid which was built to perpetuate the astronomical knowledge of the initiates.

It contains in all its measures and angles revelations of high mathematical value. Not being able to give details on this subject here, because that would deviate from the object of my study, I refer the curious reader to the works devoted to the Great Pyramid. (Petrie "Pyramids and Temples of Guizeh", A. Strauss "Die Weltzahl Pi", Stewart "The witness of the Great Pyramid").

What I want to say here is that this grandiose monument symbolized as a whole the daily course of the sun. Considered from this point of view, it is the eternal monument of the god Ra, father of Egypt. (In Hebrew, Egypt was called Rah-Ab, Psalm 87, which means Ra the father.)

This needs some explanation so that the enigma of this "wonder of the world" becomes clear and bright.

As we have seen, the precursor of the sun (the ideal year of heliacal rising) was Sothis who "by taking long steps prepares the celestial path of Ra" (chapter 174 of the Book of the Dead). It was the "morning star" referred to in many texts. His Egyptian name was Sepdt, written with the sign of the triangle (note that the verb, written in the same way, *sepdt* means: to prepare).

The evening star, the one that first lights up in the sky after sunset, is Venus. The Egyptians called this planet Benu and represented it in the form of a bird: the phoenix. It is the fabulous bird of the Greeks which is born from flames, an idea which becomes clear if we imagine the planet Venus appearing in the part of the sky "burned" by the rays of the setting sun. In the teaching texts the Benu bird is nicknamed "the soul of Ra" (ibid, chapter 29).

According to these texts, the bedtime was the death of Ra who was transformed into a mummy, into Osiris, to be reborn the next day by the force of transformation, symbolized by the scarab Khepera.

But Ra, dead and transformed into a mummy, descended into the tenebrous region of Tuat (another world) where he was followed by his soul, which appeared for a moment in the western sky in the luminous form of Venus—Bennu.

On vignettes adorning the chapters of the Book of the Dead, we see in the solar boat pushed by the deceased, Ra mummified and, behind him, his soul in the form of Bennu. (Turin papyrus, vignette of the 129th<sup>chapter</sup>; papyrus of Ani, vignette of chapter 101.)

These vignettes are explained in the texts where the deceased asks to be admitted in the boat of the setting sun to enter under its protection in the Other World (Hymn to Osiris the Good, chapter 100 of the Book of the Dead, etc...).

In phonetic transcription, the name Bennu has as its root the letters B, N. Now the word Bn, which means "to turn" indicates the movement, apparently turning, of the sun when it leaves its celestial path to descend into the region of the Other world.

In one text (Papyrus Iou, ch. 64) the point of sunrise and sunset are represented by angles.

On the other hand, this same repeated root BN, BN-BN, with the determinative of a triangle, signifies the carved stone which terminates an obelisk or a pyramid, the pyramidion of the Greeks.

Thus we see rising at the two cardinal points (that of sunrise and that of sunset) respectively two pyramids: the Sepdt and the Bn-Bn.

Finally there is another hieroglyph in the shape of a pyramid representing a ritual bread whose phonetic is DY and the meaning: to give. This sign can be represented either by the pyramid bread, or by the same bread placed on an outstretched hand who presents it as a gift.

This last sign enters the sentence "Ra rises". I draw the reader's attention to the fact that the appearance of the sun is represented by the offering (Dy) in the form of a pyramid. This explains the view of the ancient Egyptian who considered life as a gift from Ra.

According to the idea of the Egyptians, the celestial vault was formed of primordial waters (the waters from above, of Genesis), on which the sun made its diurnal journey in a boat. The ceilings of the tombs of the Valley of the Kings as well as the various papyri show us the shape of these boats.

It should be noted that to accomplish his diurnal journey, Ra used two boats: one, the morning boat, Matet, in which he ascended the celestial vault from the point of his sunrise to the zenith and the other, the evening boat, Sektet, in which he descended from midday until sunset.

Through the mathematical papyrus we know the process employed by the Egyptian scholars to calculate a pyramid. Two measurements were given, one was called "pyrmus" and showed the edge of the angle of elevation of the pyramid. The other, called Seqd, showed the ratio (cosine) of one side of the base (which was a square) to the diagonal. Now the word pyrmus is close to the title of the Book of the Dead, which was Pyrm-Hru, meaning "Exit to the Light" or "Exit to the Light". (The word Pr entering these two denominations means "going out").

The word Seqd with a determinative representing a boat means: to circulate in a boat (QD meaning circle); thus this word perhaps alludes to the daily course of the sun which forms a circle. (It is interesting to note that the diurnal course of the sun is represented by the hieroglyph T in the shape of a half-circumference.)

All these synthesized elements clearly bring out the idea of the builders of the pyramid who wanted to immortalize on earth the temple of their father Ra.

It is important to add that the whole building was oriented exactly according to the cardinal points.

The rising sun cast its first ray in the form of a Sepd (Sirius) pyramid, then it ascended the eastern pyrmus of the celestial vault to the summit (noon) after which it descended the western pyrmus again and cast a final ray, its soul Bennu, pyramid-shaped Ben (Venus, the evening star).

In a study specially devoted to the pyramid, I propose to indicate many striking elements contained in this eternal edifice. What I have said here is only intended to give an idea of the Egyptian conception of astronomy.

Let us now see how they applied their astronomical knowledge to astrology.

The horoscope, according to them, was written by the ansate cross, "sign of life" (phonetically transcribed Ankh). Thus the horoscope chart was considered a vital writing, setting out the subject's destiny. It will be understood that the stars entering into the chart were named: Ankh-Dw, because they were those which regulate life according to their aspects at the time of birth.

But as the stars are only visible signs, in a way characters written on the sky, it was necessary to know the divinities to which they related, divinities "who prepare the periods of existence".

We understand that the preponderant role was reserved for the sun — the father of the Universe — who was the visible manifestation of the god Ra. Then came the moon, whose guardian was the god of wisdom, Thoth, sometimes identified with the star itself. We have seen the important role played by Venus — the soul of Ra.

Other stars and constellations, represented by snakes and other animals, formed the whole symbolizing the power of numerous and diverse divinities that we see on the ceiling of the royal tombs and in the book of the Tuat (Other World).

We see in the Cairo Museum a statue of an Egyptian astronomer which is of great interest because of the inscriptions which cover it (described by Ahmed Bey Kamal, *Annales du Service des Antiquités* 1906 and by V. Daressy, *Statue of an Astronomer*, stele of the 20th dynasty) .

In these inscriptions, the priest-astrologer speaks of his observations of the stars, of his knowledge of their highest points, as also of the variations in the height of the sun above the horizon: "The descent towards the north and the ascent towards south of the solar disk.

He therefore knew the variation in length of the shadow according to the times of the year, an essential condition for the establishment of sundials. These inscriptions also teach us how the Egyptians knew the time: by day by the sundial, by night by means of clepsydras which were turned on after sunset. Clepsydras were water clocks where the time was indicated by the flow of liquid. Greek historians attribute its invention to an Egyptian, Ktecibius, who lived in 124 BC, but it is likely that this invention is much earlier.

It should be noted that this machine is named in the text SHB-SHB, from the same root as the word OUSHB which means "answering". According to the belief of the Egyptians, the deceased had to carry out various works in the Other World and to spare him these fatigues they buried with him figurines in earth or wood, named Oushabti, which, being consecrated magically "responded" to the call of the deceased and performed for him all the chores of the other world.

In the tombs one finds many of these ushabtis, often 365 in number to accomplish the work of each day of the year.

Unfortunately, some of the other inscriptions covering the statue are mutilated. What remains legible relates to the places where reptiles and scorpions roost. Daressy deduces that this astronomer was at the same time a snake charmer. This conclusion is not necessary. I believe rather, and the text seems to indicate it, that it was about various constellations whose conventional form was that of the animals quoted.

Modern astronomy has retained their ancient denominations to the zodiacal signs as well as to many other constellations. Our celestial map is populated by bears, dogs, bulls, scorpions, capricorns, etc. ; it is however difficult to find the forms of these animals in the groups of stars which bear their names.

I hope this study has given the reader an interesting insight into Egyptian astrology.

## WHEN TWELVE REPLACES SEVEN

During a stay in Dalmatia, I was received in a Franciscan convent which had a rich library. The curator, a friendly monk, almost illiterate and speaking only the language of the country which I had trouble understanding, let me browse at my leisure among the several thousand volumes resting on the dusty shelves. I found there a quantity of religious works, in Latin and Greek, and some books of great interest and rare value.

A manuscript caught my eye. It bore no date, but the yellowed and crumpled paper and faded ink attested to its age.

Obviously, it was a copy of a centuries-old document. He was dealing with ancient wisdom.

The gems adorning the ephod of the high priest of the temple of Jerusalem were accompanied by explanations concerning the zodiacal influences. Then, mysterious Urim and Thumim were represented as a kind of magic mirror used for divination.

It also commented on the Secrets of the Kabbalah which, through its 22 letters, gave birth to the infinite combinations of the created world. Elsewhere there was talk of astrology, magic, hermetic medicine, etc.

Finally an appendix contained a prediction relating to the times to come, based on the solar revolution, that is to say on the passage by this star from one zodiacal sign to another.

Even more than the moon with its alternating phases, the great luminary, in its celestial course, exerts a considerable influence on the earth and humans. The rise of a race and its fall, great wars, epidemics are caused by the movement of the sun.

This seems to agree with the assertions of certain modern scholars who attribute to sunspots a marked action on certain terrestrial phenomena.

Finally, this corresponds, on the other hand, to the text of the Scriptures where it is said: "When the final times come, there will be

signs in the sky. Now, isn't the sun the most important sign which, according to the Bible, has been given to us to illuminate not only the earth but also "the intelligence of man" (see Fabre d'Olivet "The Hebrew language restored").

What precedes did not surprise me otherwise because I had read similar statements in other writings. However, a sentence whose meaning was unknown to me caught my attention.

Among the signs given to the sage to announce the approach of the "Last times" <sup>24</sup> I read: "When the Twelve replace the Seven."

This enigmatic sentence stopped me and I meditated for a long time on the meaning to attribute to it.

Here are the conclusions at which I have arrived and which seem to be the key to these mysterious words.

As we know, the number twelve corresponds to the twelve simple letters of the Hebrew language. In the macrocosm, these letters represent the signs of the Zodiac and in the microcosm, the organs or the members of man performing the work necessary for physiological life or ensuring contact with matter - assimilation of the elements indispensable to the maintenance of the body.

Astrology teaches us that the zodiacal influence, which is innate and cannot be changed by man, constitutes the physical realm of the subject of the horoscope.

The seven so-called "double" letters of the Hebrew language correspond, in the macrocosm, to the seven planets known to the ancients (Sun, Venus, Mercury, the Moon, Saturn, Jupiter and Mars) and, in the microcosm, to the meaning of understanding in humans by vibrations of sound, light, etc.

These letters are called "double" because they carry within them simultaneously "the quality and the defect" (Sepher Ietzira); it is up to man, by his free will, to choose one or the other.

I will not dwell further on comments which would require certain developments but would divert us from the subject of this article. I refer the reader wishing to explore these questions in greater depth to my Rota Trilogy.

The ancients represented by two numbers the domains of the spirit (reason and free will) and matter: Seven and Twelve.

Seven related to the head, to the fire, to the active and evolving substance - letter Shin - while twelve represented the belly, the water, the passive and evolving substance - letter Mem.

According to the above, the mysterious phrase could be interpreted as: "When the material replaces the spiritual".

And it seems that the materialism that reigns in our century is bringing us closer to the deadline, to the "Sign in the Sky" announced by this prediction.

The ancients knew the seven planets listed above. Their science rested entirely on the scale of the seven. Astrology which, by the study of the native sky, could predict the events of life, illnesses, successes, misfortunes, had at its base the twelve zodiacal influences and the seven planetary potentials.

Astronomy, the corporeal daughter of astrology, discovered Uranus, Neptune and Pluto, bringing the number of planets to ten. Illnesses unknown to the ancients, nervous disorders that cannot be attributed to the influence of the seven planets known in the past, have now manifested themselves in man enslaved by matter. Physics itself shows new colors (ultraviolet, infrared and others) which increase the range of the spectrum.

Our astronomers are certain of the existence of a still invisible star in our solar system which would bring the total number of planets to eleven. It is very likely that some day not far off will see the discovery of a new celestial body, which will confirm the prophetic expression: "Twelve will replace Seven", and this will be the "Sign in Heaven" - the sign of accomplished materialism. of the man-beast.

It will be the End or... the Renewal...

## VII

### COMMENTS ON SOME CABBALISTIC SYMBOLS

God says, “Let there be light ” <sup>25</sup> .

In Hebrew, the verb to say אסור doesn't just mean uttering a word. It also expresses a manifestation of the will. “He said and there was light”.

The sole act of the divine Word suffices to carry out the act of creation. This creative Word, this Logos of Saint John <sup>26</sup> , is the starting point, the cornerstone of all religions as well as of Creation itself. “God said and it was”.

By judging Creation from this point of view, we understand what importance the ancients attributed to the Creator Word.

Their sacred alphabets were based on this principle and the hieroglyph of each letter as much as possible graphically represented the creative forces in their various applications.

Unfortunately, the man immersed in matter had lost the memory of the primitive creative language and it is only the reflections of the latter that we can study in the ancient sacred texts.

The memory of this creative or Adamic language was still alive in the millennia of ancient civilizations and the elect of those distant times pursued its restitution. The results obtained were of little value because it would have been necessary above all to free man from the matter in which he was bogged down and which had made him forget his predestination and his divine role.

Our contemporary languages, daughters of the present era, are even further removed from the sacred idioms and present a purely phonetic character. The letter has lost its meaning of hieroglyph-force and is no more than an ordinary sound out of harmony with nature.

It is for this reason that it is necessary to decipher the ancient scriptures in order to lift a corner of the veil on the problem of

Creation.

Fragments of Knowledge are scattered throughout most of the texts of antiquity.

The most complete teachings are given to us by the Hebrew Kabbalah, vehicle of the principles of ancient wisdom through the collapse of old civilizations.

The Creation is set forth in Genesis <sup>27</sup>. This book is fundamental but gives only very veiled glimmers which require commentary.

We find these in Kabbalah, an oral tradition first and later written down to prevent it from being lost. However, certain cryptographic measures were taken in order to prevent the profane from entering the occult domain. So that by superimposing the data of the Kabbalah on those of Genesis we can pretend to some light on the question which concerns us.

According to the Sepher Ietzirah <sup>28</sup> or Book of Creation which is part of Kabbalah, the sacred language consisted of 22 letters, a number adopted by the Hebrews for their alphabet.

Each letter was not only the sign of a phonetic sound but at the same time represented the hieroglyph of creative forces for the idea it expressed.

The 22 Hebrew letters are divided into three groups: three mothers, seven doubles, twelve singles.

The first letter of the alphabet is " *aleph* ", a letter in almost all known alphabets.

The last letter is " *Tau* ". Aleph and Tau are the A and the  $\tilde{\text{I}}$ , the beginning and the end.

The number corresponding to Aleph is Unity. As Unity contains in potential all the numbers up to infinity, A contains in potential ii. But  $\tilde{\text{I}}$  2 contains A in reality since it is the end.

Thus  $\pi = \aleph$  and  $A = \tilde{\text{I}}$  <sup>29</sup>.

Tau is the twenty-second letter of the sacred alphabet but in the old Tarot it corresponds to Zero 0, Zero is infinity or rather indefinite. Joined to Aleph — unity extends to infinity ( $1 + 0 + 0 \dots + \infty$ ).

The creative letter of the sacred alphabet is IOD.

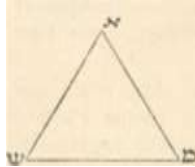
IOD, in number, represents 10 or  $\pi + \aleph$ ,  $A + \tilde{\text{I}}$ .

It is placed in the center of the alphabet where it symbolizes the Aleph which is itself the center of balance.

The Aleph and the Tau frame all letters, all words, all ideas.

$L^{\wedge}$  joins  $\pi$  to create infinity.

But it is on Aleph that the other two mother letters are balanced, forming the spiritual ternary — the basis of all Creation and of all religion.



Balanced divine ternary at the beginning (in principle, in arkhê) on 1 ' א.

Balance is the starting point in this triangle, not the result.

As Aleph is the Word — the Creative principle, the first movement of Life, the Tau is the definitive fulfillment of Life, its penetration into the depths of Creation — the Word incarnate.

It is for this reason that the symbol of the Cross, the ancient symbol of the Egyptian Tau, is so aptly appropriated to Christ — the Incarnate Word <sup>0</sup> ' .

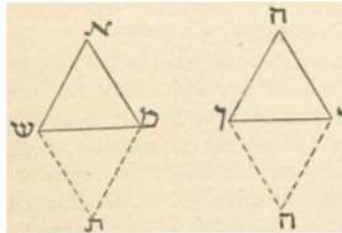
Aleph, according to the Sepher Ietzirah, symbolizes air <sup>31</sup> א, it is the masculine, active principle.

Aleph contains synthetically all the letters of the alphabet and in particular the other two mother letters — graphically it represents the first manifestations of Creation.

The Word (air) collides with inert matter — (water) and takes it out of its passive state; 'first shock, first manifestation of Life.

From this shock is born the fire <sup>321</sup> .

On the other hand, we can express the Aleph by four IOD " which gives birth to the cross — the Tau — Word incarnate — definitive manifestation in matter and the elements.



It is the passage from the Divine Ternary to the second physical quaternary - called Tetragrammaton.

Quaternary realization in the material world, where the aleph manifests as Tau א after having penetrated all the phases symbolized by the 21 letters.

The letter ב feminine, passive principle, symbol of water following the SI <sup>33</sup>.

Hieroglyphically, it represents the act of the Creator, when He separated the waters above from the waters below to create the firmament and the <sup>seas</sup>.

Finally, the passive character of the third mother letter: masculine and deductive, symbolizes fire <sup>35</sup>.

The hieroglyph retained the idea of tongues of fire, which rise from the surface of the waters after the initial shock. As we have seen, these three mother letters form the Divine Ternary, the Trinity of the Christian religion. It is the first universal law that is closely related to the second — that of balance. "The three mothers, their essential feature - the cup of righteousness, the cup of guilt and the law establishing the balance between them" says the SI <sup>36</sup>.

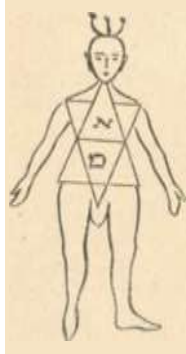
: and are created from א and balanced by ה Unity l'aokhê. In the human body (microcosm). governs the head, it is the "holy fire" the Aish (ר <sup>37</sup> ה) intellectual principle constituting <sup>man</sup>.

The ד governs the abdomen with its organs and limbs. It is the body's factory that acts passively. It receives nutrition from outside and assimilates it to the whole organism to ensure the animal and vegetable life of the being. At the same time . governs the organs of relationship with the physical world and characterizes that part of the organism from which and by means of which everything is done.

Finally N holds the balance between ו and ז . This letter governs the chest, the rhythm of breathing and purification of the

blood — the Life of the Being.

As we remember א is the air sign א . No air, no life.



The figure opposite represents this Ternary (microcosm) which develops into a quaternary in the material world. Fire rises above, water falls below, and air occupies the middle between them. (IF VI. 3.)

The earth is created from water. IF III. 3.

The fourth element, the earth, developed later when the Universe created in principle in arkhê developed its cosmic forces: the Astral, which was then projected into matter by the universal man א: א.

The divine ternary created the quaternary (realization) and by 9 א manifested the twelve points of the four trines  $3/4 = 9/12$  .

In his material relations, man is tinted green (earth). The diagram above gives the synthetic idea of the passage from the Divine ternary figured by the three mother letters of the Tetragram - to the quaternary of Creation. It is the intervention of the second hey n contributing to the formation of the complete name <sup>39</sup> איהו.

The signs of the Zodiac and the planets are inscribed in the four trines of the macrocosm by coloring each other with their respective influences.

Before going further, let us insist again on this fundamental point of creation from which everything is deduced.

Three in One — This is the Christian Trinity, it is the basic ternary of all creation. ⚡

is *One*, it is the masculine, active principle. Now, this masculine principle is opposed by the feminine principle, passive existing in the principle of Unity itself. It is the creation of woman — companion of man, which had been made from Adam's rib, as Genesis says (version of the Vulgate and the Septuagint).

But, it should be observed that this text only gives the exoteric and mythical meaning of the Bible. On the other hand, if we consider the figurative meaning, we see that it is in no way a question of a coast.

At that time, Adam had not yet sunk into matter and was not clothed with a carnal body. It is from the psychic substance of the universal man that the Creator gave birth to a new faculty destined to become the companion of the man Humanity. This faculty was Aishah <sup>40</sup> the volitional power of the intellectual being. Aish which characterized Adam and placed him outside and above any creative act.

Until then, man had remained in isolation and could not accomplish the work predestined by God. And behold, in the Adamic entity appeared the spiritual man and woman. The “*plus*” and the “*minus*”.

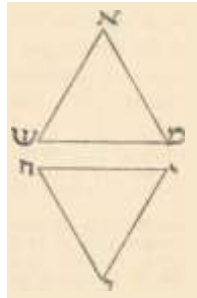
But, according to the universal law, two antipodes must balance each other. This is why the balance of these two antipodes is established in their union symbolized by the letter image of the knot which unites, which connects all things \* <sup>47</sup> ^.

Thus the mystery of mysteries is accomplished in man. The being becomes the exact reflection of its creator, the — יהד — the incarnated Divine Ternary.

The difference between the balance of the three mother letters and that of the name IEV is that the former is realized in Unity — beginning — Divine Ternary from Unity — Trinity according to Christianity. On the other hand, the second is resolved in realization by division: d' - ⚡ is born א-שך and their balance results from their union by

Balanced involuntary divine ternary in man — embodied spirit.

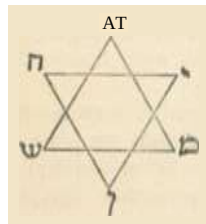
# GNOMOLOGY



The figure of the Seal of Solomon results from the union of these two triangles.

This figure is interpreted as follows:

"The initial Principle containing in potential all that was created manifests itself in Life by the opposition of opposite poles which balance each other in an encounter to achieve evolution and the return to Unity".



The seven double letters of the Hebrew language are derived directly from the Ternary and governed last.

by the same laws that this

They are considered as two ternaries (three in one) balanced on the Tau.

"Sevens, three against three and one that balances them" <sup>4142</sup>.

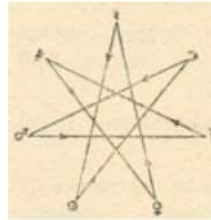
These seven letters represent the universal scale which is the basis of all creation (7 planets, 7 colors, 7 notes of the scale, 7 days of the week, etc.) The discovery of certain planets other than those of which it This does not in any way modify this creative law. These planets are considered to belong to higher or lower ranges, as well as infrared and ultraviolet with respect to the 7 colors of the spectrum.

The Kabbalah fixes the order of the planets as follows: Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon, different from the order adopted by the Babylonians, Ptolemy and the Talmud : Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon, Saturn, Jupiter, Mars.

These two theories are the same but they do not start from the same star.

Those who know the planetary hours used in magic know that during the week all the planets pass successively to the first hour while maintaining their rank <sup>43</sup>.

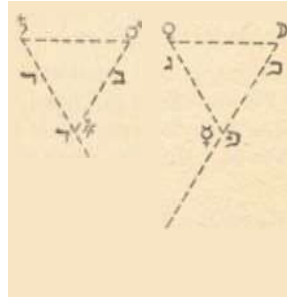
The star below gives the exact succession of planets for both hours and days.



Traveling around the circumference we will read the succession of planets that define the hours, while following the lines of the star we obtain the order of the days of the week.

As it was said above, the two opposed ternaries are balanced on the Tau, that is to say on the Aleph — Word incarnate.

It seems that the Kabbalah adopted this order of planets in order to emphasize that the center of balance is the • represented by the • -- (tau) <sup>44</sup>.

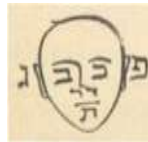


Thus we can arrange the seven planets in the following order by observing the fundamental balance in each ternary, considered as a unit as shown in the diagram opposite, expression of the macrocosm.

In the microcosm the seven doubles represent the organs of the head of man.

Thus they belong to the region of (schin).

Curious remark: the double organs are represented by letters whose hieroglyph is of analogous form (the right eye, the beth and the left eye, the caph; the right nostril, the daleth and the left nostril, the resh. Finally, the left ear is well represented by the phe, while the right is represented by the ghimel, the hieroglyph which comes closest to the phe.



The center of balance, the organ through which the breath of life enters and the Word leaves, is represented by the letter r Again we have here the cycle of Life between 1 ' א(aleph) and the ט(tau); אmakes the heart beat, the lungs breathe for

give life to the incarnate, but it is through the  $\aleph$  that the material air enters. On the other hand, Life, given by  $\aleph$  is manifested by  $\aleph$  the Verb.

Again we find the A and the *Cl*, the beginning and the end which manifest themselves very clearly in the incarnate.

Each letter of the seven is called double because it carries within itself the quality and the defect, the + and the - <sup>45</sup>.

It is the world of free will, of human initiative, which can direct an event towards good or evil.

On the other hand, the twelve letters, called simple, are those that man cannot influence. They are the twelve borders <sup>46</sup> in which come to develop all the manifestations of the Life of the Microcosm and the Macrocosm.

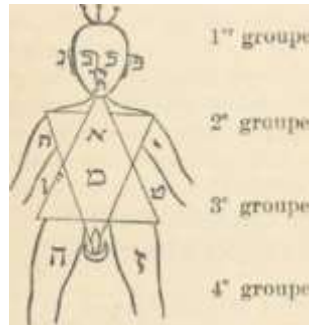
In Astrology, the succession of the signs of the Zodiac is invariable and they influence the nascent man in an order of absolutely fixed relations. It is not the same with the planets whose positions relative to each other are infinitely variable. They individualize and deeply impress man by giving him his personal character. For, in short, what are the dominant ones in the life of man?

It is not his physiological functions that escape his will, but his thought, his words, his decisions of which he is the undisputed master.

It is the domain of  $\aleph$  where the forces of the seven doubles develop. It is the union of the Aish-Aisha, the divine ternary  $\aleph$  with which they agree and resonate like the strings of a musical instrument.

Finally the simple twelve represent the four trines of the Zodiac in the Macrocosm. They are not balanced at any point, for their stability is natural and their mutual relations immutably fixed. They form, as we have said, the zone in which come to develop the manifestations of Life. This zone influences them in one way or another, depending on the place in which the event takes place, but the determinism is invariable.

In the Microcosm, the simple twelve belong to the domain of the letter  $\aleph$  governing the organs of man's negative life and the limbs which are the linking agents of the body with the physical world. They are arranged as follows:



H■ 4 ? right leg  
 V right kidney  
 -ןll left leg  
 יÍ •G right arm  
 left kidney  
 •■ np left arm  
 לthe bile  
 ■m intestines  
 D \*\* Keva  
 p- % the liver  
 kerkovak  
 p-lf the spleen

The Hebrews divided the stomach into two parts: Keva and Kerkovak.

This figure is the synthesis of the Microcosm according to Kabbalah.

It offers many revelations both by the place and by the hieroglyphs of the letters.

It is not possible for me to expand further on this subject which goes beyond the usual framework of a chapter. I will only draw the reader's attention to the figure above entirely balanced on Life, the poles of which are constituted above by the divine Word and below by the phallus, symbol of an ancient cult.

It is up to man to orient himself towards one or the other of these poles.

## VII

## THE PRINCIPLE OF DUPLICATION IN EGYPTIAN EDUCATION

## A FRAGMENT OF HIEROGLYPHIC TEXT

With its endless procession of deities with the heads of birds, reptiles, any other animals, or more or less complete human appearance, the religion of the ancient Egyptians inevitably appears to us as pantheistic.

The study of the texts, however, illuminates this pantheism in a particular way and reveals the existence, from the earliest times, of monotheistic beliefs. These beliefs which were at the base of the teaching of the schools of initiation of Heliopolis, Memphis and finally of Thebes, came under the secret doctrine which was neither for the use nor within the reach of the people. The latter needed concrete ideas which alone suited his primitive understanding.

To satisfy the demands of the profane, the priests introduced into the general worship the local divinities, those worshiped by the prehistoric inhabitants of Egypt.

Before Pharaonic times, the country was not a united kingdom, but was instead made up of a number of small divisions called "nomes" and inhabited by clans that were often enemies. Each nome had its particular gods who later became its "totems" (signs) (e.g. The Wolf, VIII<sup>th</sup> nome; The Orix, XVI<sup>th</sup> nome; The Crocodile, VI<sup>th</sup> nome; The Hare, XV<sup>th</sup> nome, etc...).

By adapting the general worship to a certain part of Egypt, the priests were obliged to elevate the local gods there to the preponderant place, which produced in the texts of various periods such confusion that one sometimes has great difficulty to sort them out.

But the dominant idea from the most ancient period (idea emerging from the texts of the Pyramids) until the New Kingdom (Theban period) is that of the god One, Creator of the Universe, and whose other gods are only demonstrations <sup>47</sup>.

This Unique god named *Atum* or *Tem* in the Pyramids, became *Ptah* in Memphis and *Amon* in Thebes. It is he whom the Hebrew cabbalists will call Ain-Soph, the indefinite, the Ancient of Days (compare with the usual epithet of Atum: "one of millions of years").

The heretical king Amenophis IV, who took the name of Akhnaton (and whose cartridges were, after his death, hammered with determination by the priests of Amun), wanted to free the Egyptian religion from pantheism and proclaimed for all the people the worship of a single god whom he named Afon.

This idea, fundamentally erroneous, was not lacking in beauty, and we can judge of it from the hymns intended for Aten which have come down to us <sup>48</sup>.

The error consisted first of all in the fact that no one had the right to reveal this great mystery carefully hidden for millennia in the holy of holies of the temples and communicated to the vulgar in the enigmatic form of religious texts.

Then the name Afon means "solar disc", material manifestation of the Indefinite God. By adopting this new name to describe the One God, the deeper meaning of the old teaching was lost.

The ancient name *Atum* was written by the hieroglyph of the sledge (Tm) — means of transport on which the divine effigies were placed to be able to circulate in religious processions. — We understand the idea attached to this sign: means of movement, or even *reason for manifestation*.

Devotees adored the divine images appearing in processions, but the possibility of this appearance was given by the sledge - an indispensable vehicle, which remained unnoticed.

Now, the symbol of the sleigh perfectly sums up the idea that the initiates attached to the indefinite - "invisible reason of all life, of all manifestation".

The name of the god *Amon* of the Theban school expressed this same idea in a less complete way. This name was written using the hieroglyph *YMN*, that of the chessboard. This hieroglyph forms the words meaning on one side: "the established order of things". We see that the idea of primitive teaching had degenerated in the Theban period and that the name of the god Demiurge retained only the significance of the mystery and of the principle which establishes the order of things.

By proclaiming *Aton*, the solar disk, as the only god, the heretical king tore away the veil of the mystery of the reason of all things and lowered the creator god to the level of a physical phenomenon.

We can understand the feelings that this reform aroused in the initiates of the temples who understood the symbolism of the old teaching, and we can explain the determination with which they effaced the traces of this doctrine as soon as they could.

Thus the idea of the One God, Creator of the Universe existed from the most remote times in Egyptian teaching and it is precisely the knowledge of this hidden doctrine which served as a basis for Moses (initiate of the Egyptian temples) to establish the religion of the Hebrews.

In studies which will appear soon I give many examples which can be used as proofs for the theory which I advance.

Here, I will content myself with a single fragment of text whose idea approaches in a striking way the teaching of the Hebrew cabbalists.

In the papyrus of Ani in ch. XXIV, 2, it is written:

y\*K-T / w W \* V ' c i V \* A i ; \*-w\*L i - M H - t f i

which is translated: "I am Tem-Hepri who created himself on his mother's thigh".

This translation although literary (and possible from the phonetic point of view) does not render all the deep meaning of this text and if we only stuck to this meaning, we could deduce that Egyptian teaching was private logically.

How can one speak of the mother of the one who "was the only one", who "created himself in the first element"? (ibid. ch. XVII, 5 and 9 and ch. III, 3) who was *alone* before the beginning of things, since it was the appearance of Ra (the sun) which marked the beginning of creation (ch. XVII ), and of which finally it is said: "There was no mother for him who gave him his name, no father for him who issued it saying: it was I who created him". Eg. Zeit. 42 page 33.

Let's analyze the words that make up our fragment:

*Nwk-Tm* — I, absolute pronoun: I (am) Tem. Speaking of the name Tem written by means of the hieroglyph of the sled, I said that one could interpret it: "the hidden reason of the movement", or of life. Thus this name expresses the idea that the One God was the principle of life, an idea which had been preserved through the religion of Moses and up to Christianity. On the other hand the word Tem written

in the same way, but without the determinative of god, meant: EVERYTHING. And finally, as an abstract idea, this same word represented the negative Verb: not to be, not to really exist.

These last two meanings complete the first by presenting the unique god as a principle encompassing in himself all that exists, but having no particular form, because he is in EVERYTHING.

*Hpry* — comes from the verb *Hpr* — create, train; the determinative of a god gives this word the meaning "Creator"—epithet of the God Tem.

*Hpr-Zef*— self- created.

*Hr-p* — the superior, the leader. These same signs with the determinative representing stars mean: the superiors, the stars.

This word is made up of the human face, the part of the body that identifies man <sup>49</sup> and the celestial vault. The reader will understand later the particular meaning that comes out of this word.

The hieroglyph of the walking human leg, phonetically transcribed either *War*, or means the leg, the thigh and also the *movement* (walking, fleeing). In our text, this hieroglyph is followed by the letter T and the sign of the book indicating that it is not a question here of the part of the human body, but of an abstract idea which is attached symbolically to this member. Now, we know what importance the ancient Egyptians attached to the constellation of the Big Dipper called by them " *the Thigh* ". » <sup>50</sup>.

It is true that ordinarily this constellation was represented by the thigh of an animal, a member which, by its shape, imitates the position of the stars constituting the Big Dipper (phonetically this last hieroglyph is transcribed *MSKHT*).

The discussion of this last word goes beyond the framework of this article and I refer the curious reader to the very interesting work of Moret "The Egyptian Mysteries" as well as to my book "The Sacred Language".

What is important to note is that the hieroglyph *MSKHT* is used in the texts *when it comes to the shape of the constellation* Ursa Major, while the walking human leg (*Wart*) is found in the cases *where it is a question of the movement of this constellation* around the Pole Star.

Thus the words "Head of the Thigh" mean in our text: the one who is in the center of the sky, the one who directs the movement of the Thigh <sup>51</sup> or, in general, the movement of the stars. And as the apparent movement of the sky occurs around a fixed point (Polar Star) we could qualify this point as being *the center of the Universe* <sup>52</sup>.

Finally, the words *Mout-F* are translated in other texts by "his mother" <sup>53</sup>, but then they are not accompanied by the determinative of a male being, as is the case in the sentence we are analyzing. The fact that in our text we judged

necessary to make this addition, radically changes the meaning of the words that precede it.

The word mother could be written either by the sign of the vulture (*Mout*) followed by the letter T and the determinative representing a woman, or without the latter, or even without the letter T (by the vulture alone). On the other hand, the word father was written *Itf* or *Tf*, but was in both cases followed by the determinative representing a man.

In the text that interests us we clearly see the union of these two words: *Mout-Tf* = mother-father. To indicate the indissoluble union of these two principles, the letter *T* which ordinarily determines the word mother *Mout* merges with that which begins the word father *Tf*. This is all the more significant as the letter *T* symbolizes balance.

This idea, which had the greatest importance in Egyptian theology, received different interpretations in the various schools of initiation. Thus in Memphis, where the principal god was Ptah, the double function of father and mother was expressed by "Ptah is the father...Ptah is the mother..." (Denkmal Mem. Theol Sethe 50a51~a).

In Thebes it was the attribute of Amun-Ra which is said to have been simultaneously "the begetter and the mother" (Rit. of Must XXX 23~). We find this same expression referring to the archaic form of the sun god Tem-Ra found in the texts of the Pyramids. Elsewhere it is said that he was "the Unique who himself was the fertilizer (father) and the one who gives birth (mother) pap. Hu-Nefer Hymn to the Sun Brit. Mus. 9901 pl. I line 12; also dad. Nekht, Brit. Mus. 10471 pl. 21.

We find here the source from which was borrowed the idea of the Hebrew cabbalists who said of primordial times (when the creative force had not yet manifested itself), that "the Balance was in the Ancient of Days" <sup>54</sup>. This meant that the first act of creation was the *division* of the One principle *into two*: masculine and feminine or positive and negative, the first division of Unity into binary <sup>55</sup> which begat all subsequent divisions.

By synthesizing the words studied above we obtain the luminous meaning of the text which interests us and which will be:

"I, the principle of all life, the Creator who created himself, center of the movement of the Universe, mother-father (of all things)".

This fits perfectly with the idea of the One God, the reason for all life and all movement, as specified in other initiatory texts.

It seems that this needs no further comment.

The reader will find in my "Sacred Language" the exposition of the doctrine of the hierophants and its study on new bases allowing to decipher the sibyllic language of the texts of ancient teaching.

## ONE OF THE BASIC PRINCIPLES OF EGYPTIAN ESOTERIC TEACHING

In an article published in No. 439 of *Psyché*, in July 1933, I analyzed a passage from the papyrus of Ani which, in the official translation, presents, in my opinion, an incomplete meaning. I tried to demonstrate that on the contrary this passage contained a deep and philosophical idea hidden under a banal appearance. I won't repeat what I said about this again, but for those who haven't read the article in question, I will sketch the general idea.

It was the passage translated thus: "I am Tem-Hepri who created himself on his mother's thigh" (pap. Ani ch. 24.2).

I drew attention to the fact that this translation was contrary to logic, because how can one speak of the mother of the Creator for whom "there was no mother who gave him his name, no father who emitted it saying: it is I who created it" (Aeg. Zeit. 42 page 33).

The texts, moreover, often mention the Creator Tem "who was alone", who "created himself in the first element" (L. des M. ch. XVII5, 9 ch. III, 3), etc...

The name of the Creator was written with the sign of the sledge Tm ᵀ ᵀ that is to say that of the *means of transport* or, in other words, of the *reason for the movement* of a thing (such as, for example, divine effigies which were placed on sledges to figure in processions).

But apart from this meaning the hieroglyph Tm still formed the words meaning: "everything", and: "not to be", "not to really exist". This accords perfectly with our conception of God who is the Reason of all movement, of all life, who is in all that exists and who at the same time has no particular form, precisely because he is in all .

After comments concerning the meaning of the expression the "thigh" which I interpret as the constellation of the Big Dipper, I approach in the article mentioned the translation of the passage in question: "I, principle of all life ; Creator who created himself; center of motion of the Universe; *mother-father* " (of all manifestations).

Now we find the same doctrine, expressed in almost identical terms, in the texts of the Maia civilization of Central America. This civilization, according to some scholars, is one of the branches from the prehistoric strain (Atlantis) of which another branch was the Egyptian civilization.

It would take too long to dwell here on all the data that seems to support this hypothesis. I shall therefore confine myself to quoting a fragment of text which is strikingly similar to the Egyptian teaching which we are studying.

A Maia book called Popol Vuh (The Collection of Written Leaves) which was first published by Dr. Scherzer in

1854, said in speaking of Creation, that above all existed “ *The principle which presented in itself alone the Mother and the Father of all living beings; the cause of existence, the Creator of all*”. (L. Spence. The problem of Atlantis p. 116).

I will not go into detail about the translation discussed in the mentioned article. I will stop here on the word Mut-F which I consider to be one of the cornerstones of the esoteric teaching of ancient Egypt.

It goes without saying that in the spoken language the expression Mout-F meant "his mother" and we find this meaning in the titles often accompanied by the determinative representing a woman ( <sup>1</sup> Jj \* J ■ — Hymn to Amon, Gardiner AZ 42) Where an egg c%: or % - v. eg. Mr Gautier. The royal sons of Ramses A. of the S. of Antiquities T. 18 page 247).

In all these cases the grammatical translation of the expression "his mother" is perfectly correct and the only one possible, when it comes to titlature. But this does not apply to the teaching texts and to certain epithets in which this seemingly banal form was used to hide a dogma of faith. If in our translations we pursue the interpretation of these texts from the sole point of view of the spoken language, without seeking to penetrate their symbolic meaning, the opinion that we form on the teaching of the Egyptian initiates is rather deplorable.

This teaching then presents only incoherent formulas, deprived of all logic and good only for a people in the savage state.

And yet all the proofs to the contrary are furnished to us: first by these reflections of Egyptian civilization which are its grandiose monuments, as also by testimonies such as the religion of Moses, initiate of the Egyptian temples; then by the fact that the founders of all the Greek schools of philosophy went to educate themselves in Egypt. It is certainly not in the childish texts of superficial translations that these great minds drew the principles of their knowledge, there was something else, a great science hidden from the profane and which we have not been able to discover.

The expression *Mout-F* whose hidden meaning I have proposed to reveal presents an example of the means used by the initiates to conceal in a banal form one of the fundamental ideas of their religion.

This idea, which was of the greatest importance in Egyptian theology, received different interpretations in the various schools of initiation.

Thus in Memphis, where the main god was Ptah, the dual function of father and mother was the chosen interpretation and this is expressed in very clear terms "Ptah is the father... Ptah is the mother..." ( Denk, Mem Ph. Theol. Sethe 50a51 -a).

At Thebes it was the attribute of Amun Ra, who was admitted to be "simultaneously the begetter and the mother" (Rit. of Must

30 2-3).

"The Unique who was himself the fecundator (father) and the one who gives birth (mother)" (pap. Hu-Nefer hymn to the sun Brit. Mus. 9901 p. 1 .12, also pap. Nekht Brit. Mus. Pl. 21).

Finally, the archaic expression *Tem-Ra* of the texts of the Pyramids represents the first duplication of the Unique Creator God, duplication in reason and in visible manifestation. We find in the Hebrew Kabbalah the same idea expressed in these terms: "The divine image is double, there is the head of light and the head of shadow... He (the visible God) is the light, but It is the black head that is the lamp" (Siphra Dzenioutha. Comment, by Schimeon Ben Jachai).

It seems to me from what precedes that the expression *Mout-F* in addition to its banal meaning "his mother" used in the spoken language, also had a symbolic meaning that was used in the initiation texts. The Egyptians liked to use puns or periphrases to illustrate or hide their thoughts, as the case may be. Many such examples can be found in the texts. Here's one that sheds light on what I'm saying.

The word cat was written *Miu* (. 1 V with the determinative representing a cat. This word reproduces the mewing of this animal and it is probable that starting from this consideration this word had been composed to express the idea of the cat. But d ut another side this same word *Miu* in its abstract meaning means: "similar to..." "in the image of...".

In the text of ch. XVII of the L. of M. we find a passage of which here is the vulgar meaning: "the male cat is Ra himself and he is called *Miu*, because of the words said by the god *Sa* (knowledge) who says about him (Ra)": he is similar (*Miu*) to what he created, "and so his name became *Miu* " (Budge. Book of the Dead p. 103).

The vignette adorning this text represents a cat sitting under a tree and cutting the head of a large snake with a knife.

Thus the man of the people by reading these words only saw their popular meaning and really believed that it was only a cat called *Miu* by imitation of the cry of this animal. But the esoteric essence of this passage is hidden in the words: "He is like what he created" and this relates the teaching of the Egyptian initiates to that of the Bible: "And God formed man in his own image (Genesis 1,27).

It would take too long to comment here on the esoteric meaning of this whole passage. I expand on it moreover in the translation I made of this very interesting chapter and which will appear shortly. It suffices to note that the image of the cat, used by the initiate in the text in question, was chosen with the intention of masking the esoteric meaning which would have disturbed the imagination of the vulgar.

Later, the real meaning is further obscured by omitting the word *Miu altogether* and merely depicting the cat while

alone, as is the case on a healing statue of a priest named "Zed Hor, the Saviour" which is in the Cairo Museum (See the description by M. Daressy in the An. du Serv. des Antiquités Tome XVIII pp. 134-135).

In a long text that covers the base of this statue, we see repeated several times the representation of a cat that must be understood not as the animal itself, but as the abstract meaning of the word *Miu* which names it , i.e. "similarity". This totally changes the meaning of this obscure text and brings it closer to that of the Pyramids where it is said "your body is Tem..., your hand is Tem..." etc., (Pyr. Unas 129).

In this text of the Pyramids it is the body of the deceased who is assimilated to that of the god Tem (the Creator).

Mr. Daressy who published the texts of the statue of Zed Hor begins each sentence of the passage mentioned with the words: "Oh this cat... your soles are those of Isis and Nephthys..."

It seems to me that it would be more correct to translate: your soles of the feet *are similar* to those of Isis and Nephthys", etc... to the patient asking the statue for his healing, and the image of the cat here replaces its usual name: *the word Miu* meaning "in the image of..."

This digression finished, I return to the word *Mut-F* which is one of the cornerstones of the teaching of Ancient Egypt. This combination was interpreted by the Hebrew cabbalists as follows: "The Balance which was in the Ancient of Days" (Op. Cit. Siphra Dzenioutha). This means that before the manifestation of Creation the Supreme Being was the Unity which contained in potential the two opposite poles, principles of the first unfolding. The creation once begun continued in consecutive doublings: from one was born two, what the Egyptian priests teach by the birth of the first couple Shou and Tefnut left the Unity of Ra (Word-sun).

The Hebrew cabbalists say that before the Creation "the face did not look at the face" (ibid). That is to say that the unity had not yet split, the two opposite principles: masculine and feminine (father-mother from which all the following manifestations were to be born) had not yet separated, but resided in the primordial One.

The Egyptian teaching expresses this same idea by the word *Mut-(f) T j ! J* variant   Little hymn to Atony, mother-father linked to each other by the common equilibrium sign *T* which ends one of the words (Mout   -mother) and begins the other (  Tf -father).

The Pyramid Texts (Pyr. 799) give us this same indication, but expressed in even clearer terms ( 𓆎𓆎𓆎 " ) where the words mother and father are complete as their component letters, and bound together by the sign *T*, that of

lasso symbolizing union, bond. It is the union of the father and the mother indispensable to the birth of the child, the fruit of this union.

Any formation of a phenomenon must follow the prototype of creation. It must start from unity, but from active unity like that of *Tem*, thus containing within it the principle of duplication necessary for any vital manifestation, that is to say the *Mout-(t) F*.

Understanding the mysterious meaning of this word sheds light on a whole host of other names by explaining their esoteric meaning.

A single example will suffice to illustrate this law, that of the priest officiating the rite of "passing through the skin" by means of which the Egyptians believed to renew life in a being fallen into decrepitude by giving birth to it a second time by magical processes; the priest officiating this rite was called: *YWN MOUT-F* (j . \_ ) •

This name is usually translated as "column (or support) of his mother" and also serves as an epithet for Horus the Younger. The phonetic transcription of the sign of the *IWN column* is representing a newborn kid and the vase of the Nou

(promatter). But the sign of the newborn kid transcribes itself in phonetic letters *IW* (l V) meaning "to be".

Thus the name *YWN-MOUT-F* means that the one who bears it succeeds, by the union of the two principles (that of the mother and that of the father), in bringing about a rebirth in a real form resulting from the promatter.

We know that the skin, through which man had to pass to be reborn, symbolized the fertilized mother in which the mystery of *Mut-(t) F* had taken place. We have a large number of testimonies on this subject (See p. Maspero: *Tombeau de Mentouherikhepser*, Cairo Museum V. 3, *Virey Observ. on the episode of Ajristée*, *Moret Egyptian Mysteries*, etc.) preserved on the frescoes of the tombs as well as in theological collections.

The role of the priest officiating the rite of "passing through the skin" becomes clear after these explanations, because he responds well to *the one who possesses the mystery of the union of the two opposing principles*, a union necessary for the creation of a new form of life. By performing this rite, the officiant *Ywn-mout-F* acts as the Creator by bringing about a new birth by the unfolding of unity.

This chapter would not be complete if I omitted another denomination of this high dignity of officiant, a denomination which *one encounters* in some texts and which is considered to be older. In these texts this priest is named *Ywn-Ken-Mout* (i T ZZ ,\*with I e determinative of a monkey or its skin.

At Beni Hassan we see a representation of a priest dressed in the ritual skin giving his hand to a monkey (Griffith Arch. Survey of Egypt Mem, V, part. 3).

The interpretation of the denomination *Ywn-Ken-Mout* suggests that the new life evoked by the celebrant during the ritual is obtained by means of a skin which plays the role of the mother. The idea that this symbolic mother had to be impregnated in order to be able to conceive is not rendered in this name, as it is in the expression *Ywn-Mout-F*. In the name *Ywn-Ken-Mout* it must be assumed.

In a representation of rebirth through the skin that we see in the tomb of Seti I, it is said that the skin is fertilized and gives life to the deceased "like grasshoppers and bees" (Schiaparelli: Libro di Funerali I. 66, Lefébure: Studies on Abydos etc...).

As to the word *Ken-Mout*, Mr. Crum believes that it was simply a qualification applying to a species of monkey and Mr. Lashington (Trans. Soc. Bibl. Arch. VI 526, VII 66) proposes to replace the sign K (𓆎) by its consonance *Ka* ([J]) this which would give the possibility of translating the word *Ken-Mout* by "Mother's Double".

I have presented this interpretation as information to show how much this mysterious name intrigues Egyptologists.

But it seems to me that by establishing the true meaning of the word *Mut-(t) F*, the meaning of the naming of the priest officiating the rite of rebirth through the skin becomes clear as, at the same time, that of other names where between this expression (eg that of one of the sons of Horus called *Dua-Mout-F*).

The main thing is to establish that in addition to the meaning "his mother" used in the spoken language, this same combination has an esoteric meaning symbolizing the principle of duplication which is the basis of all vital manifestation of Creation.

As one could judge by all that precedes, the current translation of the word *Mout-F* "his mother" does not contradict the esoteric significance of this expression.

When we say in the titles "his mother" this indicates *the means* by which a man came into the world. In order for this act to be realized, the Must had to be fertilized by the Tef or, in other words, that in the mother's body the mystery of the union of the two opposing principles had to be produced, the sine qua non starting point of the formation of a new individual being: the son.

I recall that the many goddesses who had the epithet "mother of Ra" symbolized the different forces of nature participating in the birth of the luminous star.

Thus we can say of the expression which is usually translated by the words "his mother" that it is the external form under which the spoken language buries the greatest mystery of life. Union-separation (the Vau of the Hebrews, the *Mout-F*)

Egyptians) occurs both in the seed and in the egg, because it is the starting point of all vital formation.

## VIII

## EXAMPLE OF INTERPRETATION OF THE HIDDEN MEANING OF HIEROGLYPHS

The hieroglyphic language possesses marvelous faculties of which purely phonetic languages are deprived. In addition to the possibility of expressing the language spoken by the phonetics of words, it represents by means of its ideography the composition of the object in question and, through the symbol attached to the sign, reveals the constructive essence of beings and things she names.

The Hebrew language inherited this particular faculty from hieroglyphics, which was so clearly demonstrated by F. d'Olivet in his marvelous work, "The Hebrew Language Restored".

The hieroglyphic language still awaits its F. d'Olivet to reveal its mystery; for the moment, we only know its phonetic part, which was established by a man of genius—Champollion—and developed in detail by the whole host of Egyptologists who followed him.

The esoteric side of the Egyptian language remains unknown or, more exactly, misunderstood. Scholars strive to reconstruct its complicated rules of etymology and syntax, and persist in not seeing that hieroglyphs, besides their stated meaning, which is moreover essential, possess a greater power of revelation and teaching. Again.

It is for this reason that philosophy, the essence of the religion of the hierophants, escapes us. Basing ourselves on religious texts, of which we only know the literal translations, we believe that this religion was childish, composed of superstitions, devoid of philosophy.

We know, however, that the Greek philosophers drew their wisdom from Egypt, just as the Asclepiades (Greek doctors) found there the fundamental principles of medicine. We also know that Moses could only create his religion thanks to

the teaching he received in the Egyptian temples. He only purified the ancient religion of this people by stripping it, so to speak, of its exoteric shell formed of the innumerable divinities who concretely symbolized the various manifestations of the one Creator God. He brought out this idea, hitherto hidden from the profane, by placing on his throne the Unique God and by teaching his people the adoration of this arbitrary idea.

But the result was not brilliant: the Hebrew people, little evolved, could not do without concrete representations and, as soon as Moses moved away, made "golden calves" for themselves to be able to adore something visible and understandable. for him.

This again shows the reason why the ancient religions, while being monotheistic in their esoteric part, nevertheless kept the pantheism necessary for the masses.

I have said that the roots of our philosophy as well as of our religion are lost in the secret teaching of the Egyptians — a doctrine which certainly cannot be discovered by means of the phonetic translation of the texts. — These were composed in two ways in order to provide on the one hand (by the exoteric part expressed in the spoken language) a religion sufficient for a mass of a fairly low level, and on the other hand a philosophical doctrine which does not could be understood only by one who was sufficiently evolved.

In my works, I have set myself the goal of revealing this hidden doctrine and showing the means that the hieroglyphic language possessed of being able to express different ideas simultaneously by the same signs.

The detailed exposure of this vast subject exceeds the frames of an article, I will therefore content myself with giving here an example of the way in which the Egyptians expressed by means of signs taken from everyday life the abstract idea of Creation. We will see on the other hand that the esoteric teaching of the Egyptians concerning creation contained the principles of that of Moses and that of the Creator Word of Saint John.

The texts teach us that before creation there existed a God "who lived alone in inactivity" ("Book of the Dead", Ch. XVII, pap. Ani, pap. Iuau, pap. Nebseni, etc.). Now Tem (this unique god whose name corresponds to the "Ancient of Days" of the Hebrew cabbalists) having decided on creation, wanted to found in his heart (in his intelligence), that is to say in principle ("In Arche » according to Saint John, « Bereshit » according to Moses) everything that was going to exist. For this he emerged from inactivity ("appeared above the surface of Nou", Papyrus Nesiamsu, Budge, page 540; pap. Leiden Aeg. Z. 42 page 31).

He performs the act of Creation by means of his Word (Brugsh, Religion and Mythol., page 111; Maspero History I, page 140; Leyden pap. Aeg. Z 42, 32; Na-ville, Variants, page 57 , etc.). "In the beginning was the Word", Saint John I, I.

Thus the divine Word was the beginning of creation and, so to speak, the tool by means of which everything was created.

The hieroglyph that expresses the word “speech” is the one that represents the mouth and its phonetics is “R”. The mouth is the organ through which the word is uttered, it is, so to speak, “the door” through which the Word comes out to manifest itself. Now the action of the creative Word is rendered hieroglyphically by the signs of the mouth (R) and that of the arm (A) (sign of action in general), which together gives the word RA. This word symbolizes the mouth in action and at the same time presents the name of the sun god — father of all the gods — (Ra-Hab, Egypt, country whose father was Ra. Psalm 87).

The visible form of this God-Word was the sun — the center emitting by its rays all phenomena of life. The name of the Word god was the same as that of the sun, because one was only the visible manifestation of the other.

In chapter XVII of the “Book of the Dead” (the one that teaches us the principles of creation) it is said, that in the beginning Ra rose on the sky to exercise his creative power. Now the sign represented by the sunrise and whose phonetics is KHA means simultaneously: sunrise and tool, instrument. Thus this passage of the Egyptian text has a double meaning: 1° it is the action of the Word which began (ordained) the Creation, and 2° the Word was the tool which the Creator used to carry out his thought. From the point of view of the ideography this sign represented the physical manifestation which was clear for any Egyptian, because he saw the sunrise of the first day which began the times. This same idea was stated by Moses: “and it was the morning of the first day” (Genesis 1.5.).

Thus the moment when the Logos manifested visibly was when the sun first appeared rising above the surface of the waters (of the Nou).

This brings us to understanding the esoteric meaning of another sign. To express the idea: to create, to do something, the Egyptians used the representation of the eye phonetically called YR. This sign is formed from that of the mouth R and that of the sun (which here represents the retina of the eye). Thus the sign of the eye could literally be translated “the sun in the mouth”. The hieroglyph YR unites in itself the double idea of Creation: that of the Word and that of its visible manifestation - the sun. The eye is precisely the physical organ that sees the manifested phenomenon, so its image is perfectly suited to express the idea of creation in reality: the man who sees the result of his work.

We find in the Bible the echo of this thought when the Creator contemplates the results of his work which HE finds each time satisfactory. “And God saw the light...and found it good...And God saw the land and the seas which he found good...And God saw the grass and the plants and judged them good...” etc. . (Genesis, 1, 4,10,12, etc.).

In the Egyptian texts it is said that the Creator “saw” (created) the earth and saw (created) the watery mass. In both cases the Egyptian priest who composed this text used the sign of the eye to express the creation in reality that the Creator contemplated.

But in the same text, speaking of the creation of mankind, the sage used another word. He says that the Creator "fashioned" (QMA) mankind. (Pap. Hu-Nefer, Hymn to Ra, Brit. mus. No. 9901 pl. 1, Lines 7-8). This word is composed of the sign of raw matter Q (the heap of sand, or formless matter) and that of the sickle Maa (one of the signs which symbolize justice, balance). The sign which determines this word is that of the finger. Thus the exact interpretation of this word which also expresses at first sight the idea of creating is: to shape, to form from raw material a balanced, harmonious thing, by means of one's fingers.

And here is what the Bible says about it: "And God formed man from the dust"... (Genesis II, 7).

Another sign which also relates to creation is that of the KHPR beetle which expresses the idea: "to occur, to make, to create, to transform". The ancient Egyptian knew that this insect reproduced by burying its egg in a pellet of garbage to make it hatch.

We find on the frescoes the idea of transformation rendered by a beetle holding between its legs a red disc symbolizing the rising sun, just as this insect rolls its ball of filth.

On the other hand, to express the verb: to be, to form or to transform, the sign of the beetle was added to that of the mouth (Logos). Grammatically this sign is called: the phonetic complement, but ideographically this word is dazzlingly clear and perfectly explains the idea of the continual transformation of life. The beetle stands above the mouth as if coming out of it, and in its front legs it raises the sun disk.

Thus the idea expressed by this image is that the Creator Word is transformed into visible manifestation, and the role of the Khepera beetle is to achieve this transformation.

The same idea of the cycle of life formed by the eternal transformation from the state of potentiality to the state of reality is rendered in several other ways in Egyptian mythology.

Another expression of the same idea.

"Horas in the two horizons" symbolizing the times of sunrise and sunset is yet another, as are also the two boats of the sun: that of the morning (Matet) and that of the evening (Sektet).

The idea of the eternal transformation of states was rendered in different ways in Egyptian teaching, but the sign of transformation itself was that of the beetle. Any vital manifestation once created followed the same cycle, where death infallibly followed birth, like the sunset that ends the day. But the sun is reborn the next day,

the night being the time of preparation for a new visible manifestation. Likewise death was not considered as the end, but only as a change of state, the rest during which the new manifestation, the resurrection, was prepared.

From this point of view, the Egyptian religion is significantly close to Christianity as well as to the conception of contemporary science which considers that nothing disappears, but only transforms from one state to another.

The interpretation of these few signs serves as an example of how the philosophical teaching of the hierophants could be hidden under hieroglyphs which the vulgar understood in an exoteric way. On the other hand, this example shows that the ideas placed at the base of later religions and philosophical schools were borrowed from the ancient teaching of Egyptian texts.

## TABLE OF HIEROGLYPHIC SIGNS USED IN THIS ARTICLE

|    |                                                                                   |      |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 7. |  | P    |
| 2. |  | Ro   |
| 3. |  | Ra   |
|    |  | Vr   |
|    |  | Khpr |
|    |  | Q    |
|    |  | Mo   |
|    |  | Qmo  |
|    |  | Qmo  |

1. — The mouth: door of speech.
2. — The action of the mouth: the Creative Word.
3. — The sun: visible manifestation of the Word.
4. — The eye: the sun in the mouth, meeting the principle of manifestation. Organ by means of which man contemplates the result of his work. Grammatically: verb: to do something, to actually create.
5. — The beetle: symbol of transformation and eternally renewable life. Grammatically: verb: to do, to

produce, be born, transform.

6. — The heap of sand or any raw material to be shaped by man.

7. — Sickle: man's work tool, symbol of justice.

8. — This sign represents a sketcher by means of which the artist executed the modelling. This can be seen by closely studying the colored hieroglyphs of Béni Hassan (See Griffith Béni Hassan Part III, 77 Arch. Survey of Egypt.).

It is, so to speak, "a wooden finger" that the sculptor uses to accomplish the delicate work of shaping the raw material.

Another word, whose phonetics is the same, QMA, and which, written in the same way, means: to throw, to throw.

It seems to me that, in this word, the sign which determines it and which resembles the first is not the same: it represents in this case a sort of throwing stick, a boomerang thrown to kill birds.

The sign of the flying bird which accompanies this word as a second determinative seems to confirm this supposition, because this hieroglyph means: to flutter, representing the particular flight of the boomerang.

9. — To shape, to form a thing by applying one's fingers.

## *THIRD PART*

## MEDICINE IN THE TIMES OF THE PHARAOHS

Until now, China was considered the cradle of medicine. The earliest known document was a treatise on medicine published 2700 BCE under the auspices of Chinese Emperor Chin-Nong. It was supposed that the knowledge of the Chinese had penetrated through the Indies to Egypt where it was borrowed by the Greek philosophers who founded the schools of Cnidus and Cos. The first was led by Pythagoras, Empedocles, Democritus—all initiates of the Egyptian temples. It was in this school that the art of diagnosing illnesses was taught, while the school of Cos, under the direction of Hippocrates, had set itself the goal of studying therapeutic methods. The latter were limited for the most part to diets and natural curative processes such as, for example, gymnastics. As medicines we used herbal teas, honey, etc.

It was only later, when the school of Alexandria was founded, that scholars such as Herophilus and Erasistratus taught the descriptive anatomy of the human body later developed by Galen. The latter, by carrying out dissections of corpses, came to know not only the structure of the skeleton but also the functions of the muscles, blood vessels, nerves and certain glands.

Thus we owe our first knowledge to the Greek doctors called asclepiades — priests of the cult of Asclepius or Aesculapius, god of medicine. This word is a Greek corruption of the name Imutes or Imhostep, god of medicine among the Egyptians and whose cult existed at the time of the New Kingdom. Ptolemy II Philadelphus had a small temple dedicated to this divinity built in Philae. We also find her represented in a temple of Deir-el Medina in Thebes as well as in a sanctuary dedicated to Thoth very close to the great temple of Ramses III in Medinet-Habou.

This character, who had become mythical during the New Kingdom and even elevated to the rank of god of medicine, had nevertheless really existed. The old inscriptions teach us that Imhôtep fulfilled two functions which apparently had nothing in common between them. He was both a doctor and an architect at the court of King Zoser (3rd<sup>dyn</sup>., around 3,000 BC).

Christ). It is perhaps even he who was the builder of the famous step pyramid of Saqqara intended to serve as a tomb for this pharaoh.

Currently we have reasons, which I will develop during this chapter, to suppose that already in these very moved back times there existed treatises of medicine written perhaps by Imhôtep himself or former to him.

Until the publication of a document which will be discussed later, we had every reason to believe that the medicine of ancient Egypt consisted of an art of healing, but not of a science based on experience. It was, so to speak, country witchcraft which made use of magic incantations and, as medicine, black goat's milk, monkey excrement, etc. Many of these bizarre recipes can be found in medieval grimoires, where the crushed bones of frogs, the claws of bats and the blood of goats played an important role.

The documents that we possessed until now were limited to a few fragments of medical papyri such as the Ebers papyrus, the Hearst papyrus, those of Berlin and London which all date back to 1,500-1,600 years BC. J.-C., except that of London which is about 1,000-1,100 years BC. J.-C.

I will not dwell on these works which, while presenting a certain interest, can only be considered as witchcraft documents and in no way as scientific writings.

In addition to these papyri, we find numerous stelae known as "healing stelae". The usual motif of these stelae was a representation of the god Horus the younger, standing on two crocodiles and holding in his hands scorpions, lions and gazelles. These steles, the finest example of which can be seen in the Cairo Museum, were of different sizes, ranging from 50 centimeters and more, to the small pocket stele executed in a rudimentary fashion. There were even small amulets which were worn around the neck and which had the same meaning. On the back of the stele was engraved a hieroglyphic inscription containing exorcisms against evil spirits and the higher the stele, the more important the inscription. Larger statues were placed on a stone pedestal in which a basin was carved. This kind of stele was called "Horus Savior" and it was attributed great healing power, especially against the bites of insects and poisonous snakes.

To obtain healing, water was poured on the stele; by flowing over its surface it washed away the texts, so to speak, and became impregnated with their magical force. This "holy" water flowed into the basin where it was drawn to treat the sick limb.

We also find, among objects of the same kind, healing statues, the finest example of which is also in the Cairo Museum. This statue was described by M. Daressy (*Annales du Service des Antiquités*, tome XVIII, Statue

of Zed-Hor the Savior). It represents the doctor Zed-Hor seated in the traditional pose of the scribes and having in front of him the stele of the Savior Horus. His whole body is covered with magical inscriptions and in the pedestal there is a basin similar to that of the healing stela. The bottom of this basin is also covered with inscriptions almost completely erased by the use that must have been made of it over the centuries. In the decipherable inscriptions we learn that the doctor Zed-Hor was proud of his art and that he had this magic statue executed so that humanity could enjoy its benefits even after his death.

I have expanded on the description of these statues to show that in certain respects the ancient Egyptians did not seem to differ from the peoples of central Africa among whom low magic or sorcery plays a preponderant role, each evil being considered as the attack of an evil spirit that must be fought and tamed. But such an assimilation is impossible for whoever observes the grandiose monuments of the ancient Egyptians, testifying to very extensive knowledge in mathematics, astronomy and other sciences where they reached perfection.

We have, moreover, proof that alongside superstitions medical knowledge flourished among them. Certain documents discovered at the beginning of the century indeed prove that even at a very remote time, they had made medicine a true science. Inscriptions found in a tomb at Giza (H. Junker: *Die Stèle des Hofarztes Iry*. *Zeitschr. für Aeg. Sprache* 63, 1927, pages 55-70) speak of a certain Iry who was the court physician. We learn that in those remote times (more than three thousand years BC) medical science was already divided into specialties: there were in particular oculists (doctors for the eyes), doctors for internal diseases (who bore the bizarre titles of: "He who gets along in internal fluids" and "Keeper of the anus"). Dentistry was also highly developed; one can see on a skull from the time of the Fourth Dynasty (about 2,900 years BC) how amazingly the jaw was pierced to empty an abscess apparently formed under a tooth. A modern dentist does not operate very differently. This operation is described in detail in the Edwin Smith papyrus which will be discussed later.

Finally, a document dating from the time of the Persian conquest (about 500 years BC) tells us that a certain Ousa-Hor-Resenet, whose statue is currently in the Vatican, had been charged by the king of the Persians to reconstitute in Heliopolis the school of medicine and the hospital "House of Life".

"I have done by Her Majesty's order," says the text engraved on the statue. I have equipped the two houses with students chosen from sons of good families. I provided them with all the instruments that were mentioned in the ancient scriptures, with everything that was once in these houses. Her Majesty did all this because she knew the value of this art and in order to save the life of any sick man".

This seems to indicate clearly that there had once existed a medical school in Heliopolis and that it had been destroyed by the barbarians since it is said that it was reconstituted by order of the king of the Persians. Moreover, we find here evidence of the existence, at that time, of medical instruments described in the special treatises.

All this testifies in favor of our thesis that medicine was already very developed at the time of the Old Empire and that it was not limited to practices of low magic.

On the other hand, we find, in the Ebers papyrus, a passage, concerning the heart, which is said to have been "copied from a very ancient document called the Doctor's Secret Book" and again, in the Edwin Smith papyrus, two mentions of old medical writings, one of which is entitled "What concerns a wound" and the other "Treatise concerning the embalmer".

The fact that in these texts dating from the time of the New Kingdom, there is question of very old works mentioning medical treatments, this fact supports the hypothesis of a science well established since the most remote times and possessing specialized branches. For example, tracheostomy was practiced from the first dynasties (see the tablets of King Aha from Abydos and those of King Djer found at Saqqara, on which this operation was called "giving air". (Monuments Archaiques IV-Vo- V. Vikentiev.) Finally, the publication of the surgical papyrus discovered by Edwin Smith (Breasted Edwin Smith's Surgical Papyrus) provides irrefutable proof that surgery was really a science in ancient Egypt.

Unfortunately, neither the title nor a large part of this interesting document has come down to us, but it can be established that it predates the Ebers papyrus, considered until now to be the oldest of the same kind.

It presents a methodical treatise on surgery which could have been taught in a medical school. It begins with injuries to the head, with or without skull fracture, then descends to the neck, shoulders, chest and, presumably, continues to the lower body. Unfortunately the text that has come down to us stops at the thorax.

The methodical statement of the different cases according to their location and according to their severity distinguishes this document from all those of the same kind known to date, where the different diseases are mixed and where it is often difficult to distinguish a case of another and to clearly identify the prescribed treatment.

In the Smith papyrus, on the contrary, we find order and clarity: just as in a modern course, each case is clearly defined and divided into three distinct parts: the examination, the prognosis and the treatment. Prognosis considers three eventualities: certainty, possibility, impossibility of cure. This last verdict above all is interesting because it proves that the work's sole purpose, like the other papyri, is not to indicate recipes for healing, but that it is indeed a treatise of a scientific nature striving to establish the diagnosis of hopeless cases with as much precision as that of cases

curable. This denotes in the observer a rational method and a purely scientific concern.

To realize up to what point the prognosis of the Egyptian doctor was just, we can quote here what Dr. Luckhardt said of it when consulted by Mr. Breasted on this subject: most would be almost as much now”<sup>56</sup>. These cases, 14 in number, include fractures of the skull with rupture of the meninges, perforations of the temple, fractures of the cervical vertebrae, etc...

But what is most precious in this papyrus are the comments or explanations added to each case. These explanations allow us to see that the text in question is not the original but the copy of an older document. At the time when this copy was established, that is to say around the 16th or 17th<sup>century</sup> BC · J.-C., certain expressions of the original document had become incomprehensible. To make it easier for his contemporaries to read, a man versed in the old terminology, perhaps a doctor himself, added his comments to each questionable word, thus shedding light on a number of archaic expressions. These explanations are written in the clearest manner, using comparisons taken from everyday life. For example, in some cases it is said that the patient must be "attached to his moorings", an expression which usually applied to a boat moored in port. The commentary indicates that this expression meant that the patient should be put on his usual diet. To give an idea of the external appearance of the brain, he compares it to the wrinkled bark which forms on the copper at the time of the melting and which the worker rejects before pouring the molten copper into the mould.

When the doctor raises his hand to auscultate a wound with a fracture of the skull, he feels, says the old text, palpitations similar to those "of a struggling bird unable to fly away". This expression is translated by the commentator as follows: "When you place your hand on such a wound, you feel palpitations as in a newborn child whose two cranial lobes are not yet united". This does indeed give the impression of the pulsations of exposed cerebral matter.

As I have just said, these commentaries allow us to judge with certainty of the antiquity of Egyptian medicine since already, at the time of the papyrus, certain expressions used in the original had become incomprehensible and required explanatory notes.

On the other hand, this precious document proves to us that the Egyptians already possessed, at that distant time, very advanced knowledge of anatomy and that they were not unaware of the functions of certain organs. They knew, for example, that a lesion of the brain could lead to the paralysis of one or more limbs depending on the affected part of the cerebral material.

We also learn there that the doctor knew how to count the pulse, a discovery attributed until now to Greek practitioners. The Smith papyrus specifies the different places in the body where the pulse, "the heart which speaks" according to the figurative expression of the Egyptians, is the easiest to find (at the temple, the neck, the wrist, the leg). This revelation makes us suppose that at that time the Egyptians must have had portable watches, because what possibility would they have had of counting the pulse without an instrument measuring time?

We know that the Egyptians used sundials to mark the hours of the day and clepsydras (water clocks) for those of the night, but so far only one portable watch has been found in the excavations. of Geser in Palestine, bearing the name of Mer-Nef-Tah (13th century BC)<sup>57</sup>.

Finally in the Ebers papyrus (99,12-13) it is said: "As regards the air which enters through the nose, it penetrates towards the heart and the lungs and is carried throughout the body". This proves that the Egyptians were well aware of the role of human breathing.

For treatments, we learn that the doctor stuck to natural processes such as diet and rest. Open wounds were treated with applications of fresh meat "on the first day" and then with a soothing ointment composed of oil and honey.

On the other hand, the way of closing the edges of a wound sensibly resembled the process employed today. For benign wounds, "two bands" applied crosswise were used. The more serious wounds were stitched up, as at present; we find proof of this in some mummies where the surgical seam has been preserved. Finally, fractures were treated by the same methods as at present, by immobilizing the limb in a gutter with strips of linen and plaster, work which was entrusted to the greatest specialist in this art, the embalmer.

We also find mention of hard wooden plugs lined with bandages, used for example in cases of tetanus to introduce liquid food by spreading the teeth, and of soft plugs: a bandage rolled up on itself used, for example, to reduce a fracture of the nasal bone called by the Egyptians "the column of the nose".

The enumeration of all the different procedures of surgical treatment employed by the physicians of ancient Egypt would go beyond the framework of this chapter, but I will give to finish, by way of example, the literal translation of a case exposed in the papyrus Smith<sup>58</sup>.

## INSTRUCTIONS FOR A GAPING WOUND IN HIS HEAD PENETRATING TO THE BONE WITH

## PERFORATION OF THE SUTURES OF HIS SKULL

### *First review*

If you examine a man with a gaping wound in his head, penetrating to the bone with perforation of the sutures of the skull, you must feel the wound, although the patient is shaking very strongly. You will have to raise his face; if it is painful for him to open his mouth and if his heart beats weakly; if you observe the saliva hanging from his two lips not falling to the ground and if he discharges blood from his two nostrils and his two ears; if he suffers from sore neck and cannot look at both his shoulders (turn his head) and his chest (lower his head)...

### *First diagnosis*

You must say about him: he who has a gaping wound in his head penetrating to the bone with perforation of the sutures of his skull, the cord of his maxilla contracted, he discharges blood from his two nostrils and from his two ears and suffers from aches in the neck: an ailment with which I will fight.

### *First treatment*

As soon as you find that the lower maxillary cord of his jaw is contracted you will have to prepare him something warm to comfort him and to make his mouth open; you must bandage it with oil and honey applied to linen until you know that it has reached the decisive point ( “ crisis ” according to the terminology of Hippocrates).

### *Second review*

If then you find that this man's body has produced heat from this wound which is in the sutures of his skull and that this man has developed "tya" (tetanus?) from this wound, you must place your hand on him. If you notice that his face is wet with perspiration, if the ligaments of his neck are tense, if his face is colored, if his teeth and

his back is stiff, if the smell of the trunk of his head is "bkn" of mutton, if his mouth is clenched and his two eyebrows are drawn together and his face looks like he's crying...

### *Second diagnosis*

You must say about him: the one who has a gaping wound in his head penetrating to the bone, puncturing the sutures of the skull, and who has developed the "tya" his mouth is tight and he suffers from stiffness in the neck: an evil that cannot be cured.

### *Third review*

If you find that this man has turned pale and already has the signs of relaxation...

### *Third diagnosis*

You have to make for him a wooden wedge covered with linen that you will insert in his mouth, you have to prepare him a fruit drink "Wah" (carob?). Its treatment is (position): sit place it between two supports of bricks until the moment when you will know that it reached the decisive point (crisis).

### *Comments*

1. — As regards “the perforation of the sutures of the skull”: this means: what is between shell and shell of the skull and that the sutures are in skin (sic).
2. — Regarding “the string of his maxilla which is contracted”: this means a stiffness of the ligaments at the end of his fork (sigmoid indentation of the lower jaw which has the appearance of a fork) which are attached to the ‘temple bone, this is at the end of his jaw, operating his movement back and forth so that it is not easy for him to open his mouth because of the pain.
3. — As regards “the cord of his jawbone”: that means the ligaments which attach the end of his jaw as one would say “the cord of a thing in a spring”<sup>59</sup>.

4. "As for 'his sweaty face': that means his head is a bit sticky."
5. "Regarding 'the ligaments in his neck which are stiff': this means that the attachments to his neck are tight.
6. — As regards "his face is colored": this means that the color of his face is red like that of the fruit Tmst. (An unknown fruit.)
7. — With regard to "the smell of the trunk of his head is like the Bkn of the sheep": this means that the smell of the crown of the skull is that of the urine of the sheep.
8. "As for 'the chest of the head': that means the middle of his skull enveloping his brain, which looks like a chest.
- 9• — Regarding "his mouth is tight, his face is as if he were crying": this means that he cannot open his mouth to speak, his two eyebrows are distorted, one pulled up and the other falling down, like the one who blinks when he cries.
10. — As regards "he is pale and shows a relaxation": this means as regards his pallor that he is in the case of which it is said: "To take charge of him and not to abandon him" in view of the relaxation that has begun. (This sentence is probably quoted by the commentator of an older document. papyrus, we find the negative form: "Do not take it, it is incurable" (41.15).

The meaning of the last passage is easy enough to understand: When a relaxation of disease manifests itself, and it occurs naturally, it is the duty of the physician to undertake treatment in order to assist the forces of nature.

I gave this case as an example to show the methodical quality that characterizes this treatise.

As can be seen, this example indicates three examinations of the patient which the doctor must undertake at different times. After the first examination, performed probably immediately after the accident, the diagnosis shows that the surgeon considered the case to be treatable. Treatment consists of warm applications and soothing ointments.

The second examination shows a worsening of the evil a fever declared as well as a mysterious affection called tya which, according to the symptoms, would resemble tetanus. The doctor finds that the case has become hopeless and does not prescribe any treatment.

However, as can be judged from the third examination, the disease did not follow the fatal course which the second examination had led the doctor to foresee. On the contrary, the fever has abandoned the patient and, in general, the evil seems to take a favorable turn which incites a resumption of treatment.

After this third examination, the doctor therefore seems to have regained hope and the treatment he prescribes consists of placing the patient in a seated position and having him absorb, by force if necessary, liquid food.

The numerous commentaries of the contemporary practitioner of the papyrus explain many words and expressions which might otherwise have been misinterpreted, not only by us but also, apparently, by the Egyptians of the time when this treatise on surgery was reproduced. .

Persons more particularly interested in this question will find many other cases set forth and discussed in detail in the magnificent work which we owe to Mr. Breasted.

## UNKNOWN RADIATIONS

I read in a major English daily that two electrical engineers, during experiments on high voltage currents, saw forming above the machine a kind of gray nebula from which emerged a very clear human hand where the 'we could even distinguish the lines of the palm.

The vision lasted about thirty seconds and then faded. The next day the experiments were resumed. The engineers were equipped with cameras to check, if necessary, the reality of the phenomena. Several days passed without particular incident, when, suddenly, they saw forming the nebula in the same place as the first time, and presenting the profile of an elderly woman.

This demonstration lasted long enough to be photographed. The developed film confirmed the observation by eliminating the hypothesis of any hallucination.

In Germany, under analogous conditions, the same phenomena repeated themselves on several occasions.

The foregoing awakened in my mind the memory of observations of the same order.

From 1912 until the declaration of the first war I pursued certain works on the electromagnetic radiations which one can check in all the fields of the sensitive world where we live. These manifestations are in short only modalities of the immeasurable force of nature. It is the energy which comes from the activity generated by the cosmic currents. The tradition of which certain vestiges have come down to us affirms that the Atlanteans used this energy to move their flying boats.

The neural currents of living beings find their use in healing magnetism. They can be easily controlled by photography. Each being contains them at a more or less high potential. The lines radiating from the magnetic currents of the hand are very interesting to study. These rays present very different variations according to the state of health or spirit of the subject. A discomfort, an emotion determine disturbances which appear very clearly on the plate

photographic.

Spiritualistic phenomena are for the most part only manifestations of the magnetic force. The assistants constitute a chain which leads to the medium, condenser of this force, by which it is translated into various vibrations likely to affect our senses. The same electro-magnetic force also manifests itself in inert bodies. Everyone knows the bracelets or rings of pewter or copper which have the power to relieve rheumatic pains.

Here is another experience worth remembering. We take a small ivory cylinder one centimeter in diameter suspended by a thread of cocoon silk. By placing this cylinder one millimeter from a second identical cylinder, we see that the first rotates around its axis counterclockwise. Care must be taken to place the device under a glass bell jar in order to annihilate air displacements, heat currents, nervous fluid radiation which could in certain cases cause the rotation of the cylinder.

The importance of the results obtained in this experiment varies greatly according to the material used. There are also rotations in the opposite direction to that which has just been mentioned.

The framework of this chapter does not allow to engage in a study of any importance on these interesting and little known phenomena.

I will only say a few words about the experiments to which I gave myself up and during which I obtained manifestations of the same order as those described above.

I used two electric plate machines placed at varying distances. Sometimes a field formed between the plateaus where phenomena of materialization took place. These materializations could be photographed.

The war put an end to my work. And, since 1918, a combination of unfortunate circumstances has prevented me from resuming these captivating experiments, the results of which deserve to be compared to those obtained by the English engineers.

According to information (Côte d'Azur Médicale), certain physiologists draw analogies between the effects of high frequency currents on the one hand and those of telepathy or various metapsychic phenomena on the other.

## THE IMPRINT OF THE GESTURE

Everyone knows these purplish spots named by the official medicine *nevus congenitalis* or birthmarks. They most often appear on the face and extend over a more or less large surface. Sometimes they disfigure a very pretty person, causing her lifelong torment. Medicine failed to cure them. We have tried surgery, the grafting of another epidermis in place of the colored one, heat treatments and recently radium. In the majority of cases, these methods result in failures when they do not cause serious disorders in the tissues, the outcome of which may even be cancer. Under these conditions, evil, unsightly as it was, can become fatal.

The cause of these spots has not been defined. The popular belief is that they are due to a fright experienced during her pregnancy by the mother who, instinctively, would have brought her hand to the same place on her body where the neavus of the child will be.

Is this belief justified and, once again, is the *vox populi* right?

The above explanation may be a reminiscence of ancient knowledge preserved in the memory of peoples and forgotten by current scholars who claim to analyze everything in the light of their hypotheses.

Here are a few cases that I have personally observed that seem to confirm popular beliefs.

A mother had a violent emotion when she saw from her window a horse run wild and knock down a passer-by. She immediately raised her hand to her face. The child born a month later had on the same side of the face one of these spots, about the size of the hand.

Another pregnant woman was startled by a mouse climbing up the sleeve of her dress and crushing it with an unconscious wave of her hand. The child, at birth, had on the same arm a greyish spot in the shape of a mouse. Subsequently this spot even covered itself with hairs and exactly recalled the appearance of the little animal.

Finally a mother, a few days before her delivery, learned of the death of a relative and was very impressed. His first movement was to make a sign of the cross. Oddly enough, the newborn had a red mark in the shape of a cross on his left shoulder.

The preceding cases, which I have had the opportunity to observe, have convinced me that here, once again, the popular belief was well founded.

From the point of view of ancient occult science, these phenomena are quite easily explained.

Ancient traditions teach that once the word of man had creative power. If we happen to pronounce a name, the latter evokes in our mind a mental image that we can translate, by drawing, into a tangible image.

Formerly the verb of the man, accompanied by the gesture, gave life to the name which he pronounced. He had creative power. The memory of this power we find it in the ancient languages, sacred languages, in which the gesture represented by the hieroglyph of the letter carries in itself the ideas of creative force of the thing envisaged.

Our contemporary idioms have lost this power, our verb has become an empty sound, our gesture is out of harmony with nature.

We are forced to shape matter to give it shape. But there are times when unconsciously we cross the walls of our prison. We see at distances beyond the reach of our visual organ, we create an image that lives, if only for an instant; but it lives and is perceptible to others. Finally, without resorting to the TSF, we can communicate with a loved one who is far away.

Everyone in his life can evoke facts of this kind, without being able to explain the mechanism and even less to reproduce them. They are fleeting like the spark, nothing announces their approach and they come to an abrupt end. Often they are accompanied by great anguish or extreme nervous tension, for example in the appearance of a loved one at the time of his death. Other times, on the contrary, the phenomenon occurs when one enjoys absolute calm and perfect tranquility.

In the pregnant woman, all the subconscious forces of the organism are concentrated in view of the mysterious work of creation. It is evident that under these conditions any emotion whatsoever is violently transmitted to the region where the neurotic force is localized. In this state, the gesture regains its primitive form, giving the child the indelible imprint.

## ON THE WEST BANK OF THE NILE

The felucca touched the sandy bottom and stopped. While his grandson was bringing in the sail, the old native boatman got up heavily and went knee-deep in the water of the river to help his passenger reach the bank. When the traveler was ashore, he handed her a large package wrapped in cloth.

— “Abdul,” said the stranger, “you will come and take me here tomorrow at dawn. »

— “At dawn, master, it is understood. And the old man stared at the man who was already climbing the slight slope and approaching the little Sudanese who was waiting for him, holding a donkey by the bridle.

Abdul's dark eyes regarded the stranger with an indefinable expression of fear and disapproval. He said nothing and, after a long thoughtful look, got back into his boat.

— “Where is he going, grandpa? the boy asked anxiously. “Where will he sleep? He doesn't intend to spend the night in the afrit-haunted caverns? (The Afrits, in Arabic, are evil spirits.)

— “It's none of our business,” said the old man. Infidels have their ways, ways we don't understand. The afrits do not understand them either. In any case the infidels do not seem to fear demons. It's none of our business. Allah is great and gives everyone the path they should follow... Sail! »

He pushed on his pole and the felucca moved away from the shore.

The European straddled his donkey, holding the package in front of him, across the saddle.

— “I don't need you Sayed, go with Abdul and be here at dawn. »

— “But, my master, said the Sudanese, his eyes wide with terror, you are not going to stay there the night?...”

— “Enough, do what I ask of you. »

He kicked the donkey, which began to trot slowly.

Sayed, shivering, looked at the departing man and, running towards the Nile, hailed the felucca. The boat had already left the

but, at the boy's call, Abdul returned and Sayed climbed aboard. The Sudanese made no remark; his eyes followed the stranger until he disappeared behind the cane stalks.

— "So he didn't want to take you with him?" exclaimed little Moussa after he had hoisted the sail. His eyes popped out of their sockets but his terror only loosened his tongue.

— "What's the matter? Do you think he found a treasure? Won't the afrits prevent him from taking it?" »

— "Enough babbling," said the old man. Go to the bow, roll up the rope. »

The felucca glided gently over the water golden in the rays of the setting sun; nothing disturbed the silence, except a murmur from the old man: "Great is Allah, Allah is great." »

The stranger rode nonstop through a narrow path through plantations of sugar cane, onions, and corn. It was heading towards reddish cliffs about two miles to the west. The terrain rose gently and soon the traveler, leaving the area of cultivated fields, found himself on a stony track. The donkey's hooves rang on the stones.

The European knew his way, for almost at the end of the track he turned sharply on a barely visible path that wound among the hillocks to arrive at a narrow ravine. The shadows were already settling in this rocky defile. The place was desolate, lonely, mysterious. Not a patch of greenery brightened the dark grayness of the stones, not a breath of air suggested life. The path rose, becoming harder and more impassable with each step.

An hour later, the traveler found himself at the top of the cliffs. The landscape was bare, sad, the red cliffs were interspersed with layers of limestone. The sun near the horizon accentuated the shadows, and long lines of dark purple made the landscape look almost sinister.

Our traveler, after a quick halt to locate his route, descended the slope between the chaotic rocks. The donkey advanced only with difficulty, sometimes being forced to slide on the haunches. At the bottom of the arid valley, the traveler found himself in a depression a hundred meters wide with a few clumps of thorny plants and gray with dust. He unsaddled his donkey, hobbled it and left it to graze on the meager stalks.

Quite hastily, for the sun had already set, the bold traveler went on foot to a small rise and began to scale it. Darkness was coming quickly and the first stars appeared.

Halfway up he stopped and slipped behind a rock where there was a hole: the opening of a tomb. Switching on a flashlight, he crouched down and crawled into the entrance of the cave, dragging his package after him. After a few meters the narrow passage widens, allowing him to walk upright. Another hundred yards and he found himself in a room

carved into the rock. The walls bore neither paint nor hieroglyphs; evidently the construction of the tomb had been hasty and the work had not been finished.

In the middle of the chamber was a carved stone sarcophagus with the goddesses of protection at the four corners, their arms extended alongside the coffin. The lid, also of stone, lay next to it, broken into three parts. In the sarcophagus was a painted wooden coffin, also broken and some pieces of which were lying on the ground.

The mummy in the coffin had been disturbed in its eternal sleep, probably by thieves. The brownish swaddling clothes had been torn and tossed into a corner. A hand disarticulated roughly at the wrist - probably to remove the bracelets - rested close to the body. His fingers were clenched into a threatening fist. The head, free, rested calm and beautiful; the closed eyes seemed to stare at the intruder through their leathery lids. Silent and motionless, the whole body of the man—sleep for four thousand years—seemed vibrant with life and thought.

The stranger approached the sarcophagus and, directing the rays of his lamp on the face of the deceased, looked at him with compassion and deference.

In a corner he took a small folding table, brought during his last visit, and deposited his package on it, which he began to unpack. He took out a white tablecloth with which he covered the table and on which he placed strange objects: earthenware pots, a bronze "sign of life" held between two outstretched hands, in which he adjusted a wick whose other end rested in a small flat vase which he filled with oil, the whole forming a lamp. Four other small vases were filled with water; in a censer he put coal. Various other objects were placed on the table. This done, the stranger undressed, wrapped his hips in a white linen cloth, and threw the skin of a panther over his shoulders. A strange hairstyle and old-fashioned sandals completed her attire.

These preparations finished, he lit the wick of the lamp and the coal of the censer by blowing on the embers. Then taking a roll of papyrus browned by time, covered with hieroglyphics painted in black and red, he began to read in a monotonous voice, pronouncing this unknown language with difficulty. From time to time he went around the sarcophagus pouring water on the ground. Grains of incense, thrown on the charcoal, formed a blue cloud in the room and the air became heavy with an aromatic perfume.

The rite over, the stranger stood for a moment in front of the sarcophagus. Raising his right hand in which he held a strangely shaped wand he exclaimed:

— Osiris Ankh Ma Hor. Osiris Ankh Ma Hor! Osiris Ankh Ma Hor!

Nothing moved.

The light burned without flickering, the spirals of smoke hardly stirred in the still air of this subterranean chamber.

“Did I make a mistake? wondered the stranger. Isn't it true, everything I've learned? But maybe I did not understand the text correctly? ". He read the papyrus again. No, everything had been done to the letter.

To be on the safe side, he re-read the rite aloud.

Nothing.

Doubt and disillusion began to invade his mind. So many years of study for nothing? Was the ancient papyrus just a farce? So there was nothing true in this ancient science? And, in the grip of doubt, his twentieth-century mentality <sup>revolted</sup> against the idea that magic could be a science. Wasn't she an ancient aberration? a superstition for the use of the simple, the credulous who did not know the laws of nature?

How could he believe...

He once again examined the papyrus with anguished intensity. Suddenly his gaze fell on a hieroglyph he had omitted. Surely the sign was there earlier? or was it not there?... A small circle and two dots in the middle, below three vertical lines. It meant: “Read three times”.

Should he? Was he ready to face the Unknown?

Yes, whatever would happen!...

With a great effort of will he repeated the rite a third time, ending with the triple exclamation: “Osiris Ankh Ma Hor”.

A cold breath suddenly passed through this subterranean chamber, a damp, icy wind. Incense smoke swirled; the light from the oil lamp rose in brilliant flame, flickered, then went out.

The stranger stood still, tense, in the total darkness of the underground, his raised arm still clutching the wand. His eyes sought to penetrate the darkness, his ears to pick up the slightest noise.

From the sarcophagus came dry cracks... Then there was silence.

Now a light was forming above the sarcophagus, a pale, phosphorescent glow. It loomed in a fold of incense smoke, seeming to shimmer like a luminous spark in the sarcophagus itself. She was gaining strength and taking shape, rising in a pale column.

The intruder's eyes burned. He couldn't believe his senses. In absolute silence, this mysterious manifestation was terrifying.

The column assumed a standing human form, draped in long pleated robes. Two points of light—the eyes—terrible eyes, stared at him with penetrating intensity. It seemed to the terrified stranger that those eyes were piercing him to the depths of his soul; his body stiffened as if under the action of hypnosis. His gaze was held by that of the apparition as by an unbreakable bond.

The face of the apparition took shape in its entirety: a beautiful, chiseled, lean face with high cheekbones, a high forehead divided by a line that accentuated the arched eyebrows above the deep eyes. The mouth was firm, the lips thin, the expression cruel with a sardonic grin.

A spectator would not have perceived a breath, the thin lips of the apparition did not move but the stranger received the thoughts of the specter as if hearing them in articulated sentences. No language was used: simply the communication of one thought to another.

This is what the specter manifested:

"You, a living being, have come to disturb my rest... You are not the first... The others came to steal my goods, deprive me of my protections and my pleasures... I could not prevent looting, but the formula is still effective and all who stole the amulet are dead. The amulet still brings bad luck to those who touch it, but it can no longer protect my body.

"Why did you come? O stupid man! There is nothing left to steal. Yet I'm glad you opened my mouth, because you're the first living being I can talk to. For centuries I have been silent with the desire to speak.

"Before annihilating you I will tell you things that you do not suspect. More, even, than you can imagine. We have time — all the time — because time is only torture.

"If it were possible for me, I would bind you forever as I was hey, without hope of progress, nor even of regression. But I cannot. On this earth, only the incarnate can tie a knot.

"Fools! We were looking for life on earth. We believed we could change the laws of Nature and preserve man in his integrity. We had made the body imperishable and we had attached the soul to it. We had prepared food for the body and, for our pleasures, we had engraved on the walls of the paintings that we could make alive.

"Ignorants! We had planned the life beyond the grave as an earthly life, with the same joys and the same pleasures.

We did not understand that life is only a test for the soul and that the physical body is its prison. By binding the soul to the mummy, we have imprisoned it forever.

"I was one of those vain fools!" I was a priest and a magician. I boasted of my knowledge and many were the victims I thus bound for eternity. So it was done to me in my turn and I remain hopelessly bound to the earth, enduring nameless sufferings. This is the real hell and man created it himself by hindering his Destiny.

"I would like to make you suffer as I suffer! If only I could chain you forever! For countless centuries we could exchange our thoughts, our hatreds. But it is no longer in my power. When I strike you, your free soul will leave your body and fly away, liberated, towards Light, progress, new experiences, new joys, new sufferings. Ah! why can't I have my revenge on you, on you who dared to force my eternal silence! »

The receptive faculty of the stranger registered these words of misery and hatred of the disembodied. His fear disappeared, replaced by deep compassion.

— "My poor brother, my poor brother, how I sympathize with you! thought the living man.

The ghost picked up the compassionate vibration and his answer came, quick:

— "What do you mean? Aren't you happy to see me helpless? Aren't you proud that I can't do anything worse than free your soul? Are you not enjoying your earthly life? Don't you have ties, affections? I do not believe. Laugh at me, because you're free and I can't chain you next to me! Laugh! Triumph of your superiority! »

— "No, my brother," replied the stranger mentally, "I came neither to steal nor to mock. I came with my brotherly love. I seek to help you and all who suffer like you. »

— "Help me? What do you mean? And why? How will you benefit from it? I can't pay you because everything in my body was stolen a long time ago. Love? what is the connection between us? »

— "We are human beings, so we are brothers. Since your earthly life, many changes have taken place on earth. Humanity had become demonic. Then God sent a Messenger, His Only Son, who demonstrated the uselessness of wealth, who lifted the veil of death and who taught the Only Way of life and eternal happiness: the Way of Love. Men must love each other, because they are sparks emanating from the same Light: the Creator. »

— "It's new," came the ghost's thought. When I lived there were Teachers who taught justice to the poor as well as to the rich, but they promised us only perpetual earthly life and that the memory of the pure man would never be forgotten. Tell me, is this new doctrine universally followed? »

— " Alas no ! It was taught to us in bright and clear words, but those who follow the law are few. Men continue to hate each other; they struggle for power and wealth. Blood is spilled on earth. »

— "Oh! mentally replied the ghost, this new teaching is only empty words and its seeds fall on stony ground. It was always like that. But I sense that you have no hostile feelings for me. Are you the prophet of this new faith? »

— "I'm just an unworthy disciple, but I recognize my flaws and try to improve myself. I am weak. You ask me why I'm here in your burial chamber? I have studied at length the customs of your country, of your time and your modes of burial. I am saddened to think of the sufferings of your souls eternally attached to your body. I learned how the bond was established, but I don't know how to untie it. That's what I want to know: How do you free your souls? »

The face of the specter quivered, the hard fold of the lips softened. A light scent fills the room. And the stranger understood the ghost's answer:

— "Bless the gods! Blessed be the gods who sent me your help. I believe you, because I feel the truth of your words. I'll help you, I'll let you in on the secret, so you can set my soul free..."

The red disk of the sun was rising above the horizon when the stranger returned to the waiting felucca. Abdul was busy with the sail and avoided his passenger's gaze, but Moussa stared at him in terror, like an apparition from the Beyond.

The felucca reached the open sea. Unconsciously, the stranger lifted his helmet and wiped his brow.

— Look, look, grandfather! Her hair is all white!

— Be quiet, growled the boatman who gently resumed his eternal murmur: "Great is Allah. God is great ".

## THE SOUL OF THE SPHINX

Very often I have contemplated the Sphinx, this astonishing achievement of human art. I did it each time with admiration and respect.

Which artist designed such a grandiose monument? Which workers carried out this titanic work? We believe that its design belongs to the art of the fourth dynasty, its construction is attributed to the workers of Chephren, we venerate it for its great age which, we believe, exceeds five thousand years. But we have no certainty of all this. We only know, by the inscription engraved on the granite plate erected between its legs, that in the 15th<sup>century</sup> BC. Thutmes IV freed the Sphinx from the sand that covered it

The date of its erection, the name of its inspiration and that of its director are still unknown to us and we can only make more or less exact assumptions about them.

All these thoughts crossed my mind as I gazed once more at the immortal and majestic monument.

The sun was setting and its bloody disc tinged the golden desert sand pink. Behind me lay the valley of the Nile; the silvery river flowed peacefully, carrying for millennia fertile life to the thirsty lands, nourishing artery of the ancient land, Eternal Father Osiris reborn, Mother Isis eternal producer.

Night was approaching, an Egyptian night of splendor and calm. The dying sun shone with faith and certainty in his resurrection the next day.

Before me stood the Sphinx, the one who, for centuries, with his eyes always wide open, contemplates, dawn after dawn, the birth of days, the motionless and immutable Sphinx, with his eternal smile where all Wisdom seems to hold.

The more I stared at his mysterious face, the more he seemed to smile at me and the more that smile troubled me.

What could this strange creature think? But did she think?... Certainly her knowledge and her wisdom must be immense, too.

great as the events which paraded, in the course of long History, before his gazing eyes: the elevation and grandeur of Egypt, its deified monarchs, its magnificent civilization, its wars, its revolutions, its rise followed by its decadence. and finally its final destruction, the invasion of the barbarians, the desolation, then the great silence disturbed only by the wind pushing the sand of the desert.

As I thought, concentrating my gaze on this silent witness of the ages, it seemed to me that the enormous head was moving. A kind of vapor emanating from itself enveloped him in a cloud that spread more and more and seemed to cover the whole sky, the whole universe. And in this cloud I distinctly saw the features of the same face, the same enigmatic smile, the same distant gaze, but all immaterial, idealized.

It was the soul of this body of stone, attached to it by the thought of the builder, it was the immortal idea of which this monument was the incarnation.

And it seemed to me that I heard him speak...

Was it the breath of the wind or the murmur of the sands sliding along the stone in their eternal movement? Was it the echo of voices and noises from the distant village? I do not know.

I cannot even say that I heard his voice. But I understood the meaning of his words as if they had been spoken to me, I understood the reason for that mysterious smile, I saw a glimmer of life in the distant gaze.

And this is what he told me:

— “I am Tem, the Unique, the Reason of Life, the only Source of all existence.

“I am the one who was before time. Before the sun rose for the first time to light up the world, I existed.

“Ra is the word emanating from me to illuminate the universe and enlighten the reason of men.

“I spoke my Word and the Light came to life in the form of the sun which rose above the horizon. Its rays bring life and light because they emanate from my word.

“I am the Mother who conceived all life, I am the Father who engendered all living beings. I have no father, no mother because I myself am the Unique generator, the Only principle of all life. I alone am the father and mother of all beings, the One Source of all existence.

“I am the one of Millions of Years, the One who always existed and whose life is Eternity.

“My image is in every manifestation of life. I created man in my image.

“One generation passes to another among men and I, who conceived the idea of all life, have hidden myself.

" Whether I 'm served my way, made of precious stones or fashioned of copper, like water replaced by water.

"There is no current that suffers from being held back: it breaks the dam that captures it. Likewise I do not suffer from being imprisoned in a visible form.

"My reflection has been in this image of stone since the Universe exists, shaped by those who lived to glorify me on earth and I will live in this image until the end.

"But the man must not confuse me with this image, because I am not her and she is not me. It is the visible reflection of my glory, erected to teach man to serve me and adore me in his own way.

"When man forgot that he was only one creature among the thousand of my creations, I destroyed him and I allowed my image to disappear, to be covered with sands for thousands of years. But then came men for whose reason I unveiled the great mystery of my Being, they understood and adored me and I allowed them to discover my image and venerate me.

"This happened many millennia ago; my image has remained uncovered since then and other men adore me under other names. I live in their hearts and in their temples, in other forms, but this eternal image of me is not adored because they do not know that I am the same, the Unchangeable, the Unique who exists forever.

"This image of me is as old as the earth and its life is the life of the earth. The sand of the desert, the hand of man, nothing could destroy it. It is worn by time like the earth. It approaches its end as the earth approaches its death. But I am Etemel and will never die.

"Similarly, the Man who believes in me and adores me will never die, he will always live in me because he is my living image.

"Tell that to everyone who will listen to you. Life is eternal as Eternal I am, I, Tem, the Unique, the Reason for Everything. »

The voice died away... A brutal wind had risen. He blew clouds of sand over the Sphinx, which creaked over its stone surface.

And the vision disappeared as in the night sky vanished a vapor.

## OLD PERSIAN TALE

The rosebush had just been reborn on this clear spring morning. The sap, dormant during the sad winter months, rose happily along the young shoots, swelling the tender leaves and budding buds. The sunlight gave vigor and liveliness to this new life. The work of the plant was in full swing in order to develop its marvelous flowers as quickly as possible which, by their color and their fragrance, would soon sing to the sun, to nature, the hymn of love.

Suddenly the rosebush quivered and its thorns bristled: a filthy being, crawling on the ground, had just placed its repulsive paws on its stem. The rose bush wanted to get rid of it and called to its aid the light breeze that caressed the treetops. He begged her to shake her branches to make the disgusting insect fall from the young leaves. It was in vain. The breeze was as helpless as the sharp thorns that defended the stems. The worm held firm, gripping the shrub with its many legs; he climbed slowly along the branches, avoiding the threatening points. He soon reached the tender shoots and strove to annihilate the work of nature. The rose bush was crying to feel the horrible caterpillar devouring its flesh. He was crying in pain, grief, disgust.

Time passed. The rose bush, with a supreme effort, by means of an abundant sap, replaced by new shoots, perhaps still more tender, the poor devoured leaves. And the worm attacked them again, growing visibly larger, and the plant always covered itself with a new adornment.

Finally a day came when, tired and sated, the worm descended into a dark corner and wrapped himself in a shroud of silk, the emblem of death. And then the rosebush, in all the plenitude of its happiness, breathed with all its bruised but finally delivered being, and hastened to repair the harmful work.

Its dazzling and dense greenery formed a graceful setting in which the delicate flowers were to flourish which, with all their fragrance, would sing the hymn of life to the glory of the Creator.

That longed-for day has arrived. With the first ray of the sun the first rose blooms, all dripping with dew.

The radiant star gazed into the bosom of this flower and made a thousand diamonds sparkle there. All panting with joy, the rose

replied with a balmy sigh expressing the happiness of his soul reborn to life.

Suddenly, in the thick shadow of the foliage, the rose perceived, seated on a white pedestal - a sort of empty shell - a lovely and light being, resembling a sylph.

He was adorned with a dazzling robe and had an amiable and graceful air. And the rose addressed her fragrant appeal to him and said to him: "Come to me, oh beautiful stranger, come and rest in my fragrant breast, come and taste the nectar that with love I have prepared for you, come and mix your colors with mine. brilliant and, united one to the other, we will form a harmonious accord".

All throbbing with emotion, the slender butterfly rushed, entered the bosom of the flower, bathed in the aroma of its soul and drank the divine nectar.

The rose whispered her love song to him and said to him: "O, my beautiful stranger whom I have nourished with the fluid of my heart, whom I have bathed in my sweetest perfume, in your turn listen to my prayer, be my messenger of Love, flies towards my beloved who, very close to me, spreads her fragrant scents and brings her my kiss. Then you'll bring me his. As a reward, you will drink again from the chalice that I will offer you, you will again breathe in my disturbing perfume".

And the glorious, sparkling butterfly flew up to carry the message to the nearby flower.

He returned later, but he had changed... his colors had faded and his flight seemed heavier. He bent over the rose, but without touching the nectar it offered him, without seeming to revel in the scent it gave off.

"O, my beautiful messenger of love, what is happening to you? Why this sadness and disgust? »

The butterfly replied: "I am sad because I am going to die. I will no longer see the beautiful sun, I will no longer be intoxicated by your perfume. I have fulfilled the mission you gave me, in turn come to my aid. I'm going to die, but I don't want to disappear completely. I entrust to you the essence of my life. I deposit near you this treasure; the place is safe and quiet and I can come back... one day... me or my child". Her voice died away and her wings, lighter than the petals of the rose, fell back inert...

And the anguished rose, embraced by sorrow, answered him: "O, my sweet messenger, you will find a safe and quiet place here, in the shade of my foliage, near my roots. I promise to keep your treasure... Goodbye, see you another beautiful day... I'll be waiting for you".

And, before dying, the pretty butterfly buried her eggs against the root of the rosebush.

## THE CAPTAIN

It was in 18... As a young lieutenant, I sailed aboard the corvette l'Epervier, one of the vessels of the Pacific squadron. Towards the end of November we sailed from Vladivostok for Japan

The winter that year was harsh and it was rare for a day to pass without a storm. The commander of the corvette was an excellent sailor, appreciated throughout the fleet. The officers, united by a good camaraderie and a solid friendship, surrounded their chief with esteem and respect. We could hope for an interesting and pleasant trip. We were making merry plans to spend Christmas in Shanghai, a city full of attraction for sailors. But fate was preparing a surprise for us.

Already, at the beginning of our trip, our commander, always in a playful mood, gave worrying signs of melancholy. He remained shut up in his cabin for a long time, took his meals alone, without inviting one of the officers as usual. When the latter invited him to their mess, he declined the invitation each time. In a word, it was like a wall suddenly erected between our leader and us, and everyone tried to guess the cause of this incomprehensible situation.

The orderly of the captain, a young sailor of a cheerful character, looked out of place; to all the questions we asked him about his chief he replied by shaking his head mysteriously: "Ah! my lieutenant, there will be a misfortune. This is not going well for the commander. All day and all night he walks along his cabin, he hardly eats anything... It's not going well at all". But we couldn't tell what was wrong.

Our second in command was influenced by this atmosphere, his mood changed, he became more severe, more demanding. He often talked in a low voice with our doctor.

Contrary to our expectation, this trip became monotonous, sad, and we were getting bored, we went down to the stops without enthusiasm, everyone confined themselves to a cold reserve, and a gloomy shadow seemed to surround our ship.

On December 3, we sailed from Nagasaki for Saigon. We had not seen the commandant for five days. The second was nervous and preoccupied. On December 5, I had just left the watch and was going downstairs to warm myself up with a cup of

tea. The sea was rough and the waves rushed against the stern, the winter night enveloped the corvette in its darkness and an icy wind whistled in the masts. I felt great well-being in my warm, well-lit cabin. The orderly had just brought me my boiling tea when I heard shouts and hasty footsteps on the deck. I quickly grabbed my cap from the table and climbed the stairs four at a time.

The first thing I saw was a group of busy men on the port side and I heard the captain shouting, "You have no right to hold me." Go! I will put you all under arrest". Ignoring this, the mate ordered him to be carried to his cabin. The group started off, and I could still hear the captain's curses, which ended in terrifying laughter, as the men walked away with their burdens, and the doctor, hastily awakened, ran across the deck to rejoin the one we had just taken away.

— What is happening ? What does all this mean? I asked the watch officer when order and silence were restored.

— Ah! it's awful. The commander went mad, imagine he wanted to drown. If it hadn't been for his orderly following him like a shadow, we might have suspected nothing until tomorrow. Look at this dark, gloomy night; almost a storm. It's frightening. Who would have thought?...

When I went down to the mess, all the officers were gathered there, commenting on the event. It seemed that already in Vladivostok the commander was no longer himself, and some in low voices were talking about a love affair... Suddenly the door opened and the second entered. All eyes turned to him. We fell silent, waiting for explanations. His face, usually calm, was upset, he quickly took his place at the table and, without sitting down, said to us: "Gentlemen, a great misfortune strikes us all on board: our leader has suddenly lost his reason and wanted to to sea. Fortunately this misfortune could be avoided, but we must fear a new attempt and all precautions must be taken accordingly. I begged the doctor not to leave him for a moment and posted two sentries at his door. Provisionally, I'm in command of the ship. When we get to Saigon, I'll have the commander transported to the hospital and await orders. It is a great loss for us to lose our esteemed leader. So I think you won't be surprised if I ask you, while he's on board, to abstain from all merriment, music, noise... Do you understand me, gentlemen? »

Until Saigon our journey was dismal, the ship seemed to be in mourning. We walked on tiptoe, we talked in low voices; after a silent meal everyone went back to their cabin.

At Saigon the captain was taken ashore, accompanied by the mate and the doctor. All the crew lined up on deck watched silently as the boat carried them away. Tears could be seen on the faces of some sailors.

Two days later, a steamer took on board our sick chief to bring him back to Vladivostok. The next day we sailed for Shanghai where our admiral was and where we were no doubt going to receive a new commander.

On the morning of the 23rd, the wind became stronger and, towards noon, it blew like a storm. The waves were throwing furiously to port and the ship was 35 ° heeled. The propeller constantly came out of the water and spun in a vacuum, shaking the building. The pilot officer surveyed the horizon anxiously, then went to study the map. The men at the helm were changed every hour, they had infinite difficulty in keeping the ship on its course. Towards evening the wind seemed to weaken a little and turn. This storm lasted 24 hours and on December 24 we were almost the same distance from Shanghai as the day before.

All hope of a merry Christmas was dashed. All we had was the prospect of the dancing waves, the crockery fiddles clattering our tables as we clung to our chairs, so as not to fall, when the deck rose to an almost vertical position.

I took the watch at midnight. The storm was weakening a little, the wind was still whistling and you could hear, like a dull noise, the great waves beating the side of the ship, spraying the deck with their foam.

The pilot officer said to me: “My dear, I am going to bed, I have been here for two days. The sea seems to calm down. Here is our road, follow it well, we cross a dangerous region. At the slightest deviation, you risk throwing yourself on rocks. See here—and he pointed to me on the map—that devilish NO keeps us swerving eastward. Good night ! At the slightest alarm, send for me. »

It was completely dark. The wind made the masts moan and sprinkled everything with a dust of water that froze instantly. Two sailors were at the helm and were maneuvering to keep the vessel on its course. It was nearly one o'clock. I carefully studied the route of our route on the map. Yes, if we deviated only ten miles to the east, we risked crushing the ship on the rocks, where many boats had already sunk. What if the wind that had already been blowing for two days had swept us east? The weather was so bad that we couldn't take stock. I studied the road again. The building seemed to be following her, but the agonizing thought persisted: “What if?...”

Suddenly, through the whistling of the wind and the sound of the waves, I distinctly heard this command: "Change direction, half a degree to the W." I turned around. No one near me. I ran across the bridge. Nobody. I confess that this hallucination impressed me unpleasantly. I bent over the map again, wanting to see where we were. The thought that the wind from the O. could deflect us to the E. did not leave me.

While I was absorbed in the study of the map I heard, even more urgently, the voice which this time I recognized well:

“I tell you to turn half a degree to the O. »

There could no longer be any doubt, this voice was that of our commander. But how could he be here? We had seen him leave us in Saigon. What madness ! I climbed back up and walked the deck. Still nobody. Everything was quiet, the wind alone sang its mournful song in the ropes of the masts.

A feeling of terror seized me. My ears clearly heard the commander's voice but my reason told me that it was impossible. I approached the helm; the sailors, still in the same position, held the wheel with effort. Obviously, they hadn't heard anything, so absorbed were they in the maneuver.

With indefinable unease I returned to the command post. The lighting was bright, everything in order as usual, but my discomfort persisted especially when I approached the map where an invincible force attracted me. I was still leaning over it when I heard above my ear the same voice vibrating with emotion shouting to me: "Finally, will you take half a degree to O?" And at the same time I saw a hand come out from behind my back, the well-known hand of our commander, with its blue veins and its escutcheon ring, which traced on the map the route to be taken.

I turned around. Nobody... Like a madman, I jumped out of the post. I needed the company of men, needed to escape this strange, mysterious atmosphere. The sailors hurriedly turned the helm, changing the direction of the ship to the west...

The next morning, when we were able to orient ourselves in the sun, we found that the wind had caused us to drift ten miles to the east.

So the pilot officer said to me: "If you hadn't had the intuition that we had to change our route, we wouldn't be sitting in this place, but at the very least tossed around in a boat, somewhere on the waves. . We were going straight over the rocks”.

At Shanghai we caught up with the steamer and learned that our poor captain, in a new fit of madness, had thrown himself into the sea on the night of December 24th.

## ORIENTAL LEGEND

Sarajana Masor was one of the Sages. Nothing, it seemed, was hidden from him. He read the books of human souls as easily as the celestial book where the words are the starry constellations — the eternal book which, for those who understand it and can interpret it, contains the destiny of peoples and shows us the picture of life. cycle of worlds. For many years, Sarajana had felt no need, no desire had come to her. He walked back and forth, absorbed in his meditation. He radiated wisdom and the cave he lived in on the peaks of the Himalayas had become a destination of pilgrimage. All those who sought advice, all those who worried about the problems of existence, all those who aspired to recover their health, sought him.

The Sage received everyone, solved the most embarrassing problems and gave the most wise advice. He was completely selfless, and because of this detachment his reputation for holiness spread far and wide.

Nobody knew his age, but everyone agreed that more than a hundred winters had passed on his head, because he had advised or helped even the great-grandparents of certain visitors who had also still need his wisdom. No matter how old he was, he looked no older than 50. His beard had whitened, but his eyes remained young and lively, and every attitude attested to his bodily vigor.

The physical weakness which seems to spare no old man had no hold on him. He could always be seen meditating in his cave, always ready to affably and attentively receive anyone who came to him.

Nevertheless, he was himself, tired of living, tired of his immense knowledge, since life had hardly any secrets for him, tired of this fame which grew every day. They went so far as to say that he was a new incarnation of Brahma and, as such, they treated him almost like a god, showering him with homage and offerings.

His life flowed monotonously among the desolation and grandeur of the Himalayas, but his soul, freed from all worldly bonds, could reach the higher planes and converse constantly with the great spirits surrounding Brahma's throne. He

feared that he would not be able to join them, he was impatient to be freed from carnal bonds, to occupy, near the Lord, the place he deserved by his long exemplary life. He was thinking :

“Why do I have to remain so long attached to this body that my will has already subjugated and which no longer offers me any interest? Why are other beings much less evolved than me allowed to receive the gift of death and come before the Creator? Why am I not called? »

Thinking thus, his soul came to the door of the Everlasting Garden and knocked.

A guardian appeared and asked her what had brought her to the Abode of Glorious.

— "I would like to come in" whispered Sarajana's soul.

— "It is too early, brother," replied the Guardian. “Your name does not yet appear on the list of those who have the right to enter here. »

— “Perhaps I have been forgotten? Sarajana objected. “I have reached on earth the highest degree that it is possible for man to reach. What more can I do? »

— "You're not on the list and I can't get you in." Go and keep working. You will be called when your destiny is fulfilled. »

Sarajana therefore returned to earth and resumed her occupations; his miracles became even more amazing and his glory spread further.

For a long time still, the Ganges rolled its torrential waters, much sand flowed, slowly, in the hourglass of Time: but Sarajana was always among its peaks of the Himalayas, no one had called it from the Celestial Garden.

He decided to come back and knock on the divine door and ask once again if he could enter. He was told again that the time had not yet come and that he had to work until further notice. He returned to earth and redoubled his zeal for good works; his body became almost immaterial and his abstinence reduced his physical form to such an extent that those who saw him took him for a Deva.

But no one called him from above.

He then had a movement of revolt.

“What meaning does all my work have? he cried. I have attained the highest wisdom; I have conquered all lusts of the flesh, and I am condemned to continue this miserable existence, whereas so many others, who know nothing and whose only merit is to carry without protest the jug of water from their garden, have the right to die and are admitted near the throne of Brahma! It is true that

these do not complain, since they know nothing. But I, who have reached the culmination of knowledge, what is my reward? Why am I not called? I have deserved it for many years. It is an injustice! »

And while he lamented, he suddenly felt that the soul left his body; Finally, he was allowed to die!

He then experienced immense joy. “I am finally understood! he thought. But suddenly he felt that his soul, instead of ascending towards the Eternal Garden, was falling towards the abyss in a precipitous descent. The fall became rapid, terrible; suddenly he lost consciousness.

When he came to, he was amazed at his dire situation; he was chained, plunged into the night and an icy cold stiffened his limbs; he could not make the slightest movement, nor utter the slightest sound. In vain he tried to explain to himself the strange state in which he found himself...

Centuries passed, during which his spirit suffered indescribable tortures. He revolted: despite the prostration due to the cold, the silence, the darkness, he committed blasphemy in his mind and protested against the Creator. But his protest went unanswered and his revolt unpunished.

Centuries still passed. Sarajana calmed down. He examined his present condition, and his past life flashed through his memory. He relives his restless years in search of wisdom, his slow ascent up the long ladder to his summit; he relived the time when unfortunate people came to him and allowed him to be deified; he remembered having, tired of helping his brothers, sought rest and peace in the spheres above.

And he understood.

He understood why he had not been called to the Abode of the Glorious, why he had knocked in vain on its door without being judged ready yet. He understood that all his effort was worth nothing because he had based it on pride; he had thought himself superior to his fellows. He had humbled himself before them, but he had not loved them; his sole aim had been personal progress, ambition. This selfishness and pride had caused his fall to a lower degree of creation...

He understood the cold, the silence and the darkness. He understood the immobility: he was transformed into stone.

This revelation awoke in him a feeling of sadness and remorse which lasted for many centuries and grew in intensity. He would have liked to resume his past life, in order to prove his repentance and his submission, but his stone form condemned him to immobility, with no other manifestations of life than his sad thoughts.

Finally his repentance reached such an intensity that he was conscious of a state of relief and sought refuge in tears.

That day, a poor shepherd, mute from birth, who was grazing his sheep on the slopes of the Himalayas, in the middle of an arid and stony ravine, witnessed a miracle. A large rock, on which not a blade of grass grew, suddenly split, and from the crack a stream of clear, pure water flowed. The shepherd approached it in astonishment and, thirsty, took a mouthful. Immediately his tongue loosened and he began to speak. He ran to the village and told the miracle that had happened to him...

Since that day, pilgrims have come in droves to the miraculous source which heals those who believe of their bodily ailments and dispenses them with a little divine grace.

END

## Ratings

1

Prayer to be compared to the prayer of the Tibetan lamas.

2

The Rota Trilogy.

3

Moreover, if we take the trouble to read the correspondence of the author of “Dogme et Rituel” with Baron Spedalieri, we see that he only practiced evocation once. The result frightened him so much that he subsequently gave up any experiment of this kind.

4

PHANEG. — Lecture on bewitchment given at the Société d'Etudes Psychiques de Nancy, 1906.

5

Ancient recipes for herbs composed for different magical operations have been found in the temples of Edfu and Philae.

6

See my translation of the Sepher Ietzirah.

7

Nehot = pulverized aromatic. Nechima = breath (but Nechama = spirit). Nasso - Nefesch = aspiration (but Nefesch = subconscious soul). Nahesch = to predict by divination (but Nahash = serpent of Genesis, physical, lower instincts), etc... In hieroglyphics NF expresses any idea of breath, breathing.

8

The root Noun-Daleth means: everything that evaporates, exhales.

9

The root Resch-noun means: a chemical departure from elemental nature.

10

These correspondences have been indicated in my book: “Essay on Cabbalistic Astrology”.

11

Translated from the Hebrew by Enel and published in the “Rota Trilogy”.

12

V.FABRE D'OLIVET: *The Hebrew language restored*.

13

See my article: *The Spirit of the Sephiroths*, December 1927 issue, “Psyche”.

14

Saying and creating are synonymous in Hebrew.

15

Genesis 1.

16

Saint John 1,6,7.

17

Genesis 11.19.

18

F. D'OLIVET: *Hebraic language restored*, vol. II, ch. II, 19.

19

For example, the same letters form two completely different words: “dog” and “kennel”.

20

The ancients believed that the functions of the human body were governed by twelve glands. The functions of most of these glands are completely ignored by modern medicine.

21

See SEDIR: *Magical Plants*; ENEL: *Essay on cabbalistic astrology*.

22

Example: the magnet transfer treatments that gave Papus such remarkable results.

23

Personally, I have seen cases of serious erysipelas cured in one session by applying to the disease a red woolen cloth on which a rapid combustion product (powder) was burned. This, it was said, destroyed the nest of astral microbes in the aura. I have also seen transferred jaundice, within an hour, on a live pike. The latter turned yellow and died when the patient was healed.

A wart is lightly wrapped in a knot of linen thread which is then thrown into the damp earth: when the knot is rotten, the wart has disappeared.

I could cite a number of analogous examples despite the mocking smiles that I would not fail to create. However, I only told the truth and witnesses could testify to it. All these processes, called sympathetic, are known in the countryside and are only vestiges of an ancient science which directed its action in the astral to combat a

physical illness.

24

By the word "last" is meant, I believe, not the end of the earth, but the end of an era. I propose, in another article, to cross-check this interpretation with other data of undeniable value.

25

Genesis 1, 3.

26

St. Jean Evang., 1,1.

27

Translated and commented by F. D'OLIVET: *Hebraic language restored*, II.

28

Translated by Ch. Leiningen and by Enel.

29

In Samaritan these two letters are written identically נ and n.

30

And God was the Word (St. John, 1,3).

31

It is the Chaldaic root אור or אור.

32

Sepher Ietzirah.

33

It is the root x': passive matter, thing from which and by which everything is done: it is water. On the other hand, MA expresses the woman, the mother. It is the first word articulated by the child in almost all languages. Curious euphonic remark: in French: sea and mother.

34

Genesis 1, 7. *Et dividit aquas ab aquis, quae superius sunt quae inferius.*

35

It is the root it is the hissing sound of fire.

36

5.1. Chap. VI, 3.

37

This root was formed from fire and a precise center of activity. (VF D'OLIVET: *Hebrew language restored.*)

38

5.1. Chap. II, 1.

39

The macrocosm and the microcosm constitute similar elements. Here is what Genesis says: "Adam was created by God to work the Adamic substance, a homogeneous element similar to Adam. (F. D'OLIVET, chap. II, 5.)

The study of the microcosm leads us to the understanding of the macrocosm. Moreover, contemporary scholars are beginning, in certain areas, to find, not without astonishment, that the ancients were sometimes right. Recently an article by Dr. Lavezzari, published in *l'Homéopathie Française* (June 6, 1927), confirms our statements. The author, by analyzing the different functions of the human body, demonstrates that they are in perfect analogy with those of the Universe.

40

which was extracted from by the Creator. (It is the development of the root  $\aleph$ •fire, for it was still only a question of the man of fire — the intellectual man; the  $\aleph$  had not yet entered into action.) It is essential to be aware of the development of these words. The first poses the creative principle of the Universe, while the second develops the thought by adding  $\aleph$  (feminine sign), which gives us the - the spiritual binary.

41

F. D'OLIVET: *Hebrew language restored*, I. The letter 7.

42

5.1., VI, 5.

43

Eg. on Sunday day of  $\aleph$  the first hour will apply to  $\aleph$  and the following to the succession expressed above:

On Saturday day of Saturn we will have Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, Sun, Venus, Mercury, Moon and so on. But always the respective order of the planets remains the same.

44

It is evident that in the transcription of the SI an error has been made in attributing to the  $\aleph$  the correspondence of Jupiter, and not • center of the balance of our system and which in the planetary order of Kabbalah occupies its natural place. .

This error is involuntary or voluntary, if the author wanted to hide the exact meaning of the book.

45

Wisdom, stupidity; wealth, poverty; fertility, sterility; life, death; mastery, slavery; peace, war; beauty, ugliness.

46

5.1., IV, 2.

47

According to the Hebrew cabbalists, the Demiurge *Ain-Soph* is manifested by the various parts of his body, such as the mouth, the

hair, eyes, etc... (Zohar Sifra Dzeniutha). This idea seems to have been borrowed from the Egyptian teaching where it is said that "Ra is the Creator of the names of his members" which appeared in the form of various gods. Papyrus Nesi Amsu.

48

Davies Tel-Eel-Amarna.

49

Very often we read in the texts "the faces" instead of "the men".

50

The constellation of the Thigh was the point of reference by means of which one found the North. When the plan of the temple of Edfu was drawn, which is oriented towards the cardinal points, the pharaoh said: "my gaze plunges into the constellation of the Thigh... and I establish the four corners of the temple" (inscript. of Edfu).

51

On the sarcophagus of Penehem Ast we read: "Tem the father of the stars of the North..."

52

The legend of Dhruva says that all the stars "are tied by a cord to the North Star and run in a circle around it". At Karnak, the god Set is symbolized by the "Jackal of the South" which runs in circles around the earth.

See Lockyer "Dawn of Astronomy"; G. St-Clair "Creating records"; Payne Knight "Symbolic language of ancient art and Mythology".

53

e.g. the epithet of Horus, also used for a priest officiating the funeral rite, is *YWN-Mout-F* which is translated: "the support of his mother". The analysis of this denomination being very long, I refer the reader to my work "The Sacred Language" where he will find a detailed study of this name.

54

Zohar Sifra Dzeniutha

55

See Enel “Rota”.

56

BREASTED, *op. cit.*, p. 160.

57

PITCHER: *Palestine Exploration*, Fund XV, 1923, pages 85-88.

58

BREASTED, *op. cit.*, case no. 7, pages 175-201.

59

I draw the reader's attention to the anatomical knowledge of the Egyptians relating to the action of the lower jaw. It was considered until now that their knowledge was limited to that of the embalmer (the latter knew the position of the intestines that he removed in order to preserve the mummy, and never touched the muscles of the face). But the description of the maxillary muscle proves to us that the Egyptian surgeons had made dissections of corpses for the sole purpose of study, for, without this, they would not have been able to realize the functioning of the jaw to the point of describing it. with this precision.

GNOMOLOGY

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